The complete coach binder

90 practices + 72 move cards + 30 games + research and coaching tools
208 binder pages / 104 sheets when printed double-sided | September 2026

Print the combined Grindstone Coaching Binder PDF in its existing order. The large BINDER number at the bottom of each page is the number used in this index. The smaller section page number helps locate the same material in a standalone PDF.

Print double-sided, flip on the long edge. The punch margin alternates left/right. Use Letter paper at Actual Size / 100%. Dividers and all index pages are included. Separate documents remain available for printing only a section.

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Use index pages 2-4 for moves, page 5 for games, pages 6-8 for all 90 practices, and the following pages for research, forms and quick cues. Sections flow continuously to save paper.

Tier reminder: Pup, beginner and advanced describe teaching readiness. The practice books retain their age groups. Detailed move research is separate: open Grindstone-Move-Research.html or .md and find the same move ID.

Pup moves and foundations

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Research, forms and quick references

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TAB 1 / MOV

Coach moves reference

72 entries: Pup, beginner and advanced. Teaching steps, cues, corrections, drills and coach note space.

Content: binder pages 12-54
43 content pages

Coach / group: _____

Season: _____

GRINDSTONE WRESTLING

Coach moves reference

PUP / BEGINNER / ADVANCED

72 teaching entries covering movement foundations, setups, takedowns, defense, escapes, reversals, rides, turns and combinations.

Every entry includes prerequisites, teaching steps, two short cues, a common error and correction, a drill progression, and a technical watch point.

One shared reference for the coaching staff. Choose the right tier for the athlete and the specific skill; keep familiar fundamentals in every practice.

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Find the move. Teach the next step.

Use the tiers

Pup is a voluntary movement bank for the youngest children. Beginner is the starting technical pathway for a new wrestler at any older youth age. Advanced means the specific prerequisites, receiving, release and decision skills are established; it is not an age label.

Keep the lesson small

Choose one main technique and one related response. Demonstrate both roles, name the finish position, give one cue, then let pairs work. The numbered steps are coach notes; athletes need one useful cue at a time.

Progress the resistance

Rehearse the movement, complete cooperative repetitions, add one announced defensive response, then use a short positional problem. Use the card's drill as a starting dose, with rest and role changes. Progress only while both partners stay controlled.

Match and supervise

Pair for size, maturity, skill and control. Teach the receiving pathway before a finish or turn. Stop on the coach's signal, pain, distress, unsafe joint position or loss of control. Advanced cards need a coach who can demonstrate and correct that technique.

Use with the practice books

The 90 practice plans provide the session clock. This larger library expands the available techniques; many entries are new extensions. Substitute only after teaching their prerequisites. The binder index gives exact pages for every move, practice and support document.

Read the research

Move-specific source keys such as P07-S1 link to inspected source material. The separate Grindstone Move Research report records the chosen variant, evidence, corrections and teaching decisions for each ID. Practice doses and simplified progressions are coaching designs. Apply the actual event rules.

Remember the terms

Each card uses a specific right/left example; mirror the entire sequence together. Near means the side closest to the demonstrated top or attacking position; far means the opposite side. Underhook and overhook name arm position. A ride maintains control, a turn exposes shoulders, an escape reaches neutral, and a reversal gains top control.

Pup - find a technique

Click a move title, use a PDF bookmark, or turn to the printed page.

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Beginner - find a technique

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Advanced - find a technique

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P01 Wrestling Stance

Purpose Build a balanced stance with hands in front, ready to move or defend. **Before teaching** Child can stand independently, copy a small knee bend, and stop on the coach's signal.

1. Face the coach in your own mat space. Set feet about shoulder-width apart, with your right foot a little ahead of your left. Leave space sideways between the feet.

2. Bend your knees and hips enough to lower slightly. Keep your back long, chest slightly forward, and eyes ahead; do not sit into a deep squat.

3. Bring both hands in front of your body, fingers relaxed and elbows bent close to your sides. Keep shoulders and hips facing the coach.

4. Balance across both feet with pressure toward the balls of the feet. Keep heels near the mat; do not stand on tiptoe or lean onto your hands.

5. Pause for one easy breath, then stand and relax. Rebuild on the coach's signal. Try left foot forward after a full reset.

Say "Knees bent, eyes ahead." / "Hands forward, elbows in."

Common error Feet line up like a tightrope, or the child bends only at the waist. **Correct it** Restore sideways foot space, then show a smaller bend through both knees and hips.

Drill / progress Copy three stance-and-relax repetitions. Then play statues: coach raises a hand for stance and lowers it for standing rest. Keep each pause brief; change lead foot after successful repetitions.

Watch / stop Solo only. Stop for pain or repeated loss of balance; use a smaller bend and more space. **Resources** P01-S1 / P01-S2 / P01-S3

P02 Stance Steps

Purpose Move toward, away from, and beside a target without losing your wrestling stance. **Before teaching** Can hold the stance from P01, take a short step, and stop on a signal.

1. Face the coach in a clear lane. Put your left foot slightly ahead, feet apart, knees bent, hands forward and elbows near your sides. Keep eyes ahead.

2. Go forward: take a small step with your left foot, then bring your right foot forward enough to restore the starting space between your feet.

3. Go backward: move your right foot back first, then follow with your left. Finish with the left foot still slightly ahead.

4. Go sideways: left foot first to your left; right foot first to your right. Follow with the other foot without touching or crossing feet. Keep facing forward.

5. Pause balanced after each pair of steps, keeping knees bent. Stand to rest, then rebuild the stance before repeating.

Say "Step, follow, feet apart." / "Eyes ahead, knees bent."

Common error The following foot catches the first foot, making the stance narrow or crossed. **Correct it** Shorten the first step and stop the following foot at the original stance width.

Drill / progress Copy one direction at a time without contact. Then play follow-the-arrow for 20-30 seconds: the coach signals one direction, the child takes one step-and-follow, and freezes. Rest before repeating.

Watch / stop Use clear mat space, including behind the child. Stop for pain, stumbling or crowding; no pushing or racing. **Resources** P02-S1 / P02-S2 / P02-S3

P03 Level Change

Purpose Lower the hips in wrestling stance while staying balanced, ready for a later step-in entry. **Before teaching** Can hold the P01 stance briefly and make a small, pain-free knee bend.

1. Start alone in a staggered stance, with feet apart and one foot slightly ahead. Keep hands in front and elbows close.

2. Keep both feet in place. Bend the knees a little more and lower the hips between the feet; the head lowers with the hips.

3. Keep the back firm and eyes forward. Use a small range that preserves balance, without folding the chest toward the mat or tipping the chin up.

4. Return to the starting stance height with knees still bent. Pause balanced, then relax fully before the next repetition.

Say "Knees bend, hips lower." / "Back to your stance."

Common error Bowing at the waist while the hips stay high, or straightening the legs on the return. **Correct it** Use a smaller knee bend. Show the starting stance and finish at that same height.

Drill / progress Copy two slow level changes, then rest. Next, lower when the coach lowers an open hand and return to stance when it rises. Coach stays out of reach; no contact or racing.

Watch / stop Do not push a child lower. Stop for pain or loss of balance; reduce the depth before retrying. **Resources** P03-S1 / P03-S2

P04 Level Change and Step

Purpose Prepare for a leg-attack entry by lowering the hips and moving forward in balance. This is a standing preparation drill, not a complete penetration step. **Before teaching** Can hold a staggered stance, take short stance steps, and lower through the hips and knees.

1. Start with your right foot slightly ahead of your left, feet apart and hands in front. Place a flat marker one short step ahead of the right foot.

2. Bend your knees and lower your hips a little, keeping your eyes forward and chest from folding toward the mat.

3. Push gently from the left foot and step the right foot toward the marker. Move your hips forward with the step; both knees stay off the mat.

4. Slide the left foot forward enough to restore your starting stance. Keep it behind and to the left of the right foot; do not bring the feet together.

5. Pause balanced, then relax and walk back. Practice the other lead only after a fresh reset.

Say "Lower, then step." / "Keep your feet apart."

Common error Reaching the front foot far ahead while the hips stay behind, then gathering the feet together. **Correct it** Bring the marker closer and finish with the same foot spacing as the starting stance.

Drill / progress Copy three slow repetitions and rest. Then react to the coach lowering one hand: lower, step, recover stance, and freeze.

Watch / stop Solo only; no grabbing, diving, or knee contact. Stop if balance or comfort is lost. **Resources** P04-S1 / P04-S2 / P04-S3

P05 Bottom Base

Purpose Support yourself on hands and knees so you can move without falling onto your belly. **Before teaching** Can lower to the mat, support weight on hands and knees, and stop on the coach's signal.

1. Kneel in clear mat space. Put both palms down about shoulder-width apart, beneath your shoulders.

2. Keep knees apart beneath your hips and your back roughly level. Press through your palms to support your chest; do not let your belly sag.

3. Look a little ahead with your head clear of the mat. Keep elbows facing back and able to bend; breathe normally.

4. Shift a little toward your left hand and both knees. Briefly lift your right palm, then replace it beneath your shoulder. Rebuild your base before trying the other hand.

5. Finish with both palms and knees supporting you. Sit up on your knees to rest, then rebuild when asked.

Say "Chest off the mat." / "Move a hand, rebuild your base."

Common error Reaching a hand far forward until the chest drops or the body rolls sideways. **Correct it** Keep the hand close to its starting spot; first practice a small weight shift with both palms down.

Drill / progress Build, breathe, rest twice. Then the coach names one hand: shift, lift that palm briefly, replace it, and freeze in base. Alternate hands with rests.

Watch / stop Solo practice. No one sits or pushes on the back. Stop for wrist or knee pain, arm collapse, or head contact. **Resources** P05-S1 / P05-S2 / P05-S3

P06 Solo Belly to Base

Purpose Recover from lying on the belly to a wrestling base, ready for the next bottom move. **Before teaching** Can lower to the belly and support a hands-and-knees base without pain or head contact.

1. Start alone on the belly, legs behind you. Bring forearms beside the chest, elbows close and head clear of the mat.

2. For a right-side recovery, slide your right knee forward along your right side. Keep your chest facing the mat; do not roll onto your back.

3. Press through your forearms and shift your hips back over the right knee. Slide your left knee underneath as your belly leaves the mat.

4. Come onto your palms with hands beneath shoulders and knees apart beneath hips. Keep elbows slightly bent and hips back, then pause balanced.

5. Lower gently through your forearms to reset on your belly. Repeat with your left knee coming forward first.

Say "Knee up the side." / "Hips back, build your base."

Common error Pushing the chest up while both knees stay behind, leaving the belly stuck down. **Correct it** Pause after bringing one knee alongside; shift the hips back before bringing in the other knee.

Drill / progress Do two slow solo recoveries. Then the coach stands beside one hip without touching: bring the knee farther from the coach forward first. Reset and change sides.

Watch / stop Solo on a wrestling mat. No jumping, neck support, or partner weight. Stop for pain or collapsing arms. **Resources** P06-S1 / P06-S2 / P06-S3

P07 Solo Sprawl

Purpose Learn the legs-back, hips-low action of a sprawl and recover to stance, using a slow step-back first. **Before teaching** Balanced stance, a small level change, and steady, pain-free hand support on the mat.

1. Start in stance on a wrestling mat with empty space behind you. Coach demonstrates from the side.

2. Bend hips and knees; place both palms on the mat in front of your feet, about shoulder-width apart. Keep your head clear.

3. Support your upper body and step one foot back, then the other. Keep feet apart and extend both legs behind you.

4. Lower your hips toward the mat, keeping them square and knees off the mat. Let elbows bend as needed; keep chest and head clear without forcing a back arch. Pause only briefly.

5. Lift hips enough to step feet forward underneath you, one at a time. Lift hands when your feet support a balanced crouch, then return to stance.

Say "Legs back, hips low." / "Feet under, back to stance."

Common error Stopping in a high plank or dropping onto the knees. **Correct it** Slow down: extend the legs, lower the hips briefly, then recover. Avoid a long hold.

Drill / progress Copy two slow repetitions, then rest. When consistent, react to the coach's open-hand signal with one sprawl and a balanced reset.

Watch / stop Solo only. Stop for pain, head contact, arm collapse, or uncontrolled dropping; return to stance practice. **Resources** P07-S1 / P07-S2 / P07-S3

P08 Solo Stand-Up

Purpose Rehearse stand-up footwork from base. This solo stage prepares for escaping a rider; actual hand control comes later. **Before teaching** P05 base, a steady half-kneeling rise, and a balanced stance.

1. Start on hands and knees, toes tucked, with an imaginary wrestler on your left. All directions describe your own body.

2. Lift your chest as your right foot steps forward under you. Bring your left forearm up across your chest and your right hand to your belly; avoid a long lunge.

3. Push through your right foot, bring your left foot underneath, and stand with knees bent and hips under your shoulders. Bring both hands to your waist to rehearse protecting that area.

4. Step your right foot slightly forward to clear your hips. Step your left foot back and around, turning left to face the imaginary wrestler; let both feet move with the turn.

5. Finish in stance with hands up. Walk back and lower into base for a fresh repetition; practice the mirror image after this side is steady.

Say "Chest up, foot under." / "Clear hips, turn and face."

Common error A long first step leaves the chest folded over the thigh. **Correct it** Shorten the step and pause with chest lifted before rising.

Drill / progress Do two slow repetitions and rest. Then react to the coach's raised hand: rise, turn, and freeze in stance.

Watch / stop Solo only. No pulling, pushing, head posting, or mat returns. Stop for pain or loss of balance. **Resources** P08-S1 / P08-S2 / P08-S3

P09 Solo Sit-Out

Purpose Learn to bring a leg and the hips through from base into a sit-out, preparing for later escapes. **Before teaching** P05; can step one foot up and briefly support a small hip lift without wrist pain or a trapped knee.

1. Begin on hands and knees in clear mat space. The coach demonstrates with the right foot leading; all directions refer to your own body.

2. Cross your left hand in front of your right hand and plant that palm on the mat. Lift your right hand beside your right thigh, keeping that elbow close.

3. Step your right foot a short distance forward and outward. Press through that foot and your left hand to make room beneath your hips.

4. Slide your left leg under the raised right knee and forward. Bring your hips through into a low seat, with your right knee bent and chest up.

5. Reposition your supporting hand beside your hip as needed. Pause balanced, then reset separately to hands and knees. Mirror the sequence after learning this side.

Say "Foot out, leg through." / "Sit low, chest up."

Common error Sitting down before the left leg clears, trapping that knee under the hips. **Correct it** Rehearse the foot step and small hip lift; slide the leg clear before lowering your seat.

Drill / progress Copy two slow repetitions, then rest. When consistent, sit out on the coach's open-hand signal and hold base on a closed-hand signal.

Watch / stop Solo only. Stop for pain, a trapped leg, head contact, or falling onto a straight arm. **Resources** P09-S1 / P09-S2 / P09-S3 / P09-S4 / P09-S5

P10 Hip-Heist Preparation

Purpose Learn the hip lift and leg-through that turn a seated wrestler toward the mat; this solo preparation does not teach a complete escape. **Before teaching** Can sit with bent knees, support a brief hip lift on a hand and opposite foot, and return to base without pain.

1. Sit with knees bent and feet apart. For this right-side turn, place your right palm beside and slightly behind your right hip; keep your left hand free.

2. Press through your right hand and left foot. Lift your seat enough to free your right leg; keep your head off the mat.

3. Thread your right leg underneath your left leg and back as you turn your chest toward your right hand. Let the left foot turn with your hips.

4. Place your left palm on the mat. Once the leg is clear, settle both knees into base facing back toward where you started sitting.

5. Pause, then reset separately to sitting. Learn the opposite side only after this side is smooth.

Say "Lift, then thread your leg." / "Turn your foot with your hips."

Common error Walking in a circle without lifting and passing a leg underneath. **Correct it** Practice only the small hip lift, then add one leg-through; reset if the foot catches.

Drill / progress Rehearse two slow repetitions and rest. Then complete one repetition on the coach's signal, finishing still in base.

Watch / stop Solo only. Stop for wrist pain, a trapped foot, knee twisting, or arm collapse. No head posts or partner pushing. **Resources** P10-S1 / P10-S2 / P10-S3 / P10-S4

P11 Go-Behind Footwork

Purpose Practice circling from in front to behind imagined hips. This is preparation for a go-behind, without contact or a takedown. **Before teaching** Can take short stance steps and stop balanced on a signal.

1. Mark an oval on the mat with flat tape or markers. Identify its head end and hip end. Put a start spot outside the head end and a finish spot beyond the hip end.

2. Begin on the start spot in a shallow stance, hands in front and eyes looking along the route. The oval stays empty.

3. Circle to your right: step your right foot right, then bring your left foot along without crossing or touching feet together.

4. Continue around the outside with small stance steps, gradually turning to face the oval. Keep both feet outside it; do not cut through the imagined head or arms.

5. Stop beyond the hip end, facing toward the head end. Stand and walk outside the station to reset. Repeat left, with the left foot leading.

Say "Small steps around." / "Finish behind the hips."

Common error Crossing feet or stopping beside the hip marker. **Correct it** Slow down and follow the outside arc all the way to the finish spot.

Drill / progress Rehearse once each way. Then the coach points right or left before each start; circle that way and freeze behind the hips.

Watch / stop No partner inside the oval, crawling, grabbing, or racing. Stop if balance or spacing breaks down. **Resources** P11-S1 / P11-S2 / P11-S3

P12 Side Breakfall Prep

Purpose Rehearse the side-breakfall position from the floor, without a drop or partner. **Before teaching** Child willingly rolls on a wrestling mat and can briefly keep the head clear while the coach watches.

1. Lie on your back in a clear mat space, feet apart and knees slightly bent. Gently bring your chin toward your chest and lift your head clear.

2. To practise your right side, bring your right hand toward your left shoulder. Rest your left hand near your belly.

3. Slowly turn your shoulders and hips toward your right, rolling across your right shoulder blade onto your side. Keep your legs uncrossed and head clear.

4. As you turn, open your right arm diagonally away from your body toward your feet. Gently tap the mat with the palm and length of the arm together; do not prop yourself on the elbow or hand.

5. Pause on your side, return slowly to your back, and rest. Reverse the instructions for your left side.

Say "Chin in, head clear." / "Roll and tap together."

Common error Propping on an elbow or reaching behind with a stiff hand. **Correct it** Stay on your side and rehearse the open, relaxed arm tap before rolling again.

Drill / progress Copy one slow roll each way. Then respond to the coach pointing right or left; pause and reset after every turn.

Watch / stop Stop for head contact, pain, fear, or loss of head control. Floor practice only; no pushing, drops, or standing takedowns. **Resources** P12-S1 / P12-S2 / P12-S3

B01 Wrestling Stance

Purpose Build a stance you can move, attack, and defend from. **Before teaching** Can bend knees and hips, follow a stop signal, and maintain personal space.

1. Face your partner outside touching distance. Set feet about shoulder-width apart, with your own right foot slightly ahead. Keep sideways space between your feet.

2. Bend knees and hips; keep your back long, chest slightly forward, and eyes ahead. Keep shoulders and hips facing your partner.

3. Hold relaxed hands in front with elbows close to your sides. Balance over both feet with pressure toward the forefeet; keep heels near the mat.

4. Take one small step: move the foot nearest that direction first, then follow with the other foot. Restore your spacing without crossing feet or standing tall.

5. Stop in stance without a recovery step. Stand to reset, then repeat with your left foot leading.

Say "Knees bent, eyes ahead." / "Hands forward, elbows in."

Common error Athlete folds at the waist, rocks onto heels, or narrows the feet. **Correct it** Reset the foot spacing, bend knees and hips less, then test one small step and stop.

Drill / progress Rebuild stance three times solo. Partners then mirror small steps for 20 seconds and swap leaders. After successful turns, the leader adds unexpected stops; the follower stops in stance while preserving the gap. Rest and reset between turns.

Watch / stop No contact or attacks. Reset if balance, spacing, or attention breaks down. **Resources** B01-S1 / B01-S2

B02 Motion and Level Change

Purpose Adjust distance and lower for an attack or defense while keeping your balance. **Before teaching** B01: can hold stance, step, and stop without a recovery step.

1. Face a partner outside touching distance in staggered stance. Keep hands forward, elbows close, and eyes forward.

2. Step front foot first going forward, back foot first going backward, right foot first going right, and left foot first going left. Follow with the other foot, preserving space between them.

3. Circle both ways with short steps, keeping the partner in front and the same lead foot. Never cross or join your feet.

4. First practice lowering in place: bend your knees and hips so your body drops without folding your chest toward the mat. Keep your knees off the mat.

5. Link a short step, level change, and another step. Stay mobile at the lower level; recover stance height without standing upright.

Say "Step, follow, keep your base." / "Hips down; eyes forward."

Common error Feet come together, or the head dives while the hips remain high. **Correct it** Shorten the steps; rehearse lowering in place, then take one balanced step from the lower position.

Drill / progress Rehearse three solo sequences. Partners mirror for four 20-second rounds, resting and swapping leaders each round. Begin slowly; then the leader chooses an unannounced direction or level change and the follower matches while keeping space.

Watch / stop No contact or shots in this drill. Reset if partners crowd each other or lose balance. **Resources** B02-S1 / B02-S2 / B02-S3

B03 Penetration Step

Purpose Practice a leg-attack entry and bring the feet back underneath you. **Before teaching** B01-B02; can lower, kneel, and rise without knee pain on a wrestling mat.

1. Start alone with your right foot forward and hands in front. Bend both knees; lower your hips with chest lifted and eyes forward.

2. Push from your left toes and step your right foot into the imaginary opponent's stance. Bring your hips forward.

3. Continue forward over your right toes until your right knee touches the mat lightly. Your knee travels forward; do not jump or fall onto it.

4. As the right knee comes down, bring your left foot forward and plant it to the left of that knee. Keep your left knee up and your hips underneath your chest.

5. Push through your left foot, lift your right knee, and step your right foot underneath you into a low stance. Reset; reverse sides for left-leg practice.

Say "Lower, then go forward." / "Lead knee down, trail foot up."

Common error The wrestler drops straight onto the lead knee and leaves the trail leg behind. **Correct it** Lower first, shorten the step, and bring the trail foot up as the lead knee touches.

Drill / progress Do three slow solo repetitions each side. Then a partner outside the entry lane either holds or retreats: enter when they hold; close distance and reset when they retreat. No contact.

Watch / stop Use a wrestling mat. Stop for knee pain, heavy knee impact, or loss of balance. **Resources** B03-S1 / B03-S2 / B03-S3 / B03-S4 / B03-S5

B04 Wrist and Inside Tie

Purpose Control both arms briefly and move the partner's feet to prepare an attack. **Before teaching** B01-B02; partners can keep balance during light hand fighting and release on command.

1. Face your partner in stance at bent-arm reaching distance. The partner keeps both elbows bent and hands in front.

2. With your left hand, grip their right wrist just above the hand. Close your fingers and thumb around the wrist, keeping their hand aligned with the forearm.

3. Keep that wrist grip. Slide your right hand inside their left forearm, then cup high on their left upper arm, fingers curling behind the triceps. Your right forearm contacts the inside of their biceps and your elbow points down.

4. Keep your head up and both elbows bent. Circle a short step to your right, right foot then left, guiding the upper arm so your partner steps to keep facing you.

5. Finish balanced with one wrist and the opposite upper arm controlled. Release both hands and reset; if either arm becomes stretched or blocked, release sooner. Mirror the sides next.

Say "Wrist on one side, inside on the other." / "Elbows down; feet move."

Common error Reaching across to the wrist-controlled arm or pulling with straight elbows. **Correct it** Reset closer; identify their opposite upper arm and keep your elbows bent.

Drill / progress Take 3 cooperative repetitions each. Then use 4 x 20-second rounds, alternating roles with 20-second rests. Receiver may retract the free elbow before entry; attacker gains the tie and one step, or releases and resets. No takedowns.

Watch / stop No finger grips, wrist bending, arm wrenching, or forcing a closed elbow open. Release for discomfort. **Resources** B04-S1 / B04-S2 / B04-S3 / B04-S4 / B04-S5 / B04-S6

B05 Arm Drag to Go Behind

Purpose Clear an arm and get behind while both stay standing. **Before teaching** B01-B02 and B04; can follow a pull with the feet and release promptly.

1. Face your partner in stance. Take their right wrist with your left hand, keeping their wrist straight.

2. Guide that wrist down and across; reach your right hand under their right upper arm and cup the triceps just above the elbow.

3. Step your left foot just outside their right foot as your right hand draws their elbow across your front toward your right hip. Keep your head up and your own elbows close.

4. Bring your right foot around and follow their right shoulder toward their back. Release the wrist and reach your left arm around their waist to the far hip.

5. Continue behind their hips, release the triceps, and place both hands lightly at the waist. Freeze balanced, then release and reset.

Say "Elbow across; feet around." / "Catch the hip, then let the arm go."

Common error Pulling the wrist while staying in front. **Correct it** Rehearse the triceps pull and outside step together before adding the go-behind.

Drill / progress Take three slow repetitions each; receiver steps with the pull. Then alternate four attempts each while the receiver may take one step to square up. Reset if the angle closes.

Watch / stop No wrist twisting, backward arm pulls, lifts, trips, or mat returns; release for joint pain or lost balance. **Resources** B05-S1 / B05-S2 / B05-S3

B06 Elbow Pop

Purpose Clear both arm posts and enter a double leg. **Before teaching** B03; can enter, pause, release both legs, and recover without a takedown.

1. Start right foot forward. Partner rests both hands on your upper arms with elbows slightly bent. Place your palms beneath their upper arms just above the elbows: left hand under their right arm, right under their left.

2. Give a small forward push through the tie. Partner presses back while staying balanced.

3. As that pressure returns, briefly lift both elbows while lowering your hips. Lift with open palms; do not strike or straighten their joints.

4. Release the arms and step your right foot between their feet. Put your head outside against their right ribs, on your left. Reach behind both knees with separate hands and bring your left foot up.

5. Pause at the leg capture without driving or lifting. Release, back out, and recover stance. Reset if their hands close the lane before entry.

Say "Elbows up, hips down." / "Pop and step together."

Common error Lifting at the wrists or pausing after the pop. **Correct it** Place palms above the elbows and connect the lift directly to the level change and step.

Drill / progress Take 3 slow entries each. Then alternate 4 x 20-second rounds, resting 40 seconds. Partner either presses back or withdraws the posts; attack the returning pressure and reset on withdrawal.

Watch / stop No face contact, shoulder wrenching, lifts, or takedown finishes in this entry drill. **Resources** B06-S1 / B06-S2 / B06-S3

B07 Double Leg Takedown

Purpose Finish a double leg by driving across the opponent and covering the hips. **Before teaching** B03; can receive a low side landing without posting a straight arm.

1. From a right-foot lead, clear their hands, lower your hips, and step your right foot between theirs. Touch your right knee softly down.

2. Keep your chest up and head on your left, snug against their right ribs. Cup their right knee with your left hand and their left knee with your right hand.

3. Step your left trail foot forward and outside their right foot. Push from it to bring your right knee off the mat.

4. Take short driving steps diagonally to your right across their stance. Press with your head and shoulder while gathering their knees toward your left; keep their far knee from escaping.

5. Receiver lowers onto their left hip and side without straight-arm posting. Follow above their hips, settle without dropping your weight, and reset on the coach's call.

Say "Chest up, trail foot up." / "Drive right; knees left."

Common error Attacker circles left around the head side or keeps driving straight. **Correct it** Freeze at entry; point out the right-hand corner, then step across it.

Drill / progress Alternate three cooperative finishes each. Then receiver may retreat one step before entry; attacker closes distance or resets. Add resistance after reliable landings.

Watch / stop Stop for head-down pressure, trapped-knee twisting, or straight-arm posting. No standing lift or dump. **Resources** B07-COLLEGE_PARK / B07-JOHN_WILL / B07-HORASKI_GARCIA / B07-USAW_GUIDE

B08 Single Leg Run the Pipe

Purpose Finish a head-inside single by lowering the captured-leg hip. **Before teaching** B03; coach-taught single-leg pickup and side-hip receiving.

1. For their right leg, keep your head inside, left temple at their right ribs. Wrap left arm outside and right arm inside; clasp behind the knee.

2. Stand with knees bent and their leg between your thighs, foot off the mat. Keep elbows close and your head up.

3. Your right foot is inside their captured leg. Step your outside left foot back and left, pivoting on the right.

4. Lower your hips as you turn left. Bring your left shoulder over their thigh and draw the held leg inward, guiding their right hip down.

5. Receiver turns hips and leg together and lowers onto the right side without a straight-arm post. Follow beside the hip, cover behind, and change from leg clasp to hip/arm control.

Say "Head inside; leg close." / "Step back, turn, hips down."

Common error Attacker circles upright and the receiver keeps hopping. **Correct it** Slow down; combine the backstep with lowering hips and shoulder pressure over the thigh.

Drill / progress Take 3 cooperative finishes each. Then take 3 each with the receiver making one small balancing step; finish or reset if alignment is lost.

Watch / stop Release for a planted or twisting captured leg, knee pressure, head-down collapse, or loss of landing control. No body lifts. **Resources** B08-S1 / B08-S2 / B08-S3 / B08-S4

B09 Sweep Single

Purpose Sweep outside one leg and finish by collecting the far knee. **Before teaching** B03-B04; coach teaches the outside swing step and side-hip receiving.

1. Lead right. Cup inside their right upper arm with your left hand; circle left and draw the arm until their left foot steps forward.

2. Lower, step your right foot outside their left foot, and wrap your right arm behind their left knee. Keep your head up, inside the thigh.

3. Touch your right knee softly and sweep your left leg around the outside toward their left rear corner. Release the arm tie; post your left hand for balance.

4. Keep your right shoulder behind their thigh, below the buttock. Transfer their lower leg to your left hand at the ankle; briefly post your right hand, then reach it between their legs behind their right knee.

5. Drive forward and draw the far knee toward you. Receiver bends and turns with the hips onto a side hip, without a stiff-arm post.

6. Follow behind their hips, release the leg grips, and settle into the taught top position.

Say "Sweep to the backside." / "Shoulder tight; catch the far knee."

Common error Attacker stops beside the leg and pulls sideways. **Correct it** Circle farther behind before reaching the far knee.

Drill / progress Do three slow finishes each from the backside, then three complete entries. Next, receiver may take one squaring step; finish only if the corner remains open, otherwise reset.

Watch / stop Stop for a planted, twisting knee, trapped foot, or lost head position. **Resources** B09-S1 / B09-S2 / B09-S3 / B09-S4

B10 Snap-Down Go-Behind

Purpose Pull a leaning opponent onto their hands, then get behind their hips. **Before teaching** B01-B02; partner can lower from stance onto hands and knees and release on command.

1. Put your right palm behind their head and your left hand around their right triceps, above the elbow. Keep your elbows bent.

2. As they lean into you, step back and lower your hips, pulling their head and arm toward you and down together.

3. Receiver lowers onto hands and knees with elbows able to bend and head clear of the mat. Keep your chest over their shoulders and feet back.

4. Release the right-hand collar tie. Turn your left hand to block their right triceps with the back of that hand, keeping chest contact.

5. Circle left around their right side. Reach your right hand to cup their right thigh; continue behind their hips and cover with hands separate.

Say "Step back and pull together." / "Block the arm; circle behind."

Common error Athlete lets go and races around while the partner turns to face. **Correct it** Keep chest contact and replace the arm grip with the block before circling.

Drill / progress Do 3 slow repetitions each from kneeling, then 3 from stance. Next, receiver may turn to face after touching the mat; attacker finishes or resets without increasing neck pressure.

Watch / stop Stop for neck pain, throat pressure, locked-arm landing, or head contact with the mat. **Resources** B10-S1 / B10-S2 / B10-S3 / B10-S4

B11 Sprawl and Go-Behind

Purpose Stop a leg attack, clear the hands, and take control behind the hips. **Before teaching** B01-B03; solo sprawl, stable receiving base, and coach-demonstrated top control.

1. On their low double-leg entry, extend both legs backward and lower your hips. Keep your chest over their upper back, head up.

2. Stay square and scoot back until both legs clear their hands. Keep knees off the mat and pressure through their shoulders, not their neck.

3. To go right, slide your right hand between your chest and their head; block their left triceps with the back of your hand.

4. Take short steps right around their left shoulder, maintaining chest contact. Reach your left hand to cup their left thigh above the knee.

5. Continue behind their hips, release the arm block, and settle with separate waist-and-arm control. Bring knees underneath after reaching the rear.

Say "Clear the legs first." / "Block the arm; circle to the hips."

Common error Defender circles early or lifts the chest, allowing another leg grab. **Correct it** Pause with legs free and chest connected; establish the arm block before stepping around.

Drill / progress Take 3 slow entries each; shooter releases and builds a base. Then use 4 x 15-second turns: shooter may circle on the knees to face; defender seeks rear control. Reset at control or separation.

Watch / stop No jumping onto the partner, head driven into the mat, forced arm twisting, or circling on a trapped leg. **Resources** B11-S1 / B11-S2 / B11-S3 / B11-S4

B12 Down Block and Circle

Purpose Keep a single-leg entry away from your leg and recover facing the attacker. **Before teaching** B01-B03: balanced stance, circling, and a partner who can stop a slow entry.

1. Start with your right foot forward. Your partner makes a slow single-leg entry toward that leg.

2. As the partner reaches, bend your knees and lower your hips. Drop your right hand toward the mat between the reaching arms and your right leg, making your forearm a barrier.

3. Simultaneously send your right leg straight back, balancing on your bent left leg. Keep your head up and left hand forward.

4. Once the leg is clear, set your right foot down with space between your feet. Lift the blocking hand and circle left with short steps, left foot first, turning to keep your chest facing your partner.

5. Finish in stance, both hands forward. The partner stops reaching and recovers stance; switch roles. Mirror the sequence later.

Say "Hand down, same leg back." / "Circle and face."

Common error The hand reaches down while the threatened foot stays planted. **Correct it** Rehearse the hand drop and leg withdrawal together before adding the partner.

Drill / progress Do three slow entries each. Then alternate one fake or one slow single; defend the entry and reset facing.

Watch / stop No striking or locked-elbow impact. If the attacker catches the leg, stop this rehearsal instead of twisting free. **Resources** B12-S1 / B12-S2 / B12-S3 / B12-S4

B13 Peek-Out Recovery

Purpose Clear your head after a stopped shot and recover an attacking position. **Before teaching** B03, B07 and B11; partner can receive a low double-leg finish.

1. Start on hands and knees after releasing a stopped shot. Partner faces you with light chest pressure over your shoulder blades and separate hands behind your upper arms; no locked head grip.

2. Keep your left palm on the mat. Step your right foot up outside your right elbow, shortening your stretched position.

3. Draw your right elbow back toward your hip. Slide your left knee underneath as your head comes out to your right, beneath partner's left upper arm.

4. Keep your left hand posted until your head clears. Bring your hips underneath and raise your chest; do not pull your neck upward against pressure.

5. Turn back toward partner and collect both knees, head on your right at their left ribs. Bring your right trail foot up and use B07's mirrored finish: drive left while gathering knees right.

6. Receiver follows onto the right hip and side without a straight-arm post. Settle above the hips and reset together.

Say "Post, step, elbow back." / "Head clear, hips in."

Common error Trying to stand while the head remains trapped. **Correct it** Return to the light starting cover; shorten your base and clear the head sideways first.

Drill / progress Take three cooperative repetitions each. Then use four 15-second rounds, swapping roles; partner adds one light sprawl and follows the recovery. Reset if the head cannot clear.

Watch / stop No elbow strikes, locked front headlocks, neck pressure, or forced twisting through a trapped arm. **Resources** B13-S1 / B13-S2 / B13-S3

B14 Referee's Bottom Start

Purpose Set up correctly for a folkstyle bottom start and wait for the whistle. **Before teaching** Can support a hands-and-knees base; coach confirms the event's starting procedure.

1. At the center marks, place both knees on the mat behind the rear starting line, with the knees parallel to that line.

2. Place the heels of both hands on the mat beyond the forward starting line. Keep both elbows off the mat.

3. Spread your supports for balance. Keep your head in line with your back and leave room for top to start legally on either side.

4. Become still before top takes position. Keep your hands and knees set through the referee's check; move only on the whistle.

5. For setup practice, top releases at the whistle and you rise to kneeling and reset. Later, connect the start to a taught escape.

Say "Knees behind; hand heels ahead." / "Still until the whistle."

Common error Fingertips cross the line but the heels of the hands stay behind it, or bottom rocks before the whistle. **Correct it** Check the base of each palm, then rehearse a still pause with an unpredictable whistle.

Drill / progress Make three solo setups, then three with a partner on each side. Top stays loose until the whistle. Progress to one taught escape action while top follows lightly; stop and reset.

Watch / stop Correct the setup before adding resistance. No pushing or squeezing before the whistle. **Resources** B14-S1 / B14-S2 / B14-S3 / B14-S4 / B14-S5

B15 Referee's Top Start

Purpose Take the standard folkstyle top start legally and respond to the whistle. **Before teaching** B14; partner can stay still in bottom position; coach confirms event rules.

1. Let bottom establish a legal, still base. Wait for the referee to direct you to take top; this example starts on bottom's left.

2. Put your left knee outside their left knee. Plant your right foot behind their feet, also on their left side. Keep your legs and feet clear of their body.

3. Rest your left palm lightly on the back of their left elbow. Wrap your right arm loosely across their waist, with your right palm covering the belly button.

4. Hold your head above the middle of their back. Support yourself without squeezing, pushing down or gripping the elbow.

5. Become still for the referee's check and 'set' command. Wait through the pause; move only on the whistle.

6. For setup practice, release both hands on the whistle and reset. Later, connect the whistle to a separately taught breakdown.

Say "Light palms; legs clear." / "Still until the whistle."

Common error Top touches bottom with a knee or foot, or squeezes before the whistle. **Correct it** Leave a visible gap around the legs and soften both hands before the coach checks the start.

Drill / progress Make three checked setups, then mirror on the right. Vary the whistle delay. Once consistent, bottom takes one small knee-slide after the whistle while top follows lightly; stop and reset.

Watch / stop No straddling or foot between bottom's legs. Reset early pressure or movement; stop for pain. **Resources** B15-S1 / B15-S2 / B15-S3 / B15-S4 / B15-S5 / B15-S6 / B15-S7 / B15-S8

B16 Belly to Base

Purpose Rebuild a wrestling base beneath a rider after being flattened. **Before teaching** B14 and solo belly-to-base recovery; partner can apply light pressure and release immediately.

1. Start belly down, arms free. Partner rides on your left with a loose waist hand and other palm on your upper back, supporting most weight on their knees.

2. Draw your elbows beside your ribs and place forearms beside your chest. Keep your face clear; do not reach backward for the rider.

3. Slide your right knee, away from the rider, forward alongside your hip. Keep your chest facing the mat.

4. Press through your forearms and move your hips back over that knee. Slide your left knee underneath as your belly lifts, then come onto your palms.

5. Finish with knees apart beneath hips and hands beneath shoulders, elbows slightly bent. Keep hips underneath and pressure back into the rider; reset or continue an already-taught escape.

Say "Outside knee up." / "Hips back; knees underneath."

Common error Pushing the chest up with straight arms while both legs trail behind. **Correct it** Reduce rider pressure; bring the outside knee forward before shifting hips back.

Drill / progress Do three cooperative recoveries each side. Then use four 15-second turns: top follows the hips with light forward pressure; bottom rebuilds base. Reset on recovery and swap roles.

Watch / stop Keep arms free and hands unclasped in this drill. No turns or leg rides. Release for face pressure, trapped limbs, or pain. **Resources** B16-S1 / B16-S2 / B16-S3

B17 Inside-Leg Stand-Up

Purpose Escape by controlling the waist hand, clearing your hips, and facing. **Before teaching** B14-B15; stable base and balanced rise/turn; partner can follow without a mat return.

1. Start in referee's position with the rider on your left. Your left leg is the inside leg; directions below are yours.

2. On the signal, plant your left foot beside your right knee. Lift your chest and bring your left elbow back toward their chest without striking.

3. At the same time, grasp their right hand at your belly with your right hand. Hold the whole hand near the wrist, not individual fingers.

4. Drive through your left foot and rise onto both feet, knees bent. Keep your left elbow close. Hold their hand away from your waist as you move your hips forward away from theirs.

5. Retain hand control and turn right to face, moving both feet with the turn. Finish in a low stance; release after separation and reset.

Say "Foot and chest up together." / "Control the hand; hips clear, face."

Common error Turning while the rider's arm still hugs your waist. **Correct it** Rehearse from standing: isolate the hand, create hip space, then turn.

Drill / progress Take three slow turns each. Then top follows one step toward your hips with light, separate-hand contact; regain space and face. Reset if stuck.

Watch / stop No finger peeling, wrist twisting, elbow strikes, lifting, or mat returns. **Resources** B17-S1 / B17-S2 / B17-S3 / B17-S4 / B17-S5

B18 Sit-Out

Purpose Create hip space and hand control for a later escape. **Before teaching** B14-B15 and P09; can sit gently without trapping a leg.

1. From base, top starts on your left, left hand at your elbow and right hand at your waist. Directions are yours; move on signal.

2. Cross your left hand in front of your right and plant that palm, clearing their elbow contact. Bring your right hand beside your right thigh, elbow close.

3. Step your right foot forward and outward. Push through that foot and left palm; slide your left leg underneath the raised right knee into a low seat.

4. Bring both knees into a bend, heels on the mat and chest up. Cover their right wrist at your waist with your right hand; bring your left elbow against your ribs. Keep light shoulder pressure back into the rider.

5. Pause balanced. Both release, then reset separately to base. Sitting alone is not an escape; B19 adds the finish.

Say "Foot out, leg through." / "Elbows in, chest up."

Common error Reaching back with a straight arm while falling into the seat. **Correct it** Shorten the step and lower slowly; return the posting hand to your side once balanced.

Drill / progress Alternate three cooperative repetitions. Then top lightly follows and reaches toward the left ribs; bottom closes that elbow and keeps the waist wrist in front. Freeze and reset each repetition.

Watch / stop No chops, pullbacks, rolls, or head posts. Release for trapped knees, shoulder strain, or loss of balance. **Resources** B18-S1 / B18-S2 / B18-S3 / B18-S4

B19 Hip-Heist Escape

Purpose Clear a waist ride and escape facing your partner. **Before teaching** B18 short sit; pain-free solo hip heist and hand clearing.

1. Start in a short sit, knees bent and feet close. Top kneels behind with light, unlinked waist contact.

2. Use both hands to control the whole waist hand near its wrist and move it off your abdomen. Keep elbows close; press shoulders back as your hips gain space.

3. Once the waist hand is clear, release it. For a left heist, post your left palm beside and slightly behind your hip and plant your right foot. Keep your head off the mat.

4. Lift your hips enough to sweep your left leg underneath. Turn left, stepping your right leg over the sweeping leg; turn chest toward the mat without a shoulder roll.

5. Reposition your hands as you turn and bring your knees underneath, facing your partner. Move backward until free of their hands, then rise into stance with hands forward. If they keep control, rebuild base and reset.

Say "Clear hands, then heist." / "One leg under, one over."

Common error Turning while the waist hand still holds, or rolling across a shoulder. **Correct it** Clear the hand first; rehearse the low leg sweep slowly before adding a partner.

Drill / progress Do 3 solo turns each side, then 3 cooperative escapes each. Progress to 4 x 15 seconds: top follows on knees and tries to retain waist contact; bottom clears and faces. Rest 30 seconds and swap roles.

Watch / stop No finger peeling or head-supported turn. Top releases at separation. Stop for a trapped leg or wrist/shoulder strain. **Resources** B19-HK / B19-WEBER / B19-MAL / B19-HG / B19-USAW

B20 Switch

Purpose Reverse from bottom to control behind the rider. **Before teaching** B18-B19; can sit and scissor the hips without a locked-arm post.

1. Start on hands and knees with the rider on your left, their right arm around your waist and left hand at your left elbow.

2. Sweep your left hand across to clear their elbow contact. Step your right foot up and slide your left leg through into a short sit on your right buttock.

3. Catch their right wrist at your belly with your left hand. Reach your right arm over their right upper arm and between their legs; cup inside their right thigh above the knee.

4. Keep your chest over your hips. Raise your hips and turn right toward their right hip, moving your hips away as your right upper arm presses their right shoulder downward.

5. Scissor your left leg over your right and come onto your knees behind their hips. Release the wrist as their waist arm clears; replace the thigh grip with a waist-and-arm ride, hands separate.

Say "Thigh, not back." / "Hips away; turn behind."

Common error Bottom reaches over the back or stays seated and pulls on the arm. **Correct it** Reset the inside-thigh grip; lift and turn the hips before adding pressure.

Drill / progress Do three slow switches each. Rider follows onto knees and frees the waist arm. Then rider may circle to stay behind; reset at rear control or a blocked turn.

Watch / stop Stop for a trapped shoulder or knee. Never twist the wrist or force the arm behind the back. **Resources** B20-S1 / B20-S2 / B20-S3 / B20-S4 / B20-S5 / B20-S6

B21 Stand-Up Finish

Purpose Clear rear waist contact and finish the stand-up facing your opponent. **Before teaching** B17's balanced standing position; both partners can follow and release on command.

1. Start standing after B17 with the rider behind you. Directions are yours. Keep knees bent, feet apart, and your weight over your own feet.

2. Keep your right hand around their right hand near the wrist, as in B17. Keep your left elbow close; the rider's hands remain separate.

3. Hold their captured hand away from your waist and move your hips forward away from theirs. Clear their right arm from your right hip before turning; do not wrench the wrist.

4. Retain the hand and turn right to face, moving your feet with your hips. Keep the left hand available to protect your legs.

5. Finish in a low stance facing the rider. Once rear contact is gone, release the hand and reset. The rider follows on their feet without pulling the arm back.

Say "Hand off; hips clear." / "Keep the hand; turn right."

Common error Spinning while the rider's arm still surrounds the hip. **Correct it** Pause standing; isolate the hand and restore hip space before turning.

Drill / progress Take three slow finishes each. Then rider follows one step with light waist contact; bottom regains space and faces. Reset if stuck.

Watch / stop No finger peeling, wrist twisting, lifting, or mat returns. Stop for lost balance. **Resources** B21-S1 / B21-S2 / B21-S3

B22 Tight Waist Chop

Purpose Break bottom's base, then secure wrist control. **Before teaching** B14-B15; bottom can lower onto forearms and belly without stiff-arm posting.

1. Start legally on bottom's left: left hand at their left elbow, right hand at their navel. Wait for the whistle.

2. Draw your right waist arm snug around their belly. Keep hands separate and your chest behind their shoulders.

3. Bring your left forearm against the outside of their left arm at the elbow. Fold that elbow inward toward their belly with a short motion, without striking.

4. Simultaneously drive forward from your toes; bring your rear right knee against their buttocks to move their hips over the folding arm.

5. Bottom bends the elbow and lowers onto forearms, then belly. Follow with your feet and chest.

6. Catch their left wrist with your right waist hand across the belly; your left hand controls their left upper arm. Keep the wrist below their chest and follow their hips. Release on command.

Say "Drive forward as the elbow folds." / "Chop, catch the wrist, follow."

Common error Top pulls the elbow sideways while sitting back. **Correct it** Reset; use a small arm fold with forward toe pressure and the rear knee moving the hips.

Drill / progress Take three slow repetitions each. Then bottom may rebuild once; top follows with wrist control. Stop and switch.

Watch / stop Release for elbow or shoulder pain. No blows, forced straight-arm collapse, wrist twisting, or neck pressure. **Resources** B22-S1 / B22-S2 / B22-S3 / B22-S4 / B22-S5

B23 Near Ankle Breakdown

Purpose Break bottom's base with a tight waist, ankle control, and forward pressure. **Before teaching** B15 top start and B16 base recovery; both partners can lower to their belly and release on signal.

1. Start on bottom's left side in referee's top position. Wait for the signal.

2. Keep your right arm snug around the waist, palm across the belly. Move your left hand from their elbow to cup their left ankle just above the heel.

3. Step around behind their hips. Lift the ankle forward toward their seat while driving forward from your toes, chest on their back and head behind their shoulders.

4. Keep the ankle aligned with its knee as their body moves forward. Bottom bends the elbows and lowers through forearms to belly, keeping the face clear.

5. As their hips settle, lower and release the ankle. Follow their hips, collect a wrist without wrenching the arm, and reset on signal.

Say "Ankle forward; chest forward." / "Flat: release and control."

Common error Top pulls backward with the arm while the feet stop moving. **Correct it** Reset the grip, move behind the hips, and use short forward driving steps.

Drill / progress Do three cooperative repetitions each. Then alternate four 15-second rounds: bottom slowly rebuilds the base; top attempts one breakdown. Reset if the ankle slips free.

Watch / stop No toe twisting, sideways knee pressure, forced heel-to-seat bending, or lifting the thigh against a flat pelvis. Release for pain. **Resources** B23-S1 / B23-S2 / B23-S3 / B23-S4

B24 Spiral Breakdown

Purpose Stretch the base and capture the near wrist. **Before teaching** B14-B16; receive chest pressure onto a forearm without locking the elbow.

1. Start on your partner's left in referee's top position. Apply pressure after the signal.

2. Slide your left forearm under their left armpit, with the base of your hand supporting the upper arm. Move your right hand from the waist to the inside of their right thigh, away from the groin.

3. Rise onto your feet, knees off the mat. Keep chest contact high on their back, head behind their shoulders, and hips following your chest.

4. Walk your feet outward to the left and around toward their head. Drive their left upper arm forward and press their right thigh backward while maintaining chest pressure.

5. As their left elbow lowers, capture their left wrist with your left hand. Return your right arm to waist control and follow as they settle belly-down. Release on the coach's signal.

Say "Arm forward, far thigh back." / "Feet circle; chest stays heavy."

Common error Top pulls with the arms while sitting on both knees. **Correct it** Rise onto the toes, reconnect the chest, and circle before adding arm pressure.

Drill / progress Do three slow repetitions each, bottom yielding onto a forearm. Then bottom may widen the knees and rebuild base; top has ten seconds to capture the wrist. Switch roles.

Watch / stop Keep contact off the throat and groin. Stop for a locked elbow, shoulder pain, trapped knee, or face pressure. **Resources** B24-S1 / B24-S2 / B24-S3 / B24-S4

B25 Near Wrist Ride

Purpose Keep one arm trapped under the body while maintaining top control. **Before teaching** B15 and a taught breakdown; both can receive pressure and release immediately.

1. Start on their left after a breakdown. Partner lies belly-down, arms forward. Face their head; keep yours behind their shoulders.

2. Reach your left arm under their left upper arm and take an overhand grip around their left wrist. Your left hand controls their left wrist; keep the hand and forearm aligned.

3. Keep your right arm around their waist, hands separate. Stay chest-to-back and use your feet to drive their body forward over the held wrist, bringing it beneath their belly.

4. Maintain shoulder pressure and a wide base. Take small following steps as they move their hips; keep the wrist underneath rather than pulling the arm behind their back.

5. Finish with them belly-down and you balanced above. Ease pressure, open your grip, and let them bring the arm forward before resetting.

Say "Left hand, left wrist." / "Drive the body over the wrist."

Common error Top yanks the wrist backward while leaving their own weight behind. **Correct it** Shorten the grip distance and advance with the feet and chest.

Drill / progress Take three cooperative captures each. Then use four 15-second rounds: bottom slowly brings knees underneath to rebuild; top follows and maintains the ride. Reset if the wrist clears; swap roles.

Watch / stop Release for wrist bending, trapped-arm strain, or stop signals. No finger pulling, arm-on-back turn, or forced roll. **Resources** B25-S1 / B25-S2 / B25-S3 / B25-S4

B26 Half Nelson

Purpose Turn a belly-down opponent onto their back and settle chest to chest. **Before teaching** B22; both partners can stop, release, and receive a slow shoulder turn.

1. Start beside their left shoulder after the breakdown, facing the same direction, chest on their upper back.

2. Slide your left arm under their left armpit, palm on the back of their head. Reach your right hand beneath their chest to block their far, right elbow from posting.

3. Lift your left elbow beneath their upper arm while keeping their head down. Walk your feet out to their left and toward their head until your bodies make a T.

4. Drive from your toes through your chest to turn them onto their right side. Shoulder and torso must rotate together; stop if the body cannot turn.

5. As they turn, slide the half deeper behind their head. Settle chest to chest, hips low and feet wide. Release on the coach's signal.

Say "Elbow up; feet to the head." / "Chest across; hips down."

Common error Top stays parallel and tries to win by pushing harder on the head. **Correct it** Reset the half, step out to a T, and move the torso with chest pressure.

Drill / progress Trade three slow turns, receiver following the roll. Then bottom may close the near elbow before insertion; top resets a blocked attempt.

Watch / stop Release for neck or shoulder pain, a trapped body, or the defender's elbow being forced behind their head. Never add a second half. **Resources** B26-S1 / B26-S2 / B26-S3 / B26-S4 / B26-S5 / B26-S6 / B26-S7

B27 Early Half Nelson Defense

Purpose Stop a basic half before the opponent establishes turning pressure. **Before teaching** B16 base recovery; coach demonstrates a loose half and immediate release.

1. Start belly-down. Your partner begins threading a loose half under your left armpit. All left/right directions below are yours.

2. Draw your left elbow toward your ribs, closing the armpit. Keep that shoulder and hip low instead of letting the upper arm rise.

3. While your neck is still free, keep your head clear of the mat and look right, away from the half. Do not force the head against pressure.

4. If their hand reaches your head, use your left hand to cup and peel their whole hand off. Avoid individual fingers; return your left elbow close to your side.

5. Keep their hand away while bringing one knee, then the other, beneath your hips. Once the threading arm is clear, recover forearms or hands beneath your shoulders and reset in base.

Say "Elbow in; look away early." / "Same hand peels; then build."

Common error Defender lifts the half-side elbow high while reaching to peel. **Correct it** Rehearse closing the armpit first; make a short peel with the upper arm close.

Drill / progress Do 3 slow repetitions each side. Then top chooses either side for one light insertion; bottom clears and builds base. Reset before turning pressure develops.

Watch / stop If the half is tight or the head cannot move freely, stop and have top release. No forced neck rotation. **Resources** B27-S1 / B27-S2 / B27-S3

B28 Half Nelson Pin Finish

Purpose Keep both shoulders near the mat after a half nelson turn. **Before teaching** B26 half nelson turn and receiving; immediate release on stop or tap.

1. Begin just after the turn. For a left-arm half, keep your left arm under their left upper arm and your palm behind their head. Their upper arm stays inside the half.

2. Hold their right wrist with your right hand and keep that arm close to their trunk. Keep your hands separate; do not clasp around the head.

3. Set your chest across their upper chest, with your body perpendicular to theirs. Spread your feet, extend your legs back and lower your hips gradually; keep your head up.

4. As they make a small shoulder turn, adjust your feet to keep your chest over their shoulders. If the arm slips out or the neck twists, release and reset.

5. On stop, ease chest pressure, release the wrist, slide the half arm out and move clear. Mirror the grips for a right-arm half.

Say "Arm stays in the half." / "Chest across; feet wide."

Common error High hips and a narrow base let the receiver roll the top wrestler over. **Correct it** Spread the feet and settle the hips back while keeping chest contact.

Drill / progress Alternate three cooperative placements, then three five-second holds each. Receiver makes one gentle turn toward the belly, without a neck bridge; top follows with the feet. Reset after every hold.

Watch / stop Release immediately for a tap, stop call, throat pressure, breathing difficulty or neck/shoulder pain. **Resources** B28-S1 / B28-S2 / B28-S3 / B28-S4 / B28-S5

B29 Near-Side Cradle

Purpose Connect the head and near knee, then turn the opponent over the far hip. **Before teaching** B15; coach verifies receiving, palm-to-palm grip, and a stable, pain-free forehead post with the neck aligned.

1. Start beside their left side, facing their ribs. Bottom holds a compact base with the left knee already within reach of the head.

2. Reach your left arm over their head, elbow bend behind the neck. Scoop your right arm behind their left knee; keep the throat clear.

3. Move chest and head close to their left side. Join palms near their head, thumbs alongside fingers. If you cannot connect without forcing the bend, reset.

4. Push from your feet toward their right hip, away from you. Scoop their left shoulder upward with your chest; bottom turns onto the right hip and back without stiff-arm posting.

5. Follow chest to chest with feet wide and hips low. Post the center of your forehead on the mat, keeping the cradle connected and pressure on the shoulders.

6. Pause for the coach's check; open your hands before bottom unfolds and rebuilds base.

Say "Head and near knee; palms together." / "Drive away; chest follows."

Common error Pulling the head toward the knee while the feet stay still. **Correct it** Close your body position and drive with the legs; reset if the lock requires forcing.

Drill / progress Three cooperative turns each. Then four attempts each: bottom may extend the near leg before the clasp; top connects or resets.

Watch / stop Release for throat pressure, forced neck bending, knee twisting, or either wrestler bearing weight on a bent neck. **Resources** B29-S1 / B29-S2 / B29-S3 / B29-S4

B30 Early Cradle Defense

Purpose Prevent a near-side cradle and recover your bottom base. **Before teaching** B16 base recovery; B29 attack recognition and immediate release on command.

1. Start on hands and knees with the attacker on your left. They reach around your head and behind your left knee; their hands are still apart.

2. Send your left foot backward as you lower your left hip toward the mat. Keep your right knee bent for support and your face off the mat.

3. During that action, catch their head-arm hand in front of your chest with both hands around the whole hand and wrist. Keep elbows close and their hands separated.

4. Keep hand control and raise your head and chest as the loose head wrap clears. Once your head and left knee are free, post one hand and bring the left knee underneath to rebuild base.

5. If their hands connect, freeze and have the attacker release for this drill. Mirror the same sequence on the other side.

Say "Near leg back, near hip down." / "Catch the hand; head up."

Common error Kicking backward with the hips high, or bringing the knee back before clearing the head. **Correct it** Rehearse leg-back and hip-down together; regain head clearance before rebuilding.

Drill / progress Do 3 slow repetitions each. Then alternate 4 x 15-second rounds, resting 30 seconds. Top makes one light reach to connect; bottom prevents the lock and rebuilds. Stop at connection or recovered base.

Watch / stop Before-lock defense only. No force against a locked cradle, neck bridge, or twisting a trapped knee. **Resources** B30-S1 / B30-S2 / B30-S3 / B30-S4

A01 Russian Tie to Single Leg

Purpose Use a two-on-one to collect the near leg. **Before teaching** B08; wrist control, single-leg pickup, and side-hip receiving.

1. Partner posts right hand on your left shoulder. Grip their wrist with your right hand, palm down; roll their forearm down until your palm faces up.

2. Cup beneath their right armpit with your left palm up. Step left beside their right side; keep the arm against your chest and head inside.

3. Place your left foot, toes up, behind their right ankle. Keep your right foot underneath; press their ribs away with your left forearm to lighten that leg.

4. Lower, release the wrist, and scoop behind their right knee with your right arm from inside. Unhook your foot; release their upper arm and wrap your left arm outside the thigh.

5. Clasp behind their knee; collect the leg between your thighs, foot low. Keep your left temple at their right ribs.

6. Finish B08: left foot back-left, pivot on right, lower hips and left shoulder over the thigh. Receiver turns onto the right hip; follow behind and cover.

Say "Block, shift, collect." / "Free the foot before turning."

Common error Lifting a loaded leg with the arms. **Correct it** Shift weight onto their left leg before collecting.

Drill / progress Three cooperative entries each, then three finishes. Next, defender may withdraw the near foot before the block; attacker collects only if available, otherwise resets.

Watch / stop No wrist cranking, ankle kicking, planted-knee twisting, stiff-arm landings, or body lifts. **Resources** A01-S1 / A01-S2 / A01-S3 / A01-S4 / A01-S5

A02 Underhook Knee Pick

Purpose Move the opponent's torso past a blocked far knee and finish on top. **Before teaching** Underhook control, level changes, side landings, and covering from top.

1. Your right arm underhooks their left arm, hand curled over their left shoulder from behind. Keep your head inside beside their left temple; your left hand controls their right elbow.

2. Start angled at their left side, their right knee within reach. Bend your knees, head against their chest.

3. Release the elbow. Cup the outside of their right knee with your left hand, fingers around the back. Block; do not lift.

4. Step your right foot across their front toward that knee. Keep the underhook; drive your shoulder across toward their right side. Follow with short steps, feet apart.

5. Partner yields onto the right hip without a stiff-arm post. Follow beside their hips and release the knee. As they turn belly-down, circle behind to waist and near-arm control, hands apart.

Say "Block the knee; move the body." / "Step across and keep driving."

Common error Reaching from too far away and pulling the knee. **Correct it** Reset closer with an angle; lower before reaching and drive with the feet.

Drill / progress Alternate three cooperative finishes. Then partner may withdraw the target leg before contact; attacker resets if it escapes. Once blocked, partner yields and turns belly-down for the cover.

Watch / stop Do not pin the foot, twist the knee, or crank the shoulder. **Resources** A02-S1 / A02-S2 / A02-S3

A03 Underhook Duck Under

Purpose Use an underhook to get behind; this drill stops standing. **Before teaching** Pummeling, balanced level changes, and releasing a blocked shoulder.

1. Start over-under: your left arm under their right armpit, palm on upper back; your right arm overhooks their left upper arm. Left foot leads; head starts on your right side.

2. As they swim their right arm inside for an underhook, raise your left elbow to open space beneath their right upper arm.

3. Lower your hips through bent knees. Step your left foot past the outside of their right foot toward their back; pass your head under their right arm, staying close.

4. Bring your head up behind their right shoulder. Release your right overhook, circle your right foot behind, and bring both arms around their waist.

5. Stop chest-to-back with both wrestlers balanced on their feet. Make light palm-to-palm waist contact, release, and face each other.

Say "Hips down, step behind." / "Head through, then up."

Common error Trying to lift a closed arm without lowering the hips. **Correct it** Reset; wait for the pummel and lower as the opening appears.

Drill / progress Three slow repetitions each. Then four 15-second rounds, resting 30 seconds: partner either pummels or keeps the elbow closed. Attack the opening; otherwise reset. Alternate roles.

Watch / stop No forced shoulder opening, neck compression, lift, trip, or mat return. **Resources** A03-S1 / A03-S2 / A03-S3 / A03-S4

A04 High Crotch to Double

Purpose Change a head-outside high crotch into a double-leg finish. **Before teaching** B03 and B07, including B07's mirrored finish and right-side receiving.

1. Use a left-foot lead. From a cleared tie, lower and step your left foot between theirs, bringing your left knee softly down.

2. Shoot your left arm between their thighs around their left leg, behind the knee. Join your right hand from outside. Keep your head up on your right, outside their left hip, with your shoulder tight.

3. Step your right trail foot forward outside their left foot. Drive up off your knee with hips underneath; keep both hands on their left leg until it becomes light.

4. Keep your right hand behind their left knee. Release your inside left hand and catch behind their far right knee; keep elbows close.

5. Drive diagonally left across their stance and gather their knees right. Receiver lowers onto their right hip and side without a straight-arm post. Follow over their hips, settle, and reset.

Say "Drive up before changing hands." / "Left hand changes; drive left."

Common error Reaching for the far knee while stretched on the mat. **Correct it** Recover the trail foot, bring hips in, and unload the near leg first.

Drill / progress Alternate three cooperative conversions from a low high-crotch start. Then defender retreats one step before entry; close distance or reset.

Watch / stop Stop for neck compression, trapped-knee twisting, or rigid posting. No standing body lift or dump. **Resources** A04-USAW_INSIDE / A04-USAW_CHANGE / A04-HORASKI_GARCIA / A04-COLLEGE_PARK

A05 Single Leg to Double

Purpose Finish when the defender moves the captured leg outside your legs. **Before teaching** B08 single-leg position; B07 receiving; coach-checked leg support.

1. Hold their right leg between your thighs, hands clasped above the knee, head inside at their right ribs, left foot forward.

2. Receiver moves their right foot outside your left thigh, turning the whole leg together. Follow without twisting it.

3. Raise their right thigh against your left hip with your left arm. Unclasp your right hand; their weight settles onto their left leg.

4. Bend your knees, keep your head up against their chest, and reach your right hand around the outside of their left knee to block it.

5. Push from your left foot; step your right foot through past their left-leg side. Drive across their stance that way, head and chest together; keep supporting their right leg.

6. Receiver lowers onto their left side without straight-arm posting. Follow beside the hips, lower the held leg, then release and cover.

Say "Leg outside: lift and block." / "Right foot through; chest follows."

Common error Reaching for the far knee while leaving the hips behind. **Correct it** Freeze at the knee block; bring the right foot and hips through before adding speed.

Drill / progress Take 3 cooperative conversions each. Then alternate 4 attempts: receiver either leaves the leg inside for B08 or moves it outside for this finish.

Watch / stop Stop for trapped toes, knee twisting, head-down pressure, or loss of receiving control. No separate body lift or dump. **Resources** A05-TRASSO / A05-COLLEGE_PARK / A05-FUJI / A05-USAW_GUIDE

A06 Backside Single Finish

Purpose Shelf one leg and collect the other to finish behind the hips. **Before teaching** B09 on both sides; secure thigh control and cooperative hands-and-knee receiving.

1. Start behind their right hip. Partner supports on both hands and left knee; your left arm hugs their right thigh, with your head up beside their hip.

2. Put your left knee behind their right knee and plant your right foot. Cup their right ankle with your right hand and guide their foot onto your right thigh.

3. Once your thigh supports the foot, release the ankle and wrap your right arm around their far, left thigh. Keep the near thigh with your left arm.

4. Press your shoulder into their buttocks and move forward through their hips, gathering both thighs. Partner bends their elbows and lowers toward their belly.

5. Lower the supported leg as their hips settle. Follow behind into top control, free the shelf, then release and reset.

Say "Shelf first, then far thigh." / "Shoulder pressure; follow the hips."

Common error Reaching for the waist before controlling the far leg. **Correct it** Keep the shelf and collect the far thigh before covering.

Drill / progress Three cooperative repetitions each. Then four 15-second rounds: defender takes one small squaring step before the shelf; attacker finishes or resets if the corner closes. Rest 30 seconds; alternate roles.

Watch / stop Release for a twisting knee, trapped foot, or head loading. No body lift. **Resources** A06-S1 / A06-S2 / A06-S3

A07 Sweep Single Recovery

Purpose Recover an angle and finish when a sprawl stops your sweep single. **Before teaching** B09 on both sides; hand-supported circling and the A06 backside finish.

1. Against a sprawl on their right leg, keep your head inside and left arm behind their right knee. Open the handlock; post your right palm.

2. Push through your toes, lift your knees, and circle around their right leg to their right hip. Keep the knee attached; move your feet instead of reaching.

3. Set your left knee behind their right knee and plant your right foot. Partner supports on both hands and their left knee.

4. Your right hand cups their right ankle and guides their foot onto your right thigh. Their knee travels with the leg.

5. Release the supported ankle and collect their far thigh. Keep the near thigh with your left arm; press your shoulder into their buttocks and follow forward. Lower the leg as their hips settle; cover behind and release.

Say "Feet circle; knee stays close." / "Shelf first, then cover."

Common error Pulling upward while stretched beneath the sprawl. **Correct it** Post the free hand and circle to the hip before shelving.

Drill / progress Three light repetitions each. Then four 15-second rounds: defender sprawls and takes one squaring step; attacker finds the corner or resets. Rest 30 seconds; alternate roles.

Watch / stop Reset if the corner closes, the knee twists, or the neck bears weight. No body lift. **Resources** A07-S1 / A07-S2 / A07-S3 / A07-S4

A08 Down Block to Ankle Reattack

Purpose Turn a blocked sweep single into an ankle entry. **Before teaching** B12 on the left side; balanced circling and stoppable sweep-single entries.

1. Lead with your left foot, left hand low. Partner makes a slow sweep single toward your left leg.

2. Lower your hips, drop your left forearm between their reach and your leg, and withdraw that leg. Your right palm checks their left shoulder to keep space.

3. Plant your left foot under your hips, feet apart. As they keep pressing, guide their left shoulder across your front and step right around that shoulder; keep facing them.

4. Release the blocking arm and follow their turn. Lower beside their left hip, cup their left ankle with your right hand, and place your left palm on their back. Stay close rather than reaching.

5. Stop at the ankle catch, head lifted and partner on hands and knees. Release, regain stance, and swap roles. This drill stops before the takedown finish.

Say "Block, plant, redirect." / "Follow the ankle with your feet."

Common error Reaching for the ankle while the withdrawn leg remains stretched behind. **Correct it** Slow down and restore the foot underneath before stepping around.

Drill / progress Three cooperative entries each. Then partner either keeps pressing or withdraws: reattack the pressure; recover stance on withdrawal.

Watch / stop Stop for a caught leg, tangled knees, or neck pressure. No ankle twisting or kick-out resistance. **Resources** A08-MARTINEZ / A08-USAW_SKILLS / A08-COLLEGE_PARK

A09 Standing Whizzer Defense

Purpose Stop a standing head-inside single and regain stance when the grip opens. **Before teaching** Single-leg balance, a coach-checked overhook, and immediate partner release.

1. Partner holds your right thigh above the knee, head inside at your ribs, captured foot low between their legs.

2. Your right arm overhooks their left upper arm; keep your elbow near your ribs, forearm hooked behind their arm.

3. Move your bent right leg as a unit outside their left leg, resting your shin against their outer thigh above the knee.

4. Your left hand grips their right wrist. Keep your head up at their head's height.

5. Hop toward them from your left foot, bringing your right hip into contact. Partner steps with you and releases before losing balance.

6. When the grip opens, lower your foot underneath, release the whizzer, and recover stance. If it stays closed, hold balance and reset.

Say "Shin outside; head up." / "Drive from the free foot."

Common error Pulling the arm while the hips hang away. **Correct it** Rebuild shin contact and move your whole body with the supporting foot.

Drill / progress Three cooperative starts each; then four 10-second rounds. Attacker takes one slow circling step with light grip; reset on release or the whistle.

Watch / stop No shoulder wrench, planted-knee twist, high lift, kick, or throw. **Resources** A09-S1 / A09-S2 / A09-S3

A10 Limp Arm

Purpose Slip a whizzer from the mat and circle behind. **Before teaching** B09; coach-checked low seatbelt position, light whizzer, and immediate release.

1. Start beside their right side, both facing almost the same way. Your left arm passes under their right armpit across their back; their right arm overhooks it. The leg is released.

2. Keep your left knee down, right foot wide, and hips slightly apart. Partner posts their right knee, left foot, and left hand. Keep your head beside their shoulder, off the mat.

3. Reach your right hand underneath to hold their right wrist. Press gently into them; partner gives light pressure back.

4. Turn your left palm up and draw your left elbow forward out of their armpit, letting the hand trail along your side. Move your torso with the elbow.

5. Keep their right wrist directed forward as the elbow clears. Circle around their right hip, bring your left hand to their waist, and settle behind their hips with separate hands. Partner follows onto hands and knees; release on reset.

Say "Outside foot up." / "Wrist forward; elbow free."

Common error Trying to circle behind while the elbow remains caught. **Correct it** Pause at the clearance; shorten the arm path and lower resistance.

Drill / progress Three slow clears each, then three go-behinds. Next, partner either gives light inward pressure or squares early; clear the first, reset the second.

Watch / stop Stop for shoulder strain; no jumping over an intact whizzer or straight-arm pulling. **Resources** A10-S1 / A10-S2 / A10-S3

A11 Single Leg Kickout

Purpose Free a low standing single by lifting the elbows and returning the foot to the mat. **Before teaching** Coach-taught single-leg pickup, one-leg balance, and immediate partner release.

1. Partner holds your right leg just above the knee, head inside at your right ribs, captured foot low between their thighs.

2. Cup behind their left elbow with your right hand and behind their right elbow with your left. Hold the upper arms, not the fingers.

3. Keep your head up and chest facing them. Bend your supporting left knee; take small balance hops if needed.

4. Pull both elbows upward while lowering your right leg down and back through the opening. Let the knee straighten naturally; do not yank sideways.

5. Once the foot clears, set it behind your left foot. Push away at their upper arms, release, and recover a staggered stance facing them.

6. If the leg stays trapped or either wrestler loses balance, stop and reset. Do not keep kicking against a closed grip.

Say "Elbows up, leg down." / "Foot back; face them."

Common error Pulling the leg sideways before creating an opening. **Correct it** Use a lighter grip; coordinate the elbow lift with the downward leg action.

Drill / progress Three cooperative clears each. Then three attempts with one slow circling step by the holder. Clear or reset; swap roles each attempt.

Watch / stop No knee twisting, strikes, finger peeling, or high-leg starts. **Resources** A11-S1 / A11-S2 / A11-S3

A12 Front Headlock Drag-Out

Purpose Escape an opponent's front headlock and work behind their hips. **Before teaching** Coach-checked chin-and-arm control, kneeling balance, head clearance, and top control.

1. Start kneeling with your head under their right armpit. Their right hand cups your chin; their left holds your right triceps. Keep the practice grip loose.

2. Reach your right hand under their left forearm and across to cup their right triceps above the elbow. Keep your pulling elbow close.

3. Plant your left foot outside their right knee. Draw their right arm across your chest while moving left around their right leg and turning your hips.

4. Let your head slip outside their right elbow as your body turns. Once clear, reach your left hand around their right thigh above the knee; stay close.

5. Continue behind their hips, release the elbow, and establish separate waist-and-arm control. Reset if your head or right arm remains trapped.

Say "Step outside; drag across." / "Clear the head; collect the thigh."

Common error Pulling with the arms while both knees stay planted. **Correct it** Pause at the outside step, then move your hips with the drag.

Drill / progress Three loose-grip repetitions each. Then four 15-second turns: holder may follow to face but releases the chin as the head clears. Reset at rear control or a blocked exit; alternate roles.

Watch / stop No throat pressure, neck twisting, arm wrenching, or forced escape through a closed grip. **Resources** A12-S1 / A12-S2 / A12-S3

A13 Russian Tie Clear to Underhook

Purpose Clear a Russian and gain an underhook; stop standing. **Before teaching** Russian ties, pummeling, balanced footwork, and release.

1. Partner holds your right arm in a Russian: their right palm supports your wrist; their left palm cups beneath your upper arm. They stand beside your right side with light grips.

2. Put your free left hand beneath their right elbow - the wrist-gripping arm. Lift that elbow up and away from their body.

3. As the wrist grip loosens, draw your right hand down and across toward their left armpit. Swim your right arm under their left upper arm, placing your hand near the middle of their back.

4. Move your feet to face them, knees bent and feet apart. Bring your head inside beside their left temple. Release your left-hand elbow contact once your right arm is clear.

5. Pause in the underhook, then release and return to stance. If the grip stays locked or the elbow is unavailable, stop and reset instead of wrenching the shoulder.

Say "Lift the elbow; free your wrist." / "Hand free, then underhook."

Common error Lifting the arm at your shoulder while your wrist stays trapped. **Correct it** Find the hand holding your wrist and follow that arm to its elbow.

Drill / progress Three slow clears each. Then partner either leaves the right elbow accessible or tucks it early; clear or reset. Stop standing.

Watch / stop No sudden yanks, finger peeling, shoulder cranking, lift, or throw. **Resources** A13-S1 / A13-S2 / A13-S3 / A13-S4 / A13-S5

A14 Stand-Up Hand Fighting

Purpose Deny a new waist grip and finish your stand-up facing the rider. **Before teaching** B17 Inside-Leg Stand-Up and B21 Stand-Up Finish; balanced standing and prompt partner release.

1. Start standing after B17, rider behind you. Bend your knees, keep feet apart, and support your own weight.

2. Retain your right-hand grip around their right hand near the wrist. Keep their hand off your waist and left elbow close.

3. The rider reaches their free left hand under your left arm toward your belly. Respond before they secure a grip.

4. Keep your left elbow near your ribs. Sweep your left palm and forearm across the reaching hand, guiding it outward past your left hip; close your elbow against your side. Keep the right-hand grip.

5. Move your hips forward away from theirs and clear their right arm from your right hip. Retain the hand and turn right, moving both feet.

6. Finish low and facing. Release after rear contact is gone. Reset if the rider secures a wrist or body lock.

Say "Elbow in; sweep the reach out." / "Keep the hand; hips clear, face."

Common error Reaching backward and opening the left elbow to chase the hand. **Correct it** Bring the clear back beside your ribs; sweep only the incoming arm.

Drill / progress Take three slow clears each. Then rider follows and reaches once without warning. Add B17's left-foot rise last.

Watch / stop No strikes, finger peeling, wrist twisting, lifts, trips, or mat returns. **Resources** A14-S1 / A14-S2 / A14-S3 / A14-S4

A15 Sit-Out to Stand-Up

Purpose Use forward riding pressure to rise from a short sit and escape. **Before teaching** B18's compact seat and B21's hand-controlled finish; painless squat and safe partner following.

1. Begin in B18's short sit, rider behind your left side. Directions are yours. Keep shoulders over hips, knees bent, and feet planted close to your seat.

2. Grasp their right waist hand near the wrist with your right hand. Draw it forward and down toward your right hip; keep your left elbow against your ribs.

3. As the rider presses forward, press your shoulders back into them and drive through both feet. Lift your hips directly into a squat.

4. Rise with knees bent and stagger your feet. The rider follows upward on their own feet.

5. Hold the hand away from your waist and move your hips forward to clear their arm. Turn right to face, moving both feet. Finish low; release after rear contact is gone and reset.

Say "Feet planted; pressure back." / "Hips clear; keep the hand and face."

Common error Throwing the shoulders backward while the hips stay on the mat. **Correct it** Bring the feet closer and lift the hips with the legs; stop if balance is lost.

Drill / progress Take three slow repetitions each. Then rider adds gentle forward pressure after the sit; bottom rises and faces. Reset if pulled backward or stalled.

Watch / stop Separate-hand contact only. No finger peeling, wrist twisting, pullbacks, lifts, or mat returns. **Resources** A15-S1 / A15-S2 / A15-S3 / A15-S4

A16 Short Sit to Switch

Purpose Reverse when a rider follows your short sit with a tight waist. **Before teaching** B18 Sit-Out and B20 Switch; balanced short sit, wrist control, and hip scissor.

1. Start in B18's low short sit, feet planted and chest over hips. Rider follows behind-left, right arm around your waist. Your right hand covers their right wrist; your left elbow hugs your ribs.

2. When they retain that waist arm and their right thigh is reachable, transfer their right wrist to your left hand at your belly. Keep your left elbow in.

3. Turn right; carry your right elbow over their right upper arm. Reach between their legs and cup inside their right thigh above the knee.

4. Push through your feet, raise your hips, and move them away. Turn toward their right hip as your right upper arm presses their right shoulder down.

5. Scissor your left leg over your right; circle onto your knees behind their hips. Release the wrist as their waist arm clears, then replace the thigh grip with separate waist-and-arm control.

Say "Wrist, then thigh." / "Hips up; scissor behind."

Common error Reaching over the back while sitting still. **Correct it** Find the inside thigh, then lift and turn your hips.

Drill / progress Alternate three cooperative repetitions. Then rider follows with the tight waist or withdraws that arm. Switch on the first response; stop and reset on the second.

Watch / stop Release for trapped shoulders or knees. Never twist the wrist or force an immobilized arm. **Resources** A16-S1 / A16-S2 / A16-S3 / A16-S4 / A16-S5 / A16-S6

A17 Reswitch

Purpose Counter a switch while your waist arm can still reach the opponent's leg. **Before teaching** B20 Switch; both partners can support on one hand, scissor the hips, free their arms, and stop mid-turn.

1. Start riding on their left: your right arm around their waist and left hand at their left elbow. All directions below are yours.

2. Partner starts a right-side switch, reaching their right hand inside your right thigh. Follow the turn while your right arm remains mobile at their waist.

3. As they begin coming around behind, slide your right hand inside their right thigh above the knee. Post your left hand beside you; sit your left leg through onto your right hip.

4. Lift your hips, move them away from your partner, and turn right toward the captured thigh. Scissor your left leg over your right to come onto your knees behind them.

5. Let their right arm slide clear of your waist. Release the thigh and settle into a waist-and-arm ride, hands separate. Partner follows onto knees and frees the turning arm.

Say "Catch the thigh as they come around." / "Hips away; clear the arm."

Common error Waiting until the wrist or shoulder is pinned, then pulling harder. **Correct it** Reset earlier; the counter needs a mobile arm and reachable thigh.

Drill / progress Do three slow exchanges each. Then bottom varies the switch timing and tries to clear your waist arm. Allow one reswitch; reset at rear control or a missed counter.

Watch / stop Release for a trapped shoulder, straight-arm post, or planted knee that cannot turn. **Resources** A17-S1 / A17-S2 / A17-S3 / A17-S4 / A17-S5

A18 Quad-Pod Stand-Up

Purpose Get to your feet, clear the waist hand, and face the rider. **Before teaching** Stable base, painless hand support, and partner stand-up practice. This version turns left.

1. Start in base with the rider on your left: their right hand at your belly, left hand at your left elbow. Directions are yours.

2. On signal, shift both palms left, keeping them apart. Push weight back over your right hip; point left toes outward and plant that foot.

3. Bring your right foot out and rise onto both feet. Circle as you rise so the rider stays beside your left hip.

4. Keep feet wide, knees bent, hips low, head and chest up. Leave your left palm posted. Your right hand grasps their whole right hand near the wrist and guides it behind your right hip.

5. Lift your left palm and turn left toward the rider, moving both feet. Release as waist contact clears; finish facing in a low stance.

Say "Left hand posts; right hand clears." / "Head up; turn toward the rider."

Common error Straightening the legs and dumping weight onto the hands. **Correct it** Bend the knees, lower the hips, and recover foot support.

Drill / progress Three cooperative escapes each. Then rider adds one gentle forward push while following. Reset for a trapped wrist, secure lock, or lost posture.

Watch / stop No head posting, finger peeling, wrist twisting, chops, lifts, or mat returns. **Resources** A18-S1 / A18-S2 / A18-S3 / A18-S4

A19 Spiral Ride to Near Wrist

Purpose Keep top pressure through a wrist capture and rebuild. **Before teaching** B24 Spiral Breakdown and B25 Near Wrist Ride.

1. Start in an established left-side spiral: left forearm under their left armpit, base of hand under biceps; right hand inside their right thigh.

2. Keep chest high on their back, head behind shoulders. Knees off mat, circle left toward their head: guide their left arm forward and their right thigh backward.

3. When their left elbow lowers, release your left upper-arm contact and grip their left wrist from above. Keep thigh contact and chest pressure.

4. With wrist secured, move your right arm around their waist, hands separate. Drive their body forward over the wrist into a belly-down near-wrist ride.

5. Follow their knee-under rebuild with small steps and shoulder pressure. Finish belly-down, ease pressure, release the wrist, and reset.

Say "Elbow down, left hand to left wrist." / "Feet and chest keep control."

Common error Releasing both spiral contacts to chase a posted hand. **Correct it** Keep thigh and chest pressure while the left hand changes grips.

Drill / progress Three cooperative changes each; bottom bends the elbow and yields. Then four 15-second rounds: bottom maintains or rebuilds base; top captures and follows. Reset at wrist clearance or standing.

Watch / stop No throat/groin contact, finger grips, or arm-behind-back pull. Release for wrist bending, trapped-arm strain, or stop signals. **Resources** A19-S1 / A19-S2 / A19-S3 / A19-S4 / A19-S5 / A19-S6

A20 Claw Breakdown to Near Wrist

Purpose Break the base with a claw, then secure same-side wrist control. **Before teaching** B15, B24, B25; coach-checked claw placement and immediate release.

1. Start on bottom's left, facing their head. Bottom supports on hands and knees; your right arm controls the waist.

2. Pass your left arm under their left armpit, across the upper chest, and cup their right shoulder. Keep fingers together and forearm off the throat.

3. Move your right hand from the waist to the inside of their right thigh, away from the groin; keep hands separate.

4. Stay on your toes with chest pressure. Walk left and around toward their head, pressing their right thigh back while retaining the claw.

5. As their left elbow lowers, move your left hand from their shoulder to an overhand grip on their left wrist, underneath their left arm. Return your right arm to the waist.

6. Drive their body forward over the wrist into B25. Finish belly-down with balanced top control; unload and release before resetting.

Say "Under the arm, far shoulder." / "Elbow down; left hand takes left wrist."

Common error Releasing the claw before the near elbow lowers. **Correct it** Keep chest pressure and circle until the wrist is reachable.

Drill / progress Three cooperative repetitions each. Then bottom slowly rebuilds once; top follows in the wrist ride. Reset if the wrist clears; swap roles.

Watch / stop Release for throat pressure, restricted breathing, joint pain, or trapped knees. No arm-on-back turn. **Resources** A20-S1 / A20-S2 / A20-S3 / A20-S4

A21 Near Wrist Tilt

Purpose Expose the back by turning the hips while retaining one-hand wrist control. **Before teaching** B25, supported side receiving, and coach-checked hip loading and release.

1. Partner is on their knees. Ride their left side: your left arm goes under their left upper arm, and your left hand holds their left wrist beneath their chest.

2. Keep that elbow bent. Your right arm crosses their waist; cup their right upper thigh beside the hip. Keep your hands separate.

3. Bring your left hip beneath their left hip and sit onto your left side, loading their left thigh on your hip. Slide your right foot under their left thigh.

4. Elevate their left leg with your right foot while drawing their far hip toward you. Expose their back with your body angled across theirs, keeping their hips supported.

5. Lower the elevated leg and guide them through their left side to belly-down. Follow above their hips, unload the trapped arm, then release.

Say "Left wrist, left hip." / "Lift the leg; turn the hips."

Common error Sitting away and pulling only the wrist. **Correct it** Reload their thigh onto your hip before turning.

Drill / progress Three slow repetitions each. Then four 15-second turns: bottom permits loading or widens their base early. Reset a blocked load; alternate roles.

Watch / stop Release for wrist bending, shoulder strain, knee twisting, or neck stacking. No hands locked around the trunk. **Resources** A21-S1 / A21-S2 / A21-S3

A22 Two-on-One Tilt

Purpose Expose the back using two-on-one control and a near-side knee block. **Before teaching** B22 cross-wrist control, supported side receiving, and following a turn-down.

1. Start on their left as they rebuild to knees after a breakdown. Your right arm wraps their waist to hold their left wrist; your left hand cups their left triceps.

2. Hold their bent arm against their belly, wrist straight. Stay chest-to-back behind their left shoulder, hips close.

3. Put your left knee in front of their left knee. Sit close onto your left hip, bringing their left hip onto yours.

4. Plant your left heel and keep that knee upright against the front of their hip. Bring your right leg between their legs, supporting underneath their far right thigh.

5. Raise your right leg to tip their hips and expose their back. Keep the two-on-one snug, weight on your side, and head free.

6. Lower their thigh, ease the knee block, and let them turn belly-down. Follow chest-to-back onto your knees; release after both are stable.

Say "Left knee blocks; right leg lifts." / "Keep their hips on yours."

Common error Sitting away and trying to pull them over by the wrist. **Correct it** Move hips closer and rehearse the knee block before turning.

Drill / progress Three cooperative tilt-and-return repetitions each. Then bottom may widen the knees before entry; top tilts only when the block fits, otherwise resets.

Watch / stop Stop for wrist bending, shoulder strain, neck loading, or lost hip support. **Resources** A22-S1 / A22-S2 / A22-S3

A23 Arm Bar Turn

Purpose Turn a flat opponent with a short arm bar and far-wrist control. **Before teaching** Breakdown, side receiving, and coach-checked bar placement and immediate release.

1. Start beside their left side, partner belly-down, left elbow bent and hand beside their left hip. Do not force the arm behind their back.

2. Hook your left forearm beneath their left upper arm, just above the elbow. Bend your elbow and anchor your palm-down fist against mid-back.

3. Reach your right arm under their right armpit and hold their right wrist under their chest. Keep your chest over their shoulders.

4. On your toes, take short steps around their head toward their right shoulder. Carry the barred upper arm across the torso; shoulders and hips turn together.

5. For this drill, pause on their right side. Unthread the bar, let their left arm come forward, then follow chest-to-chest onto their back and reset.

Say "Fist on back; elbow bent." / "Circle the head; turn across."

Common error Walking forward while driving the trapped elbow toward the head. **Correct it** Stop, release, and rebuild the across-body angle with the coach.

Drill / progress Alternate three cooperative turns, pausing for grip and side-position checks. Then four 10-second entries: bottom closes the left elbow early; top inserts only through an opening. Reset if denied.

Watch / stop Release for shoulder strain, upward wrist lifting, elbow driven toward/over the head, a stand-up, or any stop signal. **Resources** A23-S1 / A23-S2 / A23-S3 / A23-S4 / A23-S5

A24 Near Wrist to Half Nelson

Purpose Turn a wrist escape into a half nelson. **Before teaching** B25 Near Wrist Ride, B26 Half Nelson, B28 finish, and slow turn receiving.

1. Ride a belly-down partner's left side. Your left hand holds their left wrist in front of their belly; your right arm holds a tight waist. Keep chest contact.

2. When they roll that wrist free and open their left elbow, let the wrist go. Catch their left upper arm from underneath with your left hand. If the elbow stays closed, keep riding.

3. Slide that same left arm under their left armpit, palm behind their head. Release the waist with your right hand and reach beneath their chest to hold their right wrist.

4. Lift your left elbow. Walk your feet out to their left and toward their head until perpendicular. Drive through your chest, turning their torso onto its right side.

5. Deepen the half as they turn onto their back. Settle chest to chest, hips low and feet wide; keep their right wrist near their trunk. Ease pressure and release both holds on stop.

Say "Wrist goes; same elbow opens." / "Feet out; chest across."

Common error Top keeps the old wrist grip while trying to insert that hand as a half. **Correct it** Pause: release left wrist, follow left elbow, then insert the half.

Drill / progress Trade three slow announced wrist-roll changes. Then bottom either opens the elbow while clearing or keeps it closed; top turns or continues riding.

Watch / stop Stop for trapped-body rotation, neck or shoulder pain, or the defender's elbow forced behind their head. Never force a closed elbow. **Resources** A24-S1 / A24-S2 / A24-S3 / A24-S4 / A24-S5

A25 Far-Side Cradle

Purpose Turn with a crossface and far-knee lock, then pin from behind. **Before teaching** Coach-checked crossface, wrist lock, side/back receiving and immediate release.

1. Start on their left, chest across their back; bottom is belly-down with the right knee drawn forward within easy reach.

2. Pass your left forearm across their cheek; hold their right upper arm above the elbow. Post your right hand behind their right knee.

3. Walk toward their head with chest pressure. Scoop under that knee; clasp your left wrist with your right hand, retaining the upper-arm grip.

4. Bring hips behind theirs and move your back leg clear. Draw them toward you onto their left hip and back; bottom rolls without stiff-arm posting.

5. Slide your hips and shoulder out from underneath. Place your bottom knee against their side, forehead at their temple, and hook their free left leg with your upper leg.

6. Hold for a shoulder check. Clear the leg hook and knee pressure, open the wrist lock, then let bottom unfold.

Say "Far arm, far knee, own wrist." / "Hips back; clear their shoulders."

Common error Forcing the knee toward the head to reach the lock. **Correct it** Move closer; reset if the clasp requires forced folding.

Drill / progress Three cooperative turns each. Then four attempts each: bottom may extend the far leg before the lock; top connects or resets.

Watch / stop No crossface strike, throat squeeze, neck crank, or knee twist; release immediately for pain or breathing restriction. **Resources** A25-S1 / A25-S2 / A25-S3 / A25-S4 / A25-S5

A26 Near-Side Cradle Decision Drill

Purpose Practice finishing an available near-side cradle or preventing its lock. **Before teaching** B29 and B30; coach-checked receiving, immediate release, and a stable forehead post with the neck aligned.

1. Top kneels beside bottom's left ribs, facing in. Bottom holds base. Top's left arm goes over the head, elbow behind neck; right arm scoops behind bottom's left knee.

2. Before hands connect, bottom may send the left foot back and left hip down, catching top's left hand/wrist with both hands. Raise head and chest as the loose wrap clears.

3. Top releases; bottom clears head and knee before rebuilding base. If this defense attempt becomes locked, stop: top opens the clasp before further motion.

4. If bottom stays cooperative, top closes chest position and joins palms near the head, thumbs alongside fingers. Reset if the lock requires forcing.

5. Top drives toward bottom's right hip, lifting the left shoulder with the chest. Bottom turns without stiff-arm posting. Top follows chest-to-chest, feet wide, hips low, with an aligned forehead post.

6. Pause for the coach; open the clasp before bottom unfolds. No escape attempts against the lock.

Say "Clear before the clasp." / "Lock, turn, pause, release."

Common error Continuing the early defense after top connects the hands. **Correct it** Freeze that repetition, open the clasp, and restart earlier.

Drill / progress Coaching exercise: two announced finishes and two clearances each. Then four attempts each; bottom chooses early defense or cooperative receiving. Stop an unexpected lock; alternate roles.

Watch / stop Release for throat pressure, forced neck bending, knee twisting, or an unstable head post. **Resources** A26-S1 / A26-S2 / A26-S3 / A26-S4 / A26-S5

A27 Half Nelson Settle Drill

Purpose Keep chest-to-chest control as the receiver starts to roll through a half nelson. **Before teaching** B26 and B28; slow receiving, separate hand controls and immediate release.

1. Start after the left-half turn: left arm under their left upper arm, palm behind their head. Hold their right wrist beside their ribs with your right hand.

2. Place your chest across their upper chest, bodies making a T. Keep your head up, hips back and feet spread on the toes.

3. Receiver slowly turns toward their own left side, raising their right shoulder slightly. Their head turns with their chest; no bridge.

4. Widen your feet and take small steps backward, away from their torso. Settle your hips toward the mat while keeping your chest across their upper chest and knees off the mat.

5. Keep both arm controls. Stop when their shoulders settle; reset if they reach their side. Ease chest pressure, release the wrist, withdraw the half and move clear.

Say "Chest stays; hips back." / "Wide feet; head up."

Common error Top climbs across the receiver with high hips and gets carried into the roll. **Correct it** Reset; move the feet back and wider before lowering the hips.

Drill / progress Three cooperative settlements each, then three five-second attempts with the single small turn above. Swap roles; stop at lost control.

Watch / stop No neck bridge, head post or hand clasp. Release for pain, breathing trouble, or a trapped elbow moving behind the head. **Resources** A27-S1 / A27-S2 / A27-S3 / A27-S4 / A27-S5 / A27-S6

A28 Cross-Wrist Clear

Purpose Break the cross-wrist before a two-on-one tilt and recover inside elbow position. **Before teaching** B22 wrist control, A22 setup recognition, and keeping a bent arm close under pressure.

1. Start on your knees with top on your left. Their right hand holds your left wrist across your belly; their left hand controls your left triceps.

2. Widen your knees and keep your hips and chest low. Keep your left elbow bent; do not rise onto their hips or reach the captured arm out.

3. Bring your free right elbow back close to your ribs, directly in front of their gripping right wrist. Set the forearm beside your elbow against that wrist.

4. Use that elbow/forearm to scrape their right wrist off as you bring your bent left arm back to your left side. Keep both knees grounded.

5. Immediately turn your freed left palm up and tuck that elbow against your ribs, leaving their left arm outside. Settle over your knees and recover hand control before your next escape.

Say "Stay low; knees wide." / "Scrape the wrist, seal the elbow."

Common error Lifting the chest to reach the gripping wrist. **Correct it** Move the free elbow to the wrist while keeping the hips low.

Drill / progress Three slow clears each. Then top may tighten the grip or reach to recapture it; bottom clears and seals. Stop if top starts loading the tilt.

Watch / stop Clear before the roll. No elbow strike, finger stripping, wrist bending, or turning against a trapped shoulder. **Resources** A28-S1 / A28-S2 / A28-S3 / A28-S4

A29 Double Leg to Tight Waist Chop

Purpose Link a double-leg finish to a left-side ride and breakdown. **Before teaching** B07 and B22; reliable side receiving and bottom base-building.

1. From a cleared right-lead stance, lower hips; step right foot between theirs and touch right knee down. Head stays left at their right ribs; left hand cups their right knee, right hand their left.

2. Step left foot outside their right foot; lift your right knee. Drive diagonally right, gathering knees left. Receiver lowers onto left hip and side without straight-arm posting. Settle above the hips.

3. Pause. Release knees and transfer hands to hips. Receiver turns belly-down as you shuffle behind to their left, facing their head; keep chest contact over their hips.

4. Bottom rebuilds hands-and-knees. Wrap your right arm around their belly, hands separate. Place left forearm outside their left elbow, chest behind shoulders and toes planted.

5. Fold their left elbow inward while driving forward from toes; bring rear right knee against their buttocks. Bottom bends the elbow and lowers onto forearms, then belly. Follow their hips.

6. Catch their left wrist across the belly with your right waist hand; left hand controls their left triceps. Hold without twisting, then release and reset.

Say "Finish, settle, find the left ride." / "Drive forward; fold and catch."

Common error Chopping during the landing or before releasing the legs. **Correct it** Pause, free the legs, then establish the left-side ride.

Drill / progress Cooperate for three chains each. Then bottom chooses one base rebuild or stand-up; top chops the rebuild, but releases and resets for standing or escape.

Watch / stop No lifts, locked-arm chopping, trapped-leg twisting, or mat returns. Release for pain or lost alignment. **Resources** A29-COLLEGE_PARK / A29-HORASKI_GARCIA / A29-WILL / A29-USAW_SKILLS / A29-MADISON

A30 Near Wrist Tilt or Half

Purpose Choose one turn per attempt. **Before teaching** B25, A21 and A24; dependable tilt and half-nelson receiving.

1. Ride a belly-down partner's left: your left hand under their left arm holds their left wrist beneath the belly; right arm at waist, hands separate.

2. Tilt option - wrist held, knees rebuilding, load available: right hand cups their right upper thigh. Sit left, loading their left thigh onto your left hip; right foot lifts their left leg (A21).

3. Finish that tilt: expose their back, then lower the leg. Guide them through their left side to belly-down; follow above their hips, unload the arm, then release.

4. Half option from the original ride: wrist rolls free and left elbow opens. Release your left grip. Thread that left arm under their left armpit, palm behind head; right hand leaves waist for their right wrist (A24).

5. Finish that half: lift left elbow and walk out left toward their head. Turn them through their right side to chest-to-chest, hips low, feet wide. Ease pressure and release.

6. No opening: maintain a secure ride or reset. Stop for standing, lost wrist without a half, or failed alignment.

Say "Wrist held: check the load." / "Wrist rolls: follow that elbow."

Common error Choosing the half because bottom spreads their knees. **Correct it** Find the wrist release and same-side elbow opening first.

Drill / progress Rehearse each branch twice. Then six attempts: bottom chooses rebuild, wrist-roll opening, or blocked opening. Top names the choice; alternate roles.

Watch / stop No forced elbow opening, wrist bending, knee twisting, neck stacking, or elbow behind head. Release on stop. **Resources** A30-S1 / A30-S2 / A30-S3 / A30-S4 / A30-S5 / A30-S6

Resources for coach preparation

For the detailed review and source ledger, open Grindstone-Move-Research.html or .md and find the move ID. Keys such as B11-S1 match that move's source list. The general resources below provide further preparation and rule context.

USAW1 - USA Wrestling Folkstyle Level 1

Fundamental technique families and linked demonstrations.

https://www.usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/1

USAW2 - USA Wrestling Folkstyle Level 2

Finishes, short-sit responses, wrist tilts and bar-arm families.

https://www.usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/2

USAW3 - USA Wrestling Folkstyle Level 3

Hand control, single-leg reactions and riding families.

https://www.usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/3

USAWG - USA Wrestling Coach Guide to Excellence, 2nd Edition

Detailed coaching instruction and technique illustrations. Check current rules separately; this is a historical coaching manual.

https://s3.us-east-2.amazonaws.com/usaw-public/CoachesCorner/Coach-Guide-to-Excellence-2ndEdition.pdf

Resources for coach preparation

For the detailed review and source ledger, open Grindstone-Move-Research.html or .md and find the move ID. Keys such as B11-S1 match that move's source list. The general resources below provide further preparation and rule context.

KOLAT - Cary Kolat technique library and clinic example

Public technique catalog and a youth clinic example; some demonstrations require membership.

https://www.kolat.com/practice-plans/youth-clinic-half-nelson-cradle

NFHS - NFHS wrestling rules resources

Folkstyle rules resources. Confirm the actual youth league and event modifications.

https://nfhs.org/sports/wrestling/rules

AAP - AAP sports readiness guidance

Developmental context for voluntary movement and individual readiness.

https://www.healthychildren.org/English/healthy-living/sports/Pages/Is-Your-Child-Ready-for-Sports.aspx

CLUB - Grindstone Wrestling / Mat Rats

Club identity and the Pup program context.

https://www.grindstonewrestling.org/mat-rats

Coaching notes

TAB 2 / GAMES

End-of-practice games

30 games with readiness tags, setup, timing, rules, variations and coach watch points.

Content: binder pages 56-64
9 content pages

Coach / group: _____

Season: _____

30 ways to finish with fun

Choose for readiness, available space and today's energy. G01-G10 are movement games; G11-G20 add partner skills; G21-G30 add wrestling decisions. Explain the finish line and stop signal, demonstrate contact, then play. Everyone stays involved.

ID	GAME	AGE / READINESS	PAGE
G01	Traffic Light Trails	Pup / all ages	2
G02	Rocket Landing Pads	Pup / all ages	2
G03	Animal Passport	Pup / all ages	2
G04	Statue Museum	Pup / all ages	2
G05	Treasure Trail	Pup / all ages	3
G06	Team Shape Factory	Pup / all ages	3
G07	Robot Remote Control	Pup / all ages	3
G08	Adventure Story Quest	Pup / all ages	3
G09	Rhythm Crew	Pup / all ages	4
G10	Invisible Balloon Keep-Up	Pup / all ages	4
G11	Hands Only Tag	Ready beginners 7-14	4
G12	Knee Window Tag	Ready beginners 7-14	4
G13	Gate Guardian	Ready beginners 7-14	5
G14	Wrist Key Rescue	Ready beginners 7-14	5
G15	Base Island Delivery	Ready beginners 7-14	5
G16	Circle The Castle	Ready beginners 7-14	5
G17	Escape Ticket Booth	Ready beginners 7-14	6
G18	Entry Parking Garage	Ready beginners 7-14	6
G19	Breakdown Builders	Ready beginners 7-14	6
G20	Coach's Photo Album	Ready beginners 7-14	6
G21	Two Door Escape	Ready older athletes; skills verified	7
G22	Coach Corner Trios	Ready older athletes; skills verified	7
G23	Hidden Mission Match	Ready older athletes; skills verified	7
G24	Team Toolbox Bingo	Ready older athletes; skills verified	7
G25	Pick The Puzzle	Ready older athletes; skills verified	8
G26	Boundary Detectives	Ready older athletes; skills verified	8
G27	Problem Solver League	Ready older athletes; skills verified	8
G28	Color Call Decision Game	Ready older athletes; skills verified	8
G29	Captain's Challenge Cards	Ready older athletes; skills verified	9
G30	Rock Paper Wrestling	Ready older athletes; skills verified	9

G01 Traffic Light Trails

Pup / all ages | 4 min | Everyone moves; shared score | Equipment: Flat boundary dots

Set up Use one minute to mark a roomy travel area and demonstrate three signals.

Play Run three 40-second rounds with 20-second resets. Green means short walking steps; yellow means tiny steps; red means freeze in balance. Add one team point when everyone freezes inside their own space. Nobody leaves the game after a mistake.

Change it Let an athlete call the final round while moving with the group.

Coach watch Travel one direction; no racing, touching, or sudden backward steps into others.

G02 Rocket Landing Pads

Pup / all ages | 4 min | Solo missions; team celebration | Equipment: One flat spot per athlete

Set up Spend one minute giving each astronaut a pad with two arm-lengths of clearance.

Play Play three 40-second missions with 20-second rests. Coach calls launch: rise onto toes; orbit: circle your pad; meteor: crouch; land: stop with two feet beside the pad. Award a shared star for each mission completed with quiet feet and clear spacing.

Change it Older athletes remember a three-command sequence before beginning their mission.

Coach watch Feet stay on or near the mat; no jumping toward another landing pad.

G03 Animal Passport

Pup / all ages | 5 min | Individual explorers; shared challenge | Equipment: Flat spots; optional animal pictures

Set up Use one minute to give each explorer a small travel lane and model three animals.

Play Complete four 40-second journeys with 20-second rests. Travel like penguins with small steps, giants with careful long steps, or mice in a comfortable crouch. On safari, each athlete chooses an animal for others to copy inside their lanes. Collect one imaginary passport stamp each round.

Change it Older groups switch animals when the coach silently raises a picture.

Coach watch Keep separate lanes; no animal tackles, partner climbing, or jumping across lanes.

G04 Statue Museum

Pup / all ages | 4 min | Everyone creates; group guesses | Equipment: One flat spot per athlete

Set up Spend one minute assigning roomy spots and demonstrating a balanced two-foot statue.

Play Run three 40-second exhibits with 20-second rests. Coach names a theme such as superhero, robot, or tall tree. Everyone makes a statue, then walks around their own spot until freeze. Choose two athletes to name the next themes; the whole museum stays involved.

Change it Older athletes add a slow level change before returning to the same statue.

Coach watch Statues balance independently; no standing on partners, headstands, or touching other exhibits.

G05 Treasure Trail

Pup / all ages | 5 min | Parallel treasure collectors | Equipment: Flat picture cards and home spots

Set up Use one minute to give every athlete a short lane, home spot, and three cards.

Play Play four 40-second rounds with 20-second resets. Walk to the far end, collect one card, return home, and place it in a row. Once all three arrive, arrange the treasure into a story. Everyone completes their own trail; no winner takes another athlete's cards.

Change it Older athletes travel sideways in stance and retell the story during the reset.

Coach watch One athlete per lane; cards stay flat and nobody dives to collect them.

G06 Team Shape Factory

Pup / all ages | 4 min | Small crews; cooperative puzzle | Equipment: Flat dots outlining separate work areas

Set up Spend one minute forming crews of three in widely separated work areas.

Play Use three 40-second builds with 20-second resets. Coach names a line, triangle, or curve. Crews walk into positions that make the shape, leaving space between bodies, then change who chooses the next shape. Award one factory point whenever everyone has a clear place.

Change it Older crews build a letter or number and let another crew guess.

Coach watch Make shapes using standing positions only; no linked arms, pulling, or human pyramids.

G07 Robot Remote Control

Pup / all ages | 5 min | Noncontact pairs; rotating leaders | Equipment: Separate flat-marked squares

Set up Use one minute to pair athletes across a generous gap and demonstrate robot commands.

Play Run four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests, switching controller each round. Controller shows slow side steps, tiny forward steps, or a level change; robot copies while maintaining the gap. Each pair earns a battery when both freeze together on the coach's beep.

Change it Older robots copy the opposite direction instead of matching the controller.

Coach watch Hands stay to yourself; shorten steps whenever the gap or boundary becomes small.

G08 Adventure Story Quest

Pup / all ages | 4 min | Whole group; personal movement spaces | Equipment: One spot per athlete

Set up Spend one minute assigning clear spaces and showing the story's three movement choices.

Play Tell three 40-second chapters with 20-second rests. Cross the swamp with careful steps, pass under branches with a level change, and guard the castle with a balanced freeze. Athletes vote on the next destination during rests. Everyone acts in place or around their own spot.

Change it Let older athletes narrate a chapter using the same three safe movements.

Coach watch Imaginary obstacles only; no crawling beneath partners or jumping into another person's space.

G09 Rhythm Crew

Pup / all ages | 4 min | Everyone follows; shared pattern score | Equipment: None beyond personal mat space

Set up Use one minute to spread athletes out and teach clap, step, and freeze.

Play Play three 40-second music sets with 20-second rests. Coach performs a short pattern, such as clap-step-freeze, and everyone echoes it together. Add one action only after the crew repeats the pattern. Give a shared point for staying together, then let an athlete lead.

Change it Older crews insert stance, level change, or a direction change into the rhythm.

Coach watch No jumping into neighbors or slapping partners; sounds come from your own hands.

G10 Invisible Balloon Keep-Up

Pup / all ages | 4 min | Solo imagination; cooperative count | Equipment: One personal floor spot each

Set up Spend one minute spacing athletes and showing gentle imaginary balloon taps without leaving their spot.

Play Run three 40-second flights with 20-second rests. Tap an imaginary balloon using alternating open hands, then catch it in balanced stance when the coach calls catch. Change the imagined balloon from tiny to enormous. The group counts consecutive controlled catches, restarting cheerfully after a wobble.

Change it Older athletes change level between taps while keeping eyes forward.

Coach watch Stay in your own space; no real balls, head taps, or jumping after balloons.

G11 Hands Only Tag

Ready beginners 7-14 | 5 min | Matched pairs; shared total | Equipment: One marked square per pair

Set up Use one minute to match partners and demonstrate gentle open-palm contact to hands only.

Play Run four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Partners stay in stance and try to touch the back of the other's hand while protecting their own. Count clean touches together; restart in the center after each. Everyone plays simultaneously, and pairs try to improve their shared total.

Change it Allow only the lead hand to tag, then switch hands next round.

Coach watch No gripping, slapping, head contact, or chasing outside the square.

G12 Knee Window Tag

Ready beginners 7-14 | 5 min | Matched pairs; alternating attacker | Equipment: Flat square markers

Set up Spend one minute matching size and skill and showing a gentle touch above the kneecap.

Play Use four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests, alternating attacker. Attacker changes level to touch the front of either knee; defender retreats or circles while staying in stance. A clean touch earns one point and a center reset. Defender earns a point for ten balanced seconds without a touch.

Change it Limit the target to the lead knee before offering both knees.

Coach watch Touch only; no knee grabbing, diving, stiff-arm pushing, or contact to the head.

G13 Gate Guardian

Ready beginners 7-14 | 5 min | Noncontact pairs; attacker and guardian | Equipment: Two flat gates per pair

Set up Use one minute to create separated squares, each with two wide gates on one edge.

Play Play four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests, swapping roles. Attacker uses stance motion to cross either gate; guardian mirrors from a step away and closes a gate by standing in its lane. Attacker chooses the other opening. Each clean crossing scores; reset centrally after each attempt.

Change it Give older attackers one silent level-change fake before choosing a gate.

Coach watch No touching or blocking with arms; stop instead of squeezing through a closed gap.

G14 Wrist Key Rescue

Ready beginners 7-14 | 5 min | Matched partners; alternating rescuer | Equipment: Separate pair squares

Set up Spend one minute demonstrating a loose whole-wrist grip and a release that never bends fingers.

Play Run four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests, swapping roles. Holder lightly controls one wrist; rescuer uses the free hand and a step to clear that contact and recover stance. Each clear earns the pair a key. Regrip only after both reset. Progress from cooperative release to light hand-following.

Change it Alternate the captured wrist every attempt so both sides collect keys.

Coach watch No finger peeling, wrist twisting, pulling straight arms, or dragging a partner.

G15 Base Island Delivery

Ready beginners 7-14 | 5 min | Cooperative pairs; alternating traveler | Equipment: Two flat spots per pair

Set up Use one minute to place each pair's islands a short knee-slide apart and review stable base.

Play Complete four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Traveler moves from one island to the other on hands and knees. Follower stays beside the hips with light, separate waist-and-upper-arm contact. Earn one delivery when both arrive balanced. Swap roles each round; progress to traveler choosing either island.

Change it Ready travelers add a pause and reverse direction while followers maintain spacing.

Coach watch No breakdowns, squeezing, locked hands around the torso, or weight on the neck.

G16 Circle The Castle

Ready beginners 7-14 | 5 min | Matched pairs; grounded angle contest | Equipment: Separate marked circles

Set up Spend one minute showing a compact base, safe grounded pivots, and legal hip control.

Play Run four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests, alternating attacker. Castle starts on hands and knees; attacker starts beside a shoulder with hands off the head. Attacker circles behind to control the hips for two seconds. Castle pivots to keep facing. Score the outcome, release, and reset together.

Change it Start cooperatively; ready castles may take one knee-step instead of pivoting in place.

Coach watch No head pulls, fast spins over trapped legs, standing, or dropping weight onto the back.

G17 Escape Ticket Booth

Ready beginners 7-14 | 5 min | Matched partners; alternating bottom | Equipment: One square per pair

Set up Use one minute to rehearse the taught hand-controlled stand-up and standing stop with each pair.

Play Play four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Bottom controls the waist wrist and rises with balance; top follows using legal separate waist-and-wrist contact. Each controlled rise earns the pair a ticket. Stop at standing, release, and restart. Alternate bottom each round; increase following pressure only after clean repetitions.

Change it Tickets count only when bottom can name the hand-control cue during the reset.

Coach watch No lifts, mat returns, finger grips, squeezing, or pulling a rising partner backward.

G18 Entry Parking Garage

Ready beginners 7-14 | 5 min | Cooperative pairs; rotating driver | Equipment: Flat entry-line markers

Set up Spend one minute matching partners and checking each athlete's taught double-leg entry and stopping position.

Play Use four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Receiver offers a stable stance; driver changes level, steps into a balanced entry, and parks without finishing. Receiver says parked when head and knee position remain controlled. Recover stance and swap driver after each attempt. Collect clean parks rather than racing.

Change it Receiver may take one slow retreat before becoming stationary; driver chooses entry or reset.

Coach watch No takedown finish, lifting, head-first contact, or driving through the receiver.

G19 Breakdown Builders

Ready beginners 7-14 | 5 min | Matched pairs; cooperative construction | Equipment: Separate pair squares

Set up Use one minute to verify the taught tight-waist/chop breakdown and controlled forearm-and-belly receiving.

Play Run four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests, alternating top. Top completes the taught breakdown with separate hands, then eases pressure while bottom rebuilds base. One controlled down-and-up cycle builds one tower level. Pairs announce their tower height during rests. Add light base recovery only after smooth cooperative cycles.

Change it Require both athletes to identify one balance cue before the next tower level.

Coach watch No striking the elbow, stiff-arm posting, torso squeezing, or pressure through the head.

G20 Coach's Photo Album

Ready beginners 7-14 | 4 min | Cooperative pairs; position challenge | Equipment: Optional picture cards

Set up Spend one minute reviewing three known pictures: neutral stance, bottom base, and legal top start.

Play Use three 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Coach calls a picture; pairs move into that position without rushing and freeze for a pretend photo. Coach calls swap or new picture. Each correctly set photo earns a shared sticker. Top and bottom roles alternate at every grounded picture.

Change it Coach silently shows position cards while pairs explain the needed hand placement.

Coach watch Separate before changing positions; never jump onto a partner or force a rushed top start.

G21 Two Door Escape

Ready older athletes; skills verified | 5 min | Matched pairs; bottom chooses | Equipment: Separate pair squares

Set up Use one minute to approve stand-up and sit-out mechanics and demonstrate each round's stop points.

Play Run four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests, alternating bottom. Bottom chooses hand-controlled standing or sit-out facing; top follows with legal waist-and-wrist control. Balanced standing or facing earns bottom a door; maintaining control until time earns top one. Reset after each outcome and keep totals.

Change it Bottom announces the chosen door first, then keeps the choice secret in later rounds.

Coach watch No lifts, returns, neck holds, forced shoulders, or locked hands around a grounded torso.

G22 Coach Corner Trios

Ready older athletes; skills verified | 4 min | Trios; rapid role rotation | Equipment: One square per trio

Set up Spend one minute assigning bottom, top, and coach and confirming the taught escape objective.

Play Run six 20-second rounds with 10-second resets. Bottom seeks hand-controlled standing; top follows legally. Third athlete coaches one cue and records balanced standing or maintained control. Rotate bottom to coach, coach to top, top to bottom after every round. Each trio earns points for the outcome and a useful cue.

Change it Use a taught sit-out-to-face objective for the second rotation.

Coach watch Coach stays outside the square; no shouting over stop, pulling fingers, lifting, or returns.

G23 Hidden Mission Match

Ready older athletes; skills verified | 5 min | Matched pairs; secret process goals | Equipment: Three simple mission cards per pair

Set up Use one minute to rehearse belly-down starts under light, separate waist-and-wrist control.

Play Play four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests, alternating bottom. Bottom secretly chooses base rebuild, wrist clear, or sit-out facing; top follows legally. Bottom scores on mission completion and names it at reset. Top scores if the mission remains incomplete at time. Reset after each outcome.

Change it Choose a different mission each round; explain one useful response during rests.

Coach watch Use taught grounded positions only; no neck holds, joint forcing, lifts, or mat returns.

G24 Team Toolbox Bingo

Ready older athletes; skills verified | 5 min | Simultaneous pairs; collective bingo | Equipment: Team chart with four named skills

Set up Spend one minute listing double-leg entry, grounded go-behind, base rebuild, and hand-controlled stand-up.

Play Use four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Each pair chooses a different chart skill each round and completes it twice cooperatively with roles reversed. Report a checked square during rest. The team wins bingo when every pair completes all four skills with controlled stops.

Change it Ready pairs add the named skill's previously taught limited defensive response.

Coach watch Entries stop before finishing; grounded control stays clear of head and neck; stand-ups stop before returns.

G25 Pick The Puzzle

Ready older athletes; skills verified | 5 min | Matched pairs; tactical choice | Equipment: Cards marked neutral and grounded

Set up Use one minute to review hands-only tag and grounded sit-out-to-face against legal waist control.

Play Run four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Chooser picks neutral or grounded; partner chooses a role. Neutral attacker lightly tags the back of defender's hand; defender evades. Grounded bottom starts in base and seeks sit-out facing; top follows with separate waist-and-wrist contact. Success scores one; reset. Swap chooser each round.

Change it Explain why the chosen puzzle suits a practiced skill.

Coach watch No head contact, takedowns, lifts, mat returns, or switching to unlisted techniques.

G26 Boundary Detectives

Ready older athletes; skills verified | 5 min | Matched pairs; awareness challenge | Equipment: Flat inner-square and buffer markers

Set up Spend one minute marking each wrestling square and a clearly separated outer safety buffer.

Play Use four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Partners play hands-only tag in stance. Either may call edge before a foot reaches the inner boundary; both freeze, identify the safe reset direction, and return centrally. Earn team points for clean touches and correct edge calls, never for forcing someone outward.

Change it Older athletes identify the reset direction without the coach's cue.

Coach watch Stop at the inner boundary; no pushing, blind retreat, grabbing, or crossing into another square.

G27 Problem Solver League

Ready older athletes; skills verified | 5 min | Pairs; cooperative improvement | Equipment: One score slip per pair

Set up Use one minute to choose a taught problem: regain base or circle behind.

Play Play four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests, alternating solver. Opponent supplies the agreed response: light waist following against base, or a grounded pivot against go-behind. Count controlled successes. During each rest, pair selects one adjustment and tries again. Award league points for explaining an improvement, not merely winning.

Change it Pairs share their best cue with the neighboring pair after the final round.

Coach watch Keep the agreed response; no head pulling, forced joints, unexpected takedowns, or escalating resistance.

G28 Color Call Decision Game

Ready older athletes; skills verified | 4 min | Simultaneous pairs; reaction choices | Equipment: Red and blue cards

Set up Spend one minute rehearsing belly-down starts under light, separate waist-and-wrist control.

Play Use three 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. From belly-down, blue means rebuild base; red means rebuild then sit out to face. Top follows with legal waist-and-wrist contact. Coach shows a card; stop on the outcome, reset, and swap roles. Earn one point for choosing correctly and one for controlled execution.

Change it Show the card briefly after two clear rounds; partners remember the choice.

Coach watch No switching mid-turn, neck pressure, lifting, returns, or twisting a trapped arm.

G29 Captain's Challenge Cards

Ready older athletes; skills verified | 5 min | Small teams; everyone active | Equipment: Cards for three taught objectives

Set up Use one minute to review wrist clear, grounded go-behind, and hand-controlled standing.

Play Run four 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Each team captain chooses one objective for all its pairs; partners alternate roles after each attempt. Teams earn one point per pair completing both roles with control. Rotate captain during every rest, and use that rest to explain the next challenge.

Change it Let the other team pick your objective from the same approved cards.

Coach watch Use matched pairs; no head holds, body lifts, returns, or resistance beyond the agreed level.

G30 Rock Paper Wrestling

Ready older athletes; skills verified | 4 min | Matched pairs; quick choice rounds | Equipment: Separate pair squares

Set up Spend one minute reviewing rock-paper-scissors, choosing first roles, and rehearsing grounded go-behind versus facing.

Play Play six 20-second rounds with 10-second rests. During each rest, play rock-paper-scissors; winner chooses attacker or defender. Start the next round beside a compact base. Attacker circles behind to control hips; defender pivots to face. Each outcome scores one point, then reset. Everyone plays simultaneously.

Change it Use a taught sit-out-to-face contest with the winner choosing top or bottom.

Coach watch Hands stay off head and neck; no lifts, fast spins, or forcing trapped joints.

TAB 3 / PUP

Ages 4-6 practice plans

30 voluntary 35-minute movement and play sessions.

Content: binder pages 66-99
34 content pages

Coach / group: _____

Season: _____

GRINDSTONE WRESTLING

30 practice plans
Ages 4 to 6

Pup movement and play

Thirty short, voluntary play sessions for children ages 4 to 6. Build comfort on the mat through moving, copying, choosing and cooperating. The aim is an enjoyable experience that children want to repeat.

35 minutes per plan | One practice per page
Timing, setup, teaching instructions, adjustments and a learning check.

Use the shared Coach Moves Reference for full teaching steps. The matching two-page handout provides quick cues and reference pages.

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Run the practice

Choose the right pace

Use these as a bank of choices for the once-weekly Pup program. Thirty plans do not require a thirty-week season. Select and repeat sessions to suit the children; observation, a familiar activity or an early finish with an authorized adult are valid options.

Prepare the space

Have a clean wrestling mat, clear margins, timer, personal water bottles and the listed equipment ready. Flat markers must not slide. Confirm staffing, emergency contacts, medical restrictions and the venue emergency plan before arrivals.

Read the clock

The left column shows elapsed time from the start of practice. Demonstration, turns, rest and feedback belong inside each block. Short rounds repeat only while both partners remain controlled. Water is available throughout, beyond the planned break.

Give a clear invitation

Show one playful movement, give one short cue and invite children to try, adapt or watch. Rehearse stopping and making space before adding another movement choice. Use the shared Coach Moves Reference for the solo teaching steps.

Make room and supervise

Give every child a clear mat space. Use separate markers for willing mirror partners. Pause for discomfort, distress, repeated imbalance or crowding. Reduce simultaneous activity or run fewer stations if every child cannot be supervised.

Adjust without excluding

The easier and harder options change the task, not the child's place on the team. Offer observation, individual movement or cooperative rehearsal. Children may ask to stop at any time. Breaks remain supervised.

Keep it play based

Offer activities as invitations. Do not require completing every station or demonstrating a skill to move on. No competitive live wrestling, forced contact, takedowns or conditioning punishments are included. Parents help only within the club's approved supervision arrangements.

Find a practice

Practice 01 starts on page 4. Click a title or use the PDF bookmarks.

PLAN	FOCUS	PAGE
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Our Mat and Our Space

Goal Explore the room, find personal space, and recognize a shared stop signal.

Set up Flat nonslip markers, a large stop card, and clearly marked movement, rest, and bottle areas.

Before you begin Show children where to rest and how to find the supervising adult.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Greet each child by name and show the water and rest spaces. Invite walking between nearby markers or watching beside a supervising adult. Explain that joining, pausing, and changing activities are welcome throughout this gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Find an empty island.** Place markers well apart. Invite children to walk to an empty marker and look around before moving again. Hold up the stop card occasionally and model still feet. Children may watch or travel with an adult.
10-17 7 min	**My movement space.** Invite each child to choose a marker with open space around it. Demonstrate reaching sideways, making a small shape, and standing tall without touching others. Let children invent comfortable shapes while the coach copies their ideas.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Hello across the space.** Offer pairs two separate markers facing one another. Invite one child to wave or make a small movement while the other responds from their own marker. Swap invitations frequently. Children may copy the coach instead of pairing.
26-32 6 min	**Choose a home path.** Offer a short walking path and a space for making shapes. Children choose either invitation, repeat it, or watch. Invite them to return to a nearby empty marker when the stop card appears; adults help preserve space.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Stay beside a familiar adult at one marker and copy any comfortable movement.

Add challenge Choose a new empty marker after looking for a clear route.

Stop or change Pause movement when children crowd a marker or cannot see a clear route.

Look for Notice children finding space or responding to the stop cue with adult support.

Ask Which place or movement did you like?

Start Slowly and Stop Kindly

Goal Experience moving, slowing, and stopping without chasing or racing.

Set up Separate marker spaces, a green card, a yellow card, and a red stop card.

Before you begin Demonstrate each color using movement and words; do not rely on color alone.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Welcome each child to Grindstone and offer a quiet marker path or observation beside an adult. Show the day's stop signal. Children may stay with a preferred activity, take a supervised break, or finish with an authorized caregiver.
04-10 6 min	**Traffic color walk.** Show green and invite comfortable walking inside the marked area. Show yellow and model slower steps; show red and pause. Name each cue aloud. Keep changes unhurried, and invite children to watch or copy beside a coach.
10-17 7 min	**Travel and park.** Give each child a roomy marker space. Invite two or three steps away, then a gentle return and pause beside the marker. Offer forward or sideways travel. Repeat at each child's pace without scoring or calling anyone out.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Two separate traffic lanes.** Create two nearby lanes for each willing pair. One child holds a movement card while the other walks or pauses within their own lane. An adult helps interpret cues. Swap roles, or let children follow the coach.
26-32 6 min	**Pick the next signal.** Invite children to select walking, slow walking, or stillness by pointing to a card. The coach shows the chosen cue to everyone. Children may follow, keep gentle movement in their own space, or use the supervised rest area.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Use only walking and stopping with a coach demonstrating nearby.

Add challenge Let a child choose between two clear movement cues for the group.

Stop or change Stop the game if cues trigger sprinting, bumping, or sudden crowded turns.

Look for Notice a child slowing before stopping, without comparing response speeds.

Ask What helped your feet stop?

Stance Along a Friendly Path

Goal Explore a comfortable wrestling stance and short steps through playful marker routes.

Set up Flat markers arranged in several short parallel paths with wide spaces between them.

Before you begin Walk each route yourself and remove slippery markers or crossing paths.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Offer children a choice of gentle movement or watching with a supervising adult as they arrive. Point out water, rest space, and the stop signal. Joining activities is voluntary; children can change choices throughout the gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Path explorers.** Invite children to walk beside a short row of markers rather than on them. Show where each path begins and ends. Let each child repeat, change paths when clear, or observe. Adults prevent two children entering crowded routes.
10-17 7 min	**Ready stance path.** Show feet comfortably apart, one slightly forward, knees soft, and open hands in front. Invite short steps beside a marker path, keeping feet separated. Pause to rebuild the ready shape; children choose their own comfortable depth and pace.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Parallel stance journeys.** Invite willing partners into separate neighboring paths. One shows a comfortable ready stance, then both take short steps toward their own end markers. Pause and wave before repeating. Children may follow the coach or use ordinary walking instead.
26-32 6 min	**Choose a stance route.** Offer straight and curved marker routes. Invite children to take small stance steps, keeping feet apart and hands comfortably forward. Stop before each gentle turn and rebuild balance. Children can repeat a favorite route or choose relaxed walking.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Use two nearby markers and walk with a supervising adult.

Add challenge Choose where to pause along a gentle curved route.

Stop or change Pause when children cross lanes, crowd an entrance, or step onto a loose marker.

Look for Notice short stance steps with feet apart and a comfortable pause.

Ask Did you enjoy the straight or curved path?

Tall Small and Comfortable

Goal Explore a gentle wrestling level change by bending hips and knees while keeping the head comfortably up.

Set up One roomy flat-marker space per child and pictures showing tall, small, and wide shapes.

Before you begin Offer standing or seated choices; check that nobody is asked to move through discomfort.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Greet each child by name and show the water and rest spaces. Invite walking between nearby markers or watching beside a supervising adult. Explain that joining, pausing, and changing activities are welcome throughout this gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Growing garden.** Invite children to pretend they are plants, reaching comfortably upward and returning to an easy standing shape. Show a smaller shape with gently bent knees, without requiring a deep squat. Children choose their own range or watch nearby.
10-17 7 min	**Level change garden.** Show a comfortable ready stance with soft knees and hands forward. Bend hips and knees slightly to become a smaller plant, keeping eyes forward; grow back to the starting height. Invite children to choose shallow, unhurried movements without bouncing.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Garden movement mirrors.** Place willing partners on separate markers. One shows a gentle level change by bending hips and knees, then returns to a comfortable stance. The other copies or chooses a smaller version. Swap leaders and use the stop cue for crowding.
26-32 6 min	**Choose your shape story.** Tell a short story about a plant growing, resting, and moving gently in a breeze. Invite children to choose movements for each part. Seated versions, quiet watching, and repeating one favorite shape are equally welcome throughout the game.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Use one familiar standing or seated shape and return to it often.

Add challenge Link two comfortable shapes slowly while keeping personal space.

Stop or change Stop a movement if a child strains, loses balance, or reports discomfort.

Look for Notice a small level change with bent hips and knees rather than a dropped head.

Ask Which shape would you like to show?

Step Into the Open Space

Goal Rehearse a level change and lead-foot step while keeping the knees off the mat.

Set up Several short routes of flat nonslip markers, spaced for ordinary steps rather than leaps.

Before you begin Review P04 Level Change and Step. This is standing entry preparation; keep the feet staggered when resetting.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Welcome each child to Grindstone and offer a quiet marker path or observation beside an adult. Show the day's stop signal. Children may stay with a preferred activity, take a supervised break, or finish with an authorized caregiver.
04-10 6 min	**Shoreline walk.** Invite children to walk around the outside of a marker island, then pause beside it. Demonstrate looking for a clear direction before leaving. Let children choose different islands without racing, while adults help avoid crowded landing spaces.
10-17 7 min	**Level Change and Step - P04.** From stance, lower through hips and knees. Push gently from the rear foot and step the lead foot forward as the hips travel with it. Bring the rear foot forward enough to restore the staggered stance, not next to the lead foot. Both knees stay off the mat. Copy P04 slowly, then rest.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Neighbors practice entry steps.** Give willing partners separate lanes with an empty marker ahead. One demonstrates lowering slightly, stepping the lead foot forward, and bringing the trailing foot underneath. The neighbor tries at their own pace. Swap invitations; there is no partner target or contact.
26-32 6 min	**Choose your entry island.** Offer two nearby markers inside each personal lane. Invite children to choose one, lower slightly through hips and knees, and step toward it softly. Recover the trailing foot, pause, and walk back. Choose ordinary stepping when the pattern feels difficult.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Use only two close markers or a clear unmarked walking lane.

Add challenge Add an optional pause at each marker while looking toward the next space.

Stop or change Stop for knee impact, lunging, loss of balance, or stepping toward another child.

Look for Notice a small level change, soft forward step, and balanced recovery without knee impact.

Ask Where did you choose to pause?

Animal Ways to Travel

Goal Explore hands-and-knees base and comfortable crawling through animal movement choices.

Set up Wide individual lanes, flat end markers, and pictures of a bear, bird, and ordinary walking feet.

Before you begin Demonstrate alternatives for children who prefer standing or seated movement.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Offer children a choice of gentle movement or watching with a supervising adult as they arrive. Point out water, rest space, and the stop signal. Joining activities is voluntary; children can change choices throughout the gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Pick an animal idea.** Show the pictures and invite children to choose comfortable walking, arm movements like wings, or an easy hands-and-knees crawl. Use short individual lanes. Children can change choices whenever they wish, with adults allowing plenty of space.
10-17 7 min	**Build a small animal base.** Show hands beneath shoulders and knees beneath hips on the mat, with relaxed elbows and head clear. Invite a short pause in this animal base, then one comfortable crawl step or rest. Keep lanes separate and offer upright animal play.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Animal neighbors.** Give willing pairs separate lanes. One child chooses a picture, and both may try their own version while staying apart. Swap the picture chooser after a short turn. Nobody must copy crawling; comfortable walking always counts as participation.
26-32 6 min	**Make a gentle journey.** Invite children to imagine moving through a quiet forest, resting at a tree, and returning home. They choose their own movement for each part. Adults describe the story slowly and support children who prefer one repeated movement.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Choose walking or seated wing movements for the entire invitation.

Add challenge Choose two comfortable movements and pause between them.

Stop or change Stop crawling for wrist or knee discomfort, collapsing support, or crowding.

Look for Notice comfortable hand-and-knee support with the head clear of the mat.

Ask Which animal idea felt good to try?

Turn Toward Open Space

Goal Explore gentle direction changes while looking before moving.

Set up Personal marker spaces and short paths with clear turnaround areas.

Before you begin Show a slow standing turn and an alternative of pointing toward the new direction.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Greet each child by name and show the water and rest spaces. Invite walking between nearby markers or watching beside a supervising adult. Explain that joining, pausing, and changing activities are welcome throughout this gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Point then walk.** Invite children to stand beside a marker and point toward an open space before taking a few steps. Pause together, look around, and choose another direction. Adults model slow changes; children may point without traveling or watch nearby.
10-17 7 min	**Gentle turn stations.** Place two markers in each roomy lane. Invite walking toward one, stopping with room to spare, and turning slowly to face the other. Children choose how far to travel. Avoid spinning, hurried reversals, or instructions to turn sharply.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Show me the direction.** Place willing partners on separate markers. One points left, right, or forward into clear space; the other points the same way or takes one small step. Swap roles often, with the coach available as a no-pressure partner.
26-32 6 min	**Choose the next view.** Invite children to choose something in the room they can safely face, such as a wall picture or empty marker. Turn gently and look together. Add a few optional walking steps only where every route remains clear.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Stay on one marker and point or turn the head comfortably.

Add challenge Combine a pause, a gentle turn, and a few steps toward open space.

Stop or change Pause if children spin, reverse into others, or become dizzy.

Look for Notice children looking before making a gentle change of direction.

Ask What did you turn to look at?

Solo Stand-Up and Face

Goal Rehearse the outside-leg stand-up from base, clear the hips, and turn to stance.

Set up Clear personal mat spaces with optional flat markers and a nearby supervised observation space.

Before you begin Review P08 Solo Stand-Up. Confirm a steady base and half-kneeling rise; demonstrate the turn with both feet free.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Welcome each child to Grindstone and offer a quiet marker path or observation beside an adult. Show the day's stop signal. Children may stay with a preferred activity, take a supervised break, or finish with an authorized caregiver.
04-10 6 min	**Moving at different heights.** Invite comfortable walking, gentle knee bends, or seated arm movements in personal spaces. Show how a movement can be bigger or smaller without being faster. Children choose their own height and may remain seated or standing throughout.
10-17 7 min	**Solo Stand-Up - P08.** Imagine a rider on your left. From base, step the right foot under you and lift the chest; left forearm rises across the chest, right hand comes to the belly. Rise on bent knees, hands at waist. Clear hips, then turn left with both feet moving. Finish in stance. Use P08 for the full demonstration.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Copy a Stand-Up.** Partners stay in separate spaces. Copy one slow P08 stand-up, hip clearance and turn to face; then rest and swap. The coach checks short steps and chest lift. Children may rehearse just the first step or copy the coach upright. This is solo footwork; nobody adds a rider or pulls a child up.
26-32 6 min	**Rise and Freeze.** Show an open hand for one solo stand-up and turn; show a closed hand to stay in stance. Pause between invitations. Children can choose the short-step rehearsal or standing footwork. Celebrate balanced finishes and prompt releases into rest; this is a choice game without speed or elimination.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Rehearse the short foot step and chest lift, then reset; or copy stance footwork upright.

Add challenge Link the rise, hip clearance and turn to face on a visual signal.

Stop or change Stop for falling, pain, dizziness, pulling on another child, or a rushed backward lean.

Look for Notice a short step under the body, chest lift, and a balanced turn with moving feet.

Ask Which position felt comfortable today?

Quiet Feet and Careful Steps

Goal Explore controlled steps and gentle movement without evaluating noise sensitivity.

Set up Flat markers forming short clear paths and several personal movement spaces.

Before you begin Explain that quiet feet is a playful movement choice, not a demand for silence.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Offer children a choice of gentle movement or watching with a supervising adult as they arrive. Point out water, rest space, and the stop signal. Joining activities is voluntary; children can change choices throughout the gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Soft step explorers.** Invite children to try comfortable smaller steps along a short path, imagining a sleeping toy nearby. There is no contest for silence. Offer ordinary walking, seated foot taps, or watching, and praise children for noticing open space.
10-17 7 min	**Step and settle.** Give each child a personal marker. Invite one step away and a comfortable pause, then another step if space allows. Show how arms can help balance naturally. Repeat in different clear directions without requiring stillness for a fixed count.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Copy a careful step.** Invite willing partners to stand on separate markers. One shows a small step and pause; the other may copy or choose a stationary version. Switch leaders frequently. Remind children that the aim is sharing ideas, not moving identically.
26-32 6 min	**Gentle giant choice.** Tell a story about a friendly giant choosing small careful steps or tall slow movements. Children choose their version in roomy spaces. Invite a favorite movement again, keeping ordinary walking and quiet observation available without calling out differences.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Use seated foot taps or ordinary walking with a coach nearby.

Add challenge Combine two careful steps in different directions with pauses.

Stop or change Pause if children exaggerate tiptoeing, lose balance, or strain to move silently.

Look for Notice children trying a controlled step and settling comfortably afterward.

Ask What helped you move carefully?

Our First Movement Celebration

Goal Revisit favorite ways to move, stop, and choose space.

Set up Three clearly separated areas for marker paths, body shapes, and comfortable animal movements.

Before you begin Keep familiar options visible and explain that visiting every area is unnecessary.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Greet each child by name and show the water and rest spaces. Invite walking between nearby markers or watching beside a supervising adult. Explain that joining, pausing, and changing activities are welcome throughout this gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Favorite movement parade.** Invite children to choose walking, gentle arm movements, or another comfortable movement inside their own space. The coach celebrates each choice without ranking it. Show the familiar stop cue occasionally and offer nearby observation throughout the invitation.
10-17 7 min	**Choose a discovery area.** Open the path, shape, and animal areas with an adult watching each active space. Describe each invitation briefly. Children may stay, switch when routes are clear, or rest. Offer help choosing without requiring a rotation or completed task.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Show a neighbor.** Invite willing pairs to remain on separate markers and show a favorite movement from today. The other child can respond by copying, waving, or showing something different. Swap invitations, and let children share with a coach instead.
26-32 6 min	**Children choose the encore.** Show pictures representing walking paths, shapes, and animal movements. Invite each child to point to a favorite, then offer the popular choices in separate spaces. Include quieter alternatives and repeat selected activities without choosing winners or awarding skill rankings.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Stay with one familiar activity beside a trusted supervising adult.

Add challenge Invent a gentle two-movement sequence and invite the coach to copy it.

Stop or change Pause station changes when travel routes crowd or children rush between areas.

Look for Notice voluntary choices, comfortable participation, or a child sharing an activity they enjoyed.

Ask What would you like to do again?

Hello Helpful Neighbor

Goal Practice offering movement ideas and responding without touching or pressure.

Set up Pairs of flat markers several steps apart, plus individual spaces for children choosing solo play.

Before you begin Offer a coach partner or solo option before assigning willing pairs.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Welcome each child to Grindstone and offer a quiet marker path or observation beside an adult. Show the day's stop signal. Children may stay with a preferred activity, take a supervised break, or finish with an authorized caregiver.
04-10 6 min	**Wave along the path.** Invite children to walk a short clear path and wave toward a nearby coach or child if they wish. Nobody needs to return a wave. Pause at open markers and let children choose another journey or stationary movement.
10-17 7 min	**Sending movement messages.** Show how a wave, small reach, or gentle knee bend can be a movement message. Invite children to choose a message from their own space. The coach responds with a comfortable movement, accepting different responses without requiring exact copying.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Neighbor invitations.** Place willing partners at separate markers. Invite one to offer a movement message while the other watches, copies, or chooses a different response. Swap after a few invitations. Remind both children that declining or changing a movement is welcome.
26-32 6 min	**Choose your greeting game.** Offer movement messages with a coach, a short waving path, or solo shapes. Children choose where to play and may change when space is clear. Adults model asking before joining another child's activity and accept a no calmly.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Respond with a gesture or watch a coach offer simple movement messages.

Add challenge Offer two different movements with a pause so the neighbor can choose a response.

Stop or change Pause the pairing if a child touches, crowds, or pressures the other child.

Look for Notice a child offering space or accepting a neighbor's different choice.

Ask How did you share an idea?

Mirror With Room Between Us

Goal Explore wrestling stance, short steps, and gentle level changes through no-touch mirroring.

Set up Separate paired markers with clear space around each pair and a visible stop card.

Before you begin Demonstrate slow movements and show children that partners remain on their own markers.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Offer children a choice of gentle movement or watching with a supervising adult as they arrive. Point out water, rest space, and the stop signal. Joining activities is voluntary; children can change choices throughout the gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Coach stance mirror.** Invite children to copy a comfortable wrestling stance: feet apart, knees soft, hands forward. Show short steps and gentle level changes inside personal spaces. Pause between ideas; children choose their own depth or watch, with no need to match exactly.
10-17 7 min	**Slow wrestling windows.** Imagine each personal space is a window. Show a ready stance, one small sideways step, and a gentle level change with eyes forward. Invite children to choose one movement or combine two, then relax before the coach offers another idea.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Two quiet mirrors.** Offer willing pairs separate markers facing each other. One child chooses a slow movement while the other follows if comfortable. Swap leaders after two or three ideas. Adults help keep movements small; solo children can mirror the coach instead.
26-32 6 min	**Choose a mirror size.** Invite children to choose small hand movements, whole-body shapes, or gentle steps within their spaces. They may mirror a coach, a willing partner, or move independently. Change the invitation when interest fades rather than requiring everyone to finish.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Use only hand movements while seated or standing.

Add challenge Link two slow movements and leave a pause for the follower.

Stop or change Stop paired mirroring when spacing shrinks, movements become jerky, or a child feels pressured.

Look for Notice a child slowing a movement so another person can comfortably respond.

Ask Which movement was fun to copy?

Your Turn My Turn

Goal Experience brief shared turns while keeping waiting active and optional.

Set up Movement picture cards, separate paired spaces, and nearby independent marker paths.

Before you begin Prepare an independent movement option so no child must wait in a line.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Greet each child by name and show the water and rest spaces. Invite walking between nearby markers or watching beside a supervising adult. Explain that joining, pausing, and changing activities are welcome throughout this gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Choose a movement card.** Spread two or three picture choices where children can see them. Invite pointing to walking, reaching, or comfortable crawling, then trying a personal version. Coaches announce choices without collecting children into a queue or requiring them to copy others.
10-17 7 min	**Coach takes a turn.** Invite children to choose a movement for the coach, then offer one in return. Keep each turn to a single simple idea with time to respond. Children may decline the offered movement or choose an independent path nearby.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Shared chooser game.** Give willing pairs two movement pictures and separate spaces. One chooses a picture, and both may try comfortable versions. Offer the other child the next choice after a short turn. Adults help without taking over or demanding equal performances.
26-32 6 min	**Turn or travel choice.** Offer the shared picture game and a nearby solo walking route. Children can move between them when the space is clear. If waiting becomes difficult, provide another set of cards or an adult partner rather than extending the wait.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Use two pictures and let an adult guide a single exchange.

Add challenge Invite each partner to suggest a new safe movement before choosing.

Stop or change Pause if children grab cards, argue over turns, or crowd the same space.

Look for Notice a child offering the next choice or choosing a comfortable independent alternative.

Ask What did you choose on your turn?

Solo Sprawl and Return to Stance

Goal Send the legs back, lower the hips briefly, and recover the feet to stance.

Set up Roomy personal mat spaces, a stance picture, and a nearby upright footwork area.

Before you begin Review P07 Solo Sprawl. Confirm comfortable hand support before offering the slow step-back version.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Welcome each child to Grindstone and offer a quiet marker path or observation beside an adult. Show the day's stop signal. Children may stay with a preferred activity, take a supervised break, or finish with an authorized caregiver.
04-10 6 min	**Stance and Hand Support.** Begin with short stance steps and pauses. In clear spaces, bend hips and knees to place both palms on the mat, then recover to stance. Keep the head clear and let the feet support the return. Children may remain upright and copy backward steps; alternate attempts with rest.
10-17 7 min	**Solo Sprawl - P07.** From stance, bend to place palms in front. Step one foot back, then the other, keeping feet apart. Extend the legs and lower hips briefly with knees off and chest supported. Lift hips enough to step feet under you; lift hands and return to stance. Demonstrate P07 slowly from the side; no long holds.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Copy One Sprawl.** Use separate spaces with no contact. One child shows a slow P07 step-back sprawl and returns the feet to stance; the other may copy or watch. Rest and swap after one attempt. Coach checks hips low rather than a high plank, and a standing reset rather than dropping to the knees.
26-32 6 min	**Sprawl or Stance.** Show an open hand for one slow solo sprawl and a return to stance; show a closed hand for small stance steps. Pause between signals and offer rest freely. Children may choose upright steps throughout. Keep the aim balanced movement, without jumping backward, racing, or holding the low position.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Stay upright and take small backward stance steps; or rehearse bending to supported palms and returning to stance.

Add challenge Respond to a visual signal with one slow step-back sprawl and a balanced stance reset.

Stop or change Stop for head contact, collapsing arms, back discomfort, sudden dropping, or lost balance. Solo only.

Look for Notice legs extended behind, hips briefly low, knees off the mat, and feet returning under the body.

Ask What helped you bring your feet back underneath you?

Pause Together Move Together

Goal Notice a partner's signals and choose a shared pace without physical contact.

Set up Parallel walking lanes for pairs, clear end markers, and a large stop card.

Before you begin Demonstrate that either child can pause and the other leaves space.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Offer children a choice of gentle movement or watching with a supervising adult as they arrive. Point out water, rest space, and the stop signal. Joining activities is voluntary; children can change choices throughout the gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Pause with the coach.** Invite children to walk in personal lanes while watching the coach's open hand. When the hand becomes still, the coach pauses too. Children can stop when ready, point instead of walking, or observe without being corrected for response speed.
10-17 7 min	**Travel at a shared pace.** Walk slowly beside a child in a separate lane and invite them to choose the pace. Model slowing or stopping when they do. Offer short journeys with rests, and avoid turning shared movement into a speed-matching challenge.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Neighbor pause signals.** Invite willing pairs into neighboring lanes. Either child may show a raised hand to suggest a pause; the other can respond by stopping or waving. Resume only when both choose. Adults help interpret signals, and solo travel remains available.
26-32 6 min	**Follow a friendly pause.** Offer a coach-led walking path and stationary hand-signal play. Children choose an invitation and may change when clear. Let different children suggest pauses by gesture, showing that a group's movement can slow to make participation comfortable for everyone.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Remain at markers and practice raising a hand, pausing, and waving.

Add challenge Take turns suggesting when a short parallel journey begins or pauses.

Stop or change Stop when one child pulls ahead to chase, crosses lanes, or ignores a partner's pause request.

Look for Notice a child noticing and respecting another person's pause.

Ask How could you ask for a pause?

Roll and Welcome the Ball

Goal Explore gentle object sharing while staying in separate spaces.

Set up One large soft lightweight ball per pair, clear seated rolling lanes, and separate walking areas.

Before you begin Check ball size and condition; keep rolling paths away from walking routes.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Greet each child by name and show the water and rest spaces. Invite walking between nearby markers or watching beside a supervising adult. Explain that joining, pausing, and changing activities are welcome throughout this gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Rolling lane tour.** Invite children to walk beside the empty rolling lanes and find where each begins and ends. Demonstrate sitting comfortably at one end and rolling a ball gently. Children may watch, use a standing movement area, or explore a ball alone.
10-17 7 min	**Send to the empty marker.** Invite each child with a ball to roll it gently toward an empty nearby marker. Retrieve it by walking only after it stops and the route is clear. Offer seated rolling or a coach-assisted return without requiring accurate aiming.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Roll to a willing neighbor.** Seat willing partners comfortably at opposite ends of a clear short lane. Invite gentle rolls toward one another, allowing the receiver to stop or let the ball pass. Adults return stray balls. Solo rolling toward a marker remains available.
26-32 6 min	**Choose a rolling journey.** Offer short straight rolling lanes and solo target markers. Children choose partners or independent exploration, then decide whether to repeat or rest. Invite changing the target distance with adult help, keeping throws, hard pushes, and competitive scoring out of play.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Roll a short distance to a coach or explore stopping a stationary ball.

Add challenge Choose between two nearby targets while keeping the roll gentle.

Stop or change Stop rolling if balls become airborne, children chase into other lanes, or a receiver feels uncomfortable.

Look for Notice a gentle roll or a child waiting until the lane is clear.

Ask Where did you like sending the ball?

Build a Path Together

Goal Share route choices and respect another person's preferred way to travel.

Set up Flat nonslip markers, several clear building areas, and an adult assigned to moving each set.

Before you begin Explain that adults place markers while children point, choose, or watch from outside the route.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Welcome each child to Grindstone and offer a quiet marker path or observation beside an adult. Show the day's stop signal. Children may stay with a preferred activity, take a supervised break, or finish with an authorized caregiver.
04-10 6 min	**Explore two routes.** Offer a short straight path and a gentle curved path. Invite children to try either at a comfortable walking pace, repeat, or watch. Coaches ask for preferences through pointing or words while protecting open entry and exit spaces.
10-17 7 min	**Choose where it goes.** Show two possible places for the next marker and invite children to point to one. An adult sets the marker while everyone pauses outside the route. Invite exploration afterward, accepting children who prefer the original path or a stationary option.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Partner route designers.** Invite willing pairs to choose alternating marker locations by pointing from the edge of a clear space. An adult builds a short route, then children explore separately with space between turns. One may observe while the other tries the path.
26-32 6 min	**Keep it or change it.** Offer the completed routes and invite children to keep a favorite route or suggest one gentle change. Adults move markers only during a pause. Children may choose a solo path, watch the building, or repeat familiar movements nearby.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Choose between two ready-made routes without helping design one.

Add challenge Suggest a pause point and explain it by pointing or demonstrating.

Stop or change Pause when children move markers during travel or gather inside a route being rebuilt.

Look for Notice a child contributing a choice or accepting a partner's route suggestion.

Ask Where would you put a resting spot?

Solo Sit-Out and Reset

Goal Step a foot out, bring the other leg through, and settle into a low sit-out.

Set up Separate mat spaces and a coach demonstration with a clear view of the feet and supporting hand.

Before you begin Review P09 Solo Sit-Out. Confirm a small supported hip lift without wrist discomfort or a trapped knee.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Offer children a choice of gentle movement or watching with a supervising adult as they arrive. Point out water, rest space, and the stop signal. Joining activities is voluntary; children can change choices throughout the gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Base, Step and Seat.** Explore a steady hands-and-knees base and a separate low seated position. From base, rehearse stepping the right foot forward and outward while supporting the body. Keep attempts short with rests. Children may stay seated or observe. This prepares the foot placement before the leg-through action.
10-17 7 min	**Solo Sit-Out - P09.** From base, cross-post the left palm in front of the right; lift the right hand beside the thigh. Step the right foot forward and out. Press through the foot and left hand, slide the left leg beneath the raised right knee, and settle into a low seat with chest up. Reset separately. Demonstrate the full P09 sequence.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Copy a Sit-Out.** Partners stay in separate spaces. One copies the P09 cross-post, right-foot step and left-leg-through action, then pauses low; the other may copy or watch. Reset separately and swap. Coaches check that the left knee clears before sitting; do not add partner contact or force a turn back to base.
26-32 6 min	**Sit-Out Signal Game.** An open hand invites one solo sit-out; a closed hand invites holding a comfortable base. Offer the foot-step rehearsal or seated hip scoot as choices. Rest between attempts. Help children find a clear leg path and an upright chest; no racing, memory test or forceful hip twist.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Rehearse the cross-post and right-foot step without threading the leg; or copy a seated hip scoot.

Add challenge Use a visual signal for one sit-out and a separate, unhurried reset to base.

Stop or change Stop for wrist or knee discomfort, head contact, forceful twisting, or dropping backward.

Look for Notice the left leg clearing before the hips lower, chest up, and a balanced low seat.

Ask Which two ideas would you put together?

Tell a Story With Movement

Goal Cooperate through simple imaginative movement and shared choices.

Set up Pictures of a tree, river, and home, plus open personal spaces and clear walking lanes.

Before you begin Show that the story can be followed standing, seated, walking, or watching.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Greet each child by name and show the water and rest spaces. Invite walking between nearby markers or watching beside a supervising adult. Explain that joining, pausing, and changing activities are welcome throughout this gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Visit the imaginary forest.** Invite children to imagine a forest while walking comfortably in personal lanes or moving their arms in place. Offer trees to look at and clear places to pause. Let children suggest details by gesture or words without requiring participation.
10-17 7 min	**Cross the pretend river.** Mark short clear routes beside pictures of a river. Invite careful ordinary steps between nearby markers, then a comfortable rest. No jumping is needed. Children may choose a seated paddling motion or watch the coach act out the journey.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Share the story choice.** Invite willing partners on separate markers to choose the next picture in the story. One points to a place; both may show their own movement for visiting it. Swap choices, with the coach available to share a solo child's story.
26-32 6 min	**Choose the ending.** Offer pictures for resting at home, growing like a tree, or walking back along a route. Invite children to choose their own ending and repeat a favorite part. Adults follow ideas that preserve clear space and comfortable movement.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Remain seated or standing and choose one familiar story movement.

Add challenge Choose two story places and pause between the movements for each.

Stop or change Stop any pretend action that becomes jumping across gaps, chasing, or climbing on another child.

Look for Notice a child sharing a story choice while allowing a neighbor's different movement.

Ask Where did your story go?

Celebrate Being a Helpful Partner

Goal Revisit shared choices, gentle signals, and no-touch cooperation.

Set up Separate stations for mirror play, picture puzzles, and gentle ball rolling with appropriate clear lanes.

Before you begin Offer solo and coach-supported options at every station before children choose.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Welcome each child to Grindstone and offer a quiet marker path or observation beside an adult. Show the day's stop signal. Children may stay with a preferred activity, take a supervised break, or finish with an authorized caregiver.
04-10 6 min	**Helpful movement welcome.** Invite children to move comfortably inside personal spaces while the coach models making room, pausing, and asking before joining. Children can copy any idea or keep their own movement. Use the stop card calmly and acknowledge considerate actions specifically.
10-17 7 min	**Choose a cooperation station.** Explain the three invitations: copy slow movements, choose two picture actions, or gently roll a ball along a clear lane. Children select one, watch, or rest. Adults manage equipment and spacing while allowing repeated play at a preferred station.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Share one favorite invitation.** Offer willing partners separate spaces at their chosen station. Invite each child to suggest one movement or target, with an adult helping them take short turns. Children can change partners through the coach or return to independent play anytime.
26-32 6 min	**Our helpful encore.** Invite children to point toward the activity they want again. Reopen the chosen stations with clear supervision and space. Notice concrete cooperation, such as leaving room or returning a gentle roll, without awarding a best-partner prize or ranking children.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Choose one familiar station with an adult as partner or nearby observer.

Add challenge Help choose an activity and suggest one way to make room for a neighbor.

Stop or change Pause station play when children crowd, grab equipment, or pressure another child to participate.

Look for Notice a considerate action, shared choice, or child comfortably choosing an independent alternative.

Ask What helped you play beside someone?

Signals We Can See

Goal Notice clear visual cues and choose a comfortable response.

Set up Large pictures showing walk, reach, and pause; flat personal-space markers and clear short lanes.

Before you begin Pair each visual cue with simple words and demonstrate without requiring quick reactions.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Offer children a choice of gentle movement or watching with a supervising adult as they arrive. Point out water, rest space, and the stop signal. Joining activities is voluntary; children can change choices throughout the gathering.
04-10 6 min	**See it and choose.** Show a walking picture and invite a few comfortable steps, then a pause picture and a rest. Give plenty of time between signals. Children may point, move their hands, or observe instead of traveling, and nobody is eliminated.
10-17 7 min	**Two ways to respond.** Show a reaching picture and demonstrate both a standing reach and a seated arm movement. Invite children to choose a response that feels comfortable. Alternate reaching and pausing slowly, allowing children to stay with one idea or watch nearby.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Neighbor signal choices.** Offer willing pairs separate markers and two picture cards. One child selects a card while the other chooses a comfortable response. Swap roles after a few invitations. Adults help interpret signals; a coach can offer the pictures for solo children.
26-32 6 min	**Choose the signal leader.** Invite children to choose whether a coach or willing child shows the next movement picture. Everyone responds in their own space or observes. Keep cards visible, name the action aloud, and pause whenever the room needs more space.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Use one movement picture and a clearly demonstrated pause.

Add challenge Offer three visible pictures while keeping enough response time for everyone.

Stop or change Pause if children react by sprinting, crowd the signal holder, or seem confused and distressed.

Look for Notice a child noticing a cue and choosing any comfortable response.

Ask Which signal was easiest to notice?

Which Path Has Room

Goal Look for an open route and pause when space is occupied.

Set up Several short parallel marker paths with clear starts, ends, and roomy waiting or independent movement spaces.

Before you begin Demonstrate checking a route before entering and offer a solo space instead of waiting.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Greet each child by name and show the water and rest spaces. Invite walking between nearby markers or watching beside a supervising adult. Explain that joining, pausing, and changing activities are welcome throughout this gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Look before leaving.** Invite children to stand beside a marker and look for an empty nearby space before taking a few steps. Coaches model pausing when someone passes. Children may remain stationary and point toward open space rather than travel.
10-17 7 min	**Open route choices.** Offer two clear walking routes per small group. An adult indicates when a route is occupied and models choosing another or pausing outside it. Children explore without racing, and a nearby shape-making space provides an immediate alternative to waiting.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Neighbors plan separate trips.** Invite willing pairs to stand at separate start markers and point toward different clear routes. Each takes a short walk when ready, then returns outside the routes with adult guidance. They may choose solo travel or remain at their markers.
26-32 6 min	**Choose space or pause.** Offer walking routes and personal shape spaces. Invite children to choose where there is room, showing that staying still is also a good choice. Adults keep traffic slow and add space rather than making children compete for an opening.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Use one child per lane with an adult helping identify open space.

Add challenge Choose between two clear routes and explain the choice by pointing.

Stop or change Pause when children race for openings, enter occupied lanes, or return against moving traffic.

Look for Notice a child choosing open space or pausing without being rushed.

Ask How did you find room to move?

Small Steps Big Shapes

Goal Rehearse a level change and lead-foot step while keeping the knees off the mat.

Set up Roomy personal marker spaces and pictures showing small steps, gentle reaches, and relaxed pauses.

Before you begin Review P04 Level Change and Step. This is standing entry preparation; keep the feet staggered when resetting.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Welcome each child to Grindstone and offer a quiet marker path or observation beside an adult. Show the day's stop signal. Children may stay with a preferred activity, take a supervised break, or finish with an authorized caregiver.
04-10 6 min	**Small step trail.** Invite children to take a few comfortable small steps beside a short marker trail, then pause. Offer ordinary walking or seated foot movements as alternatives. Coaches notice deliberate movement without asking children to make their feet perfectly quiet.
10-17 7 min	**Level Change and Step - P04.** From stance, lower through hips and knees. Push gently from the rear foot and step the lead foot forward as the hips travel with it. Bring the rear foot forward enough to restore the staggered stance, not next to the lead foot. Both knees stay off the mat. Copy P04 slowly, then rest.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Partners offer an entry idea.** Place willing partners on separate markers. One shows a gentle level change or a solo lead-foot step with trailing-foot recovery; the other chooses a comfortable version. Swap invitations and pause between attempts. No reaching toward, touching, or taking down a partner.
26-32 6 min	**Movement size story.** Tell a simple story about opening a tiny window, looking at a wide view, and resting. Children choose small or larger comfortable movements for each idea. Keep seated, standing, ordinary walking, and observation options available throughout the story.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Explore small hand movements from one seated or standing position.

Add challenge Link a small movement and a larger comfortable movement with a pause.

Stop or change Stop for knee impact, lunging, sudden dropping, or reaching into another child's space.

Look for Notice controlled lowering followed by a soft entry step and balanced recovery.

Ask Which size of movement felt comfortable?

Around the Pretend Pond

Goal Explore curved routes and choose a comfortable way around an obstacle.

Set up Flat markers outlining several small pretend ponds, each with a wide clear walking route around it.

Before you begin Keep pond markers flat and routes wide; explain that nobody jumps across or enters them.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Offer children a choice of gentle movement or watching with a supervising adult as they arrive. Point out water, rest space, and the stop signal. Joining activities is voluntary; children can change choices throughout the gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Walk beside the water.** Invite children to walk slowly beside a pretend pond outlined with flat markers. Show how to look ahead and pause where there is room. Children may explore a straight route instead, point from a marker, or watch nearby.
10-17 7 min	**Choose a way around.** Show two gentle routes around the same pretend pond. Invite children to choose one, walk it, and pause at an end marker. Adults manage one traveler per route and keep return paths separate; completing the whole circle is optional.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Neighbor route watchers.** Offer willing pairs separate nearby ponds. One child chooses a route while the other watches from a clear marker, then they swap invitations. Watching children may point toward open space or do stationary shapes without following closely or directing forcefully.
26-32 6 min	**Add a story stop.** Invite children to imagine a bird, tree, or resting bench beside their route. They choose where to pause and make a comfortable movement representing it. Coaches support imaginative choices while keeping feet on clear routes and allowing stationary participation.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Use a short straight path beside the pretend pond.

Add challenge Choose a pause point before the curve and look toward the route beyond.

Stop or change Stop when children jump across ponds, cut through markers, or crowd a curved route.

Look for Notice a child selecting a route and turning gently around the marked space.

Ask Where did you stop beside the pond?

Choose the Helpful Response

Goal Practice choosing space, a pause, or adult help during pretend situations.

Set up Pictures for space, pause, and help; separate marker areas and a clearly identified supervising adult.

Before you begin Use gentle pretend examples without staging collisions, distress, or unwanted touch.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Greet each child by name and show the water and rest spaces. Invite walking between nearby markers or watching beside a supervising adult. Explain that joining, pausing, and changing activities are welcome throughout this gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Room to move.** Invite children to make comfortable shapes on widely spaced markers. The coach points out empty neighboring spaces and models moving only when clear. Children can choose a new marker or stay, discovering that making room does not require touching anyone.
10-17 7 min	**Picture choice stories.** Describe simple situations, such as wanting a rest or seeing an occupied path. Show pictures for pausing, finding space, and asking an adult. Invite pointing or acting out a choice, accepting several sensible answers without treating the activity as a test.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Share a helpful idea.** Place willing partners on separate markers and show a picture of a crowded path or a tired walker. Invite one child to choose a helpful picture, then the other. They may gesture instead of speaking or share ideas with a coach.
26-32 6 min	**Practice a chosen helper action.** Offer children a clear walking path, a supervised rest place, and a coach available for questions. Invite trying a chosen action: pause, find space, or signal for help. Adults respond warmly and never manufacture a problem to test children.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Show just two pictures and demonstrate both responses.

Add challenge Invite a child to suggest another helpful response by movement, gesture, or words.

Stop or change End any pretend situation that worries a child or becomes actual crowding or unwanted contact.

Look for Notice a child choosing space, a pause, or help without needing to explain verbally.

Ask How could you show that you want help?

Find Your Comfortable Route

Goal Choose a movement route that suits current comfort and interest.

Set up Separate short walking, stepping, and stationary-shape areas with pictures identifying each invitation.

Before you begin Explain that every option is equally valued and children can change their choice.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Welcome each child to Grindstone and offer a quiet marker path or observation beside an adult. Show the day's stop signal. Children may stay with a preferred activity, take a supervised break, or finish with an authorized caregiver.
04-10 6 min	**Try a starting choice.** Invite children to choose ordinary walking, careful steps beside markers, or comfortable stationary shapes. Demonstrate each briefly, then allow exploration. Adults notice where children seem comfortable and offer support without directing everyone toward the same activity or difficulty.
10-17 7 min	**Two ways to the marker.** Show a straight path and a gentle stepping path that reach separate end markers. Invite children to choose based on comfort, then pause or repeat. A stationary option remains nearby, and no route is described as the better choice.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Partners choose differently.** Invite willing partners to point toward their preferred separate routes or stationary spaces. Each explores their own choice while the other may watch. After a short turn, offer another choice, showing that partners can enjoy different activities without changing each other.
26-32 6 min	**Change your mind game.** Invite children to begin at a chosen movement area, then signal when they want another option. Adults help them change using clear routes. Celebrate communicating preferences, including choosing rest, rather than counting how many different areas each child completes.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Choose one familiar stationary activity and stay with it.

Add challenge Try a second comfortable route and notice what feels different.

Stop or change Pause transitions if children rush, become crowded, or feel pushed into an uncomfortable option.

Look for Notice a child making or changing a choice that supports comfortable participation.

Ask Which choice felt right for you today?

Build a Wrestling Movement Journey

Goal Choose and connect solo base, sit-out, and stand-up movements without speed or contact.

Set up Pictures for base, seated sit-out, and standing; separate spacious areas with clear travel routes.

Before you begin Review P05, P09 and P08. Teach each action separately first; a reset between moves is part of this lesson.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Offer children a choice of gentle movement or watching with a supervising adult as they arrive. Point out water, rest space, and the stop signal. Joining activities is voluntary; children can change choices throughout the gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Visit Three Positions.** Show a hands-and-knees base, a low seat, and a balanced stance. Invite children to explore one or more in separate spaces. These are starting and finishing positions; demonstrate the P09 and P08 transitions separately. Keep demonstrations brief and leave time to pause, choose another position, or watch.
10-17 7 min	**Choose a Wrestling Sequence.** Show P05 base, then P09 Solo Sit-Out: cross-post, foot out, opposite leg through, low seat. Reset separately to base before P08 Solo Stand-Up: short outside-foot step, chest up, rise, clear hips and turn to face. Children choose one action or two with a reset. Keep every attempt solo and unhurried.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Neighbors choose a journey.** Offer willing partners separate spaces and the three pictures. One chooses base, sitting, or standing and shows a comfortable version; the other may watch or try independently. Invite a familiar hand-supported transition only when wanted, then swap who chooses.
26-32 6 min	**Make your own finish.** Invite children to end their journey in a comfortable base, upright seat, or balanced stand. They may repeat a small hip scoot or planted-foot rise before resting. Coaches follow choices, preserve clear spaces, and avoid judging a correct sequence.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Stay with a comfortable base, seated hip scoot, or planted-foot starting position.

Add challenge Link two familiar movements with a pause and comfortable hand support.

Stop or change Stop for collapsing support, forceful twists, rushed rises, head contact, or crowded travel.

Look for Notice a child linking or choosing familiar solo movements with comfortable pauses.

Ask How would your journey finish?

Children Share the Next Idea

Goal Offer movement ideas and practice inviting others without making participation compulsory.

Set up Personal spaces, movement picture choices, and clear areas for independent walking or observation.

Before you begin Explain that sharing an idea is optional and adults check space before the group tries it.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Greet each child by name and show the water and rest spaces. Invite walking between nearby markers or watching beside a supervising adult. Explain that joining, pausing, and changing activities are welcome throughout this gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Coach follows an invitation.** Invite children to show or point toward a comfortable movement such as reaching, stepping, or pausing. The coach tries a safe version from a separate space. Children may watch without offering an idea, and no public performance is required.
10-17 7 min	**Choose a group invitation.** Offer two movement pictures and invite a willing child to choose one for the group. Demonstrate it briefly, then invite everyone to try their own version or keep an independent activity. Rotate opportunities without requiring every child to lead.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Invite a willing neighbor.** Place willing partners on separate markers. One asks by gesture or words whether the other wants a movement idea, then offers a simple action. The neighbor can copy, adapt, or decline. Swap roles; a coach supports children choosing solo play.
26-32 6 min	**Our idea collection.** Collect two or three safe movement suggestions through pictures, gestures, or words. Open separate spaces for those ideas and let children choose. Adults adapt suggestions that need more space, explaining changes simply while preserving the child's contribution and voluntary participation.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Point to a picture and let the coach demonstrate the invitation.

Add challenge Offer two safe movement choices and let a willing partner decide.

Stop or change Stop invitations that become commands, pressured performances, touching, or movements beyond available space.

Look for Notice a child offering a choice or accepting another person's decision.

Ask What idea would you like to share?

Our Favorite Movement Menu

Goal Choose and revisit wrestling movement games while planning shared use of space.

Set up Pictures and separate areas for stance paths, solo entry steps, base-and-sit play, and no-touch mirroring.

Before you begin Use P01-P02 for stance steps, P04 for the standing entry step, and P09 for the solo sit-out. Confirm each chosen prerequisite.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Welcome each child to Grindstone and offer a quiet marker path or observation beside an adult. Show the day's stop signal. Children may stay with a preferred activity, take a supervised break, or finish with an authorized caregiver.
04-10 6 min	**Read the wrestling menu.** Show pictures for ready stance, a soft solo entry step, hands-and-knees base, and a low seated finish. Demonstrate each briefly in separate spaces. Invite children to point toward a favorite, while adults help preserve clear routes and welcome observation.
10-17 7 min	**Choose a Familiar Wrestling Skill.** Offer stance-step paths (P01-P02), standing level-change and step lanes (P04), and solo sit-outs (P09). Demonstrate each complete action, including the reset; the sit-out uses a cross-post, foot-out step and opposite-leg-through action. Children choose one familiar skill or watch. Assigned adults manage separate spaces and offer rest.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Share a movement choice.** Invite willing partners to choose separate stance spaces or individual floor areas. Each child shows a small stance step, gentle level change, or base position while the other may copy or watch. Coaches support different choices; partners never reposition one another.
26-32 6 min	**Plan the next celebration.** Invite children to point toward stance, entry-step, base, or seated-sit pictures they would enjoy again. Keep those movement areas open while adults note preferences. Children may change their minds, and resting or watching receives the same welcome as active movement.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Offer two familiar choices and a coach-supported version.

Add challenge Help suggest where an activity could happen with enough space for everyone.

Stop or change Pause for crowding, knee impact, collapsing support, rushed turns, or pressured participation.

Look for Notice a child communicating a preference and participating comfortably in their chosen area.

Ask What belongs on our next movement menu?

Grindstone Movement Celebration

Goal Celebrate chosen wrestling foundation movements, shared space, and each child's preferred participation.

Set up Spacious stations for stance paths, solo entry steps, base-to-seat movement, and no-touch mirroring.

Before you begin Use P01-P02 for stance steps, P04 for the standing entry step, and P09 for the solo sit-out. Confirm each chosen prerequisite.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-04 4 min	**Welcome and choose.** Offer children a choice of gentle movement or watching with a supervising adult as they arrive. Point out water, rest space, and the stop signal. Joining activities is voluntary; children can change choices throughout the gathering.
04-10 6 min	**Everyone's ready movement.** Invite a comfortable ready stance with feet apart, knees soft, and hands forward. Show small steps and a gentle level change, then relax. Children choose their own version or watch; the coach welcomes each child without ranking skill or effort.
10-17 7 min	**Choose a Familiar Wrestling Skill.** Offer stance-step paths (P01-P02), standing level-change and step lanes (P04), and solo sit-outs (P09). Demonstrate each complete action, including the reset; the sit-out uses a cross-post, foot-out step and opposite-leg-through action. Children choose one familiar skill or watch. Assigned adults manage separate spaces and offer rest.
17-19 2 min	**Water and reset.** Invite everyone to pause for water in the supervised rest space. Help children find their own bottles, leave clear walking routes, and choose whether to rejoin. Water and supervised breaks remain available throughout the gathering.
19-26 7 min	**Share a wrestling favorite.** Invite willing children to show a favorite stance step, level change, base position, or slow solo stand-up to a coach or partner across separate spaces. The other person may copy, wave, or watch. No audience, contact, or demonstration is required.
26-32 6 min	**Choose the final encore.** Offer the group's favorite movement choices for another round of relaxed play. Let each child decide where to finish, including a quiet option. Coaches share specific observations of curiosity, kindness, or communicating needs without comparing skills, bodies, or competitive potential.
32-35 3 min	**Reflect and goodbye.** Gather whoever wants to join and invite pointing, showing, or saying a favorite movement. Thank children for making room for one another. Offer a calm walk or observation while staff complete pickup with authorized adults.

Make it easier Stay at one favorite activity with a supervising adult nearby.

Add challenge Suggest a gentle variation and invite the coach to try it.

Stop or change Pause celebration activities if excitement creates crowding, rushed movement, or pressured participation.

Look for Notice a child choosing how to participate and leaving with a welcoming individual goodbye.

Ask What would you like Grindstone to offer next?

Keep these references close

These practice sequences are coaching designs. Use the current rules for your actual league or event, qualified technical instruction, and the club's medical and safeguarding procedures. Session numbers do not certify tournament readiness.

Grindstone Wrestling Club and Mat Rats
https://www.grindstonewrestling.org/mat-rats

Westminster Mat Rats Wrestling on Facebook
https://www.facebook.com/WestminsterMatRats/

USA Wrestling Folkstyle Level 1 technique demonstrations
https://www.usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/1

NFHS folkstyle rules resources; confirm youth event modifications
https://www.nfhs.org/sports/wrestling/rules

American Academy of Pediatrics sports readiness
https://www.healthychildren.org/English/healthy-living/sports/Pages/Is-Your-Child-Ready-for-Sports.aspx

CDC concussion response
https://www.cdc.gov/heads-up/response/index.html

CDC infection prevention for athletes
https://www.cdc.gov/mrsa/prevention/athletes.html

Coach reminders

Keep water available. Children participate at their normally nourished and hydrated weight. Remove suspected concussion from activity and obtain medical evaluation; no same-day return. Suspected contagious skin concerns need evaluation before contact. Follow actual club reporting and emergency procedures.

After practice

Which task helped the group learn? Who needs a different partner or an easier version? What should be repeated? Record private health or safeguarding matters through the club's secure process.

TAB 4 / 7-10

Ages 7-10 practice plans

30 foundation practices, 60 minutes each.

Content: binder pages 101-134
34 content pages

Coach / group: _____

Season: _____

GRINDSTONE WRESTLING

30 practice plans
Ages 7 to 10

Wrestling foundations

Thirty foundation practices for children ages 7 to 10. Each session gives the coach a timed sequence, specific partner tasks, clear cues, an easier option and an observable learning check.

60 minutes per plan | One practice per page
Timing, setup, teaching instructions, adjustments and a learning check.

Use the shared Coach Moves Reference for full teaching steps. The matching two-page handout provides quick cues and reference pages.

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grindstonewrestling.org

Run the practice

Choose the right pace

Two practices each week make a fifteen-week sequence. An optional extra practice should revisit familiar work. Repeat a plan when the group needs it; dates and practice numbers never override readiness.

Prepare the space

Have a clean wrestling mat, clear margins, timer, personal water bottles and the listed equipment ready. Flat markers must not slide. Confirm staffing, emergency contacts, medical restrictions and the venue emergency plan before arrivals.

Read the clock

The left column shows elapsed time from the start of practice. Demonstration, turns, rest and feedback belong inside each block. Short rounds repeat only while both partners remain controlled. Water is available throughout, beyond the planned break.

Give a clear task

Read the focus and prerequisite first. Demonstrate briefly, give one cue, let athletes try and offer one correction. Tell partners exactly which actions are allowed. Rehearse stopping and releasing before increasing resistance.

Match and supervise

Pair by size, maturity, skill, confidence and control. Coaches assign and observe partners. Stop for pain, distress, unsafe pressure, loss of control or crowding. Reduce simultaneous activity if every pair cannot be supervised.

Adjust without excluding

The easier and harder options change the task, not the child's place on the team. Offer observation, individual movement or cooperative rehearsal. Children may ask to stop at any time. Breaks remain supervised.

Progress the wrestling

Teach receiving, legal position and release before each new finish or turn. Progress from cooperative repetitions to the stated positional resistance after both partners show control. Entry-only drills stop at entry. Use only taught finishes and turns; no lifts, throws or mat returns. Stop at the task objective or signal.

Find a practice

Practice 01 starts on page 4. Click a title or use the PDF bookmarks.

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Space Stop And Belong

Goal Share mat space, stop promptly, and ask for a break.

Set up Flat nonslip markers, individual movement squares, water area, and a clearly marked supervised rest space.

Before you begin Athletes can understand a spoken or visual stop cue with support.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Traffic lights.** Give each athlete a personal square. Demonstrate walking, slowing, and freezing for two minutes. Run six rounds of 45 seconds moving and 15 seconds frozen. Use both spoken colors and a visible hand signal.
13-23 10 min	**Find your space.** Show a safe arm's length gap without touching anyone. For eight one-minute rounds after a two-minute demonstration, athletes walk to an empty marker, stop, and check nearby space. Reassign crowded markers; nobody races for a place.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Stop and ask.** Demonstrate saying or signaling stop, stepping back, and asking for help. In pairs without touching, alternate leader and follower every minute for eight minutes. The leader stops once each round; both freeze and acknowledge the signal.
35-45 10 min	**Follow a route.** Spend two minutes showing separate walking lanes and the rest area. Run eight one-minute rounds: follow one lane for 40 seconds, then return and reset for 20 seconds. Athletes choose walking or comfortable side steps.
45-55 10 min	**Find a free island.** Place more flat islands than children. Explain that everyone succeeds by finding open space. Use eight 45-second walking rounds with 15-second pauses after a two-minute demonstration. Children may stay on an island rather than move.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Follow a coach inside one personal square; use a visual stop cue.

Add challenge Change direction after stopping while maintaining the same safe spacing.

Stop or change Stop for collisions, boundary confusion, or distress; simplify the space before restarting.

Look for Athlete stops on cue and finds space without touching another child.

Ask What helped you feel comfortable on the mat?

Balance In Every Direction

Goal Move forward, backward, and sideways while staying balanced and aware of nearby athletes.

Set up Flat markers forming individual short lanes, with clear space behind each lane and a visible stop sign.

Before you begin Athletes stop on cue and stay inside their assigned movement space.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Compass walking.** Show forward, backward, left, and right inside separate lanes. Spend two minutes checking space, then run six 45-second movement rounds with 15-second rests. Call only one direction at a time; backward travel stays slow.
13-23 10 min	**Step and settle.** Demonstrate small steps with feet comfortably apart, knees soft, and eyes forward. After two minutes, use eight one-minute rounds: move for 30 seconds, settle for 30 seconds. Children pause whenever they need to regain balance.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Mirror without contact.** Pair athletes in neighboring squares with a clear gap. Demonstrate for two minutes, then use eight rounds of 30 seconds leading and 30 seconds resting. Alternate leaders each round; the follower copies steps without approaching.
35-45 10 min	**Change direction safely.** Lay three markers within each athlete's area. Explain the route for two minutes. For eight one-minute rounds, athletes move between markers for 40 seconds and rest for 20 seconds. Call stop before every direction change.
45-55 10 min	**Balance statues.** Invite children to choose a stable two-foot pose. After a two-minute demonstration, run eight 45-second movement rounds and 15-second statue pauses. Partners notice balance without judging appearance; no pushing, one-foot contests, or elimination.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Use forward and sideways walking only with a coach nearby.

Add challenge Respond to an unexpected direction cue after a complete balanced stop.

Stop or change Stop for repeated stumbling, pain, or movement outside the personal lane.

Look for Athlete changes direction without crossing feet excessively or entering another athlete's space.

Ask Which direction needed your smallest, most careful steps?

Build A Comfortable Wrestling Stance

Goal Maintain a balanced stance while taking short steps and keeping eyes forward.

Set up Individual mat squares, flat direction markers, and enough room for coaches to observe every athlete.

Before you begin Athletes move and stop with control without colliding or needing partner support.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Ready position freezes.** Spend two minutes showing a comfortable athletic position. Run six rounds of 45 seconds walking and 15 seconds freezing. Athletes soften knees, keep feet apart, and hold hands loosely forward without crouching into discomfort.
13-23 10 min	**Stance and short steps.** Demonstrate feet comfortably apart, one foot slightly forward, knees bent, and head upright. Use two teaching minutes and eight one-minute rounds of 30 seconds stepping and 30 seconds rest. Keep steps small; never force deep crouching.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Follow the stance leader.** Use pairs in separate facing squares with no contact. Demonstrate for two minutes, then alternate leaders through eight one-minute rounds: 30 seconds stance movement, 30 seconds feedback and rest. Followers preserve space rather than chasing.
35-45 10 min	**Protect your balance.** Give each athlete front, side, and rear markers within a small area. After a two-minute demonstration, call routes through eight 40-second movement rounds with 20-second resets. Athletes pause and rebuild stance whenever balance slips.
45-55 10 min	**Stance traffic lights.** Explain green means short stance steps, yellow means slow steps, and red means freeze. Demonstrate for two minutes, then run eight 45-second rounds with 15-second rests. Everyone stays in personal space and chooses comfortable depth.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Use a taller stance and shorter movement rounds.

Add challenge Change lead foot during the reset, then maintain balance using the other stance.

Stop or change Stop for knee or back discomfort, head-down posture, or uncontrolled crossing into another square.

Look for Athlete takes several short steps and stops with feet apart and head upright.

Ask What helped your stance feel strong without feeling stiff?

Lower Your Level With Control

Goal Bend through hips and knees while keeping the head upright and movement comfortable.

Set up Personal mat squares, flat foot markers, and a coach-visible station for each small group.

Before you begin Athletes can hold a comfortable stance and stop their movement independently.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Tall and ready.** Show standing tall and settling into a comfortable stance. For six one-minute rounds after two demonstration minutes, alternate 30 seconds easy walking with 30 seconds stance resets. Keep head upright and avoid bouncing deeply.
13-23 10 min	**Slow level changes.** Demonstrate lowering slightly by bending hips and knees while keeping eyes forward. After two minutes, complete eight one-minute rounds: three slow changes, then relax until the next cue. No knee drops, lunging, or partner contact.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Shadow the level.** Assign partners separate facing squares. Spend two minutes showing slow up-and-down movement. Run eight rounds of 30 seconds copying and 30 seconds rest, swapping leaders each round. Followers choose their own comfortable depth rather than matching exactly.
35-45 10 min	**Level then step.** Show a small level change followed by one short forward step and a balanced stop. After two minutes, use eight 30-second work and 30-second reset rounds. Return to the starting marker between attempts; remain entirely noncontact.
45-55 10 min	**High middle ready.** Demonstrate three comfortable positions: tall, slightly lowered, and ready stance. Run eight 45-second rounds with 15-second rests after two instruction minutes. Children choose the correct position from visual cards; everyone succeeds through controlled movement.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Make a very small knee bend and omit the forward step.

Add challenge Choose whether to lower or step first in response to a visual cue.

Stop or change Stop for painful bending, knee impact, diving, or loss of balance.

Look for Athlete lowers and rises with head upright and feet under control.

Ask How did you lower your body without dropping your head?

Be A Trustworthy Practice Partner

Goal Practice consent, immediate release, light contact, and predictable partner roles.

Set up Clearly separated partner stations, flat markers, supervised rest area, and visible stop signal.

Before you begin Both athletes willingly accept the task and can stop on spoken or visual cues.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**No contact mirrors.** Explain that partners keep a clear gap and copy easy stepping. After two minutes, run six rounds of 30 seconds movement and 30 seconds reset. Swap leaders every round; no athlete must approach an uncomfortable distance.
13-23 10 min	**Ask touch release.** Demonstrate asking permission for one light open-hand shoulder touch, then removing the hand immediately. Use two teaching minutes and eight one-minute rounds: one touch each, then discuss comfort. A no-contact pointing version is equally successful.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Practice both stop signals.** Demonstrate a spoken stop and raised open hand. Use eight one-minute rounds after two teaching minutes. One athlete briefly rests an open hand on the other's shoulder; either signal means release and step apart immediately.
35-45 10 min	**Predictable partner roles.** Explain one athlete leads a single side step while the other follows without touching. After two minutes, run eight 30-second practice and 30-second rest rounds. Swap roles each round and ask whether the pace felt comfortable.
45-55 10 min	**Partner movement puzzle.** Show a three-action puzzle: step sideways, freeze, then turn toward your own marker. After two minutes, use eight one-minute rounds. Partners copy together for 40 seconds and choose a new comfortable sequence during the 20-second reset.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Use no contact and practice signals with a coach.

Add challenge Respond to either partner's stop signal at an unpredictable moment during noncontact movement.

Stop or change Stop for pressure, grabbing, unwanted contact, teasing, or any failure to release.

Look for Athlete asks before contact and removes the hand immediately when either partner signals stop.

Ask What did your partner do that helped you trust them?

Prepare For Safe Receiving

Goal Explore controlled floor lowering and rebuilding balance before any partner takedown work.

Set up Clear mat stations, one qualified coach observing each active lowering station, and separate noncontact waiting activities.

Before you begin No partner takedowns; a qualified coach screens each athlete's controlled floor movement individually.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Walk kneel stand.** Demonstrate slow walking, stopping, and lowering to comfortable kneeling using hands for support. After two minutes, use six 30-second movement and 30-second rest rounds. Athletes may remain standing if kneeling hurts or feels uncertain.
13-23 10 min	**Low side lowering.** A qualified coach demonstrates from side-sitting: lower gently onto the side and return seated, keeping head clear of the mat. Use eight one-minute individually observed turns after two teaching minutes. No standing falls or partner pushing.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Build your base.** Demonstrate moving from side-sitting onto hands and knees, then pausing balanced. After two minutes, use eight one-minute rounds: one careful transition, a return to sitting, and rest. Coaches watch head clearance and comfortable joint positions.
35-45 10 min	**Individual receiving check.** Explain that this is preparation, not permission for takedowns. During eight one-minute turns after two instruction minutes, each athlete shows a controlled floor lowering and return. The qualified coach records readiness or assigns continued solo practice.
45-55 10 min	**Choose your safe route.** Set separate markers for standing, seated, and hands-and-knees positions. After two minutes, run eight 40-second movement rounds with 20-second pauses. Athletes choose comfortable transitions inside their station; nobody pushes, pulls, rolls over, or races a partner.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Remain seated and practice a small supported lean with direct coach supervision.

Add challenge Link two coach-approved floor transitions while maintaining head clearance and a calm pace.

Stop or change Stop for head contact, discomfort, sudden dropping, fear, or any attempt to push a partner.

Look for Athlete lowers and returns with control under direct observation; coach identifies the next appropriate task.

Ask How can you tell a coach that a movement does not feel safe yet?

Build The Double Leg Entry

Goal Learn a balanced double-leg entry before adding any finish.

Set up Separated partner stations, flat lead-foot markers, fitted ear guards for contact, and coach-visible boundaries.

Before you begin Review B03 and the entry steps of B07. This lesson stops after leg collection; receiving must be taught before any finish.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Step and lower.** Demonstrate a comfortable stance, small knee bend, and short forward step. After two minutes, run six rounds of 30 seconds practicing and 30 seconds resting. Athletes work alone and return to their own marker after each attempt.
13-23 10 min	**Learn - Double-Leg Entry.** Show a right-foot level change and step between their feet; right knee touches softly. Head stays on your left at their right ribs; left hand cups their right knee and right hand their left knee. Bring the left trail foot up. Pause, release and reset without a finish. After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute turns.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Build the entry shape.** After two teaching minutes, alternate roles through eight 30-second rehearsal and 30-second rest rounds. Receiver stays balanced; attacker changes level, steps in, and brings the trailing foot underneath. Coach checks head position and knee comfort; no finish is introduced yet.
35-45 10 min	**Check before connecting.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute turns. Attacker enters only after receiver signals ready, then pauses with hands behind the thighs. Coach checks balance, head position, and comfortable contact. Release and reset; athletes needing support use empty-space footwork.
45-55 10 min	**Entry checkpoint partners.** After two teaching minutes, run eight 40-second rehearsal and 20-second rest rounds. Partners alternate one entry and identify three checkpoints: level changed first, head upright beside torso, and feet underneath. Successful repetitions finish with controlled release, not a takedown.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Rehearse level change and entry footwork toward floor markers without contact.

Add challenge Connect level change and trailing-foot recovery smoothly while the receiver remains stationary.

Stop or change Stop for crown-first contact, knee impact, lifting, loss of balance, or an attempted finish before it is taught.

Look for Athlete enters with head upright, hands behind the thighs, and both partners balanced.

Ask How did you know your partner was ready for your entry?

Build A Controlled Single Entry

Goal Rehearse a light single-leg collection with the partner's foot remaining on the mat.

Set up Wide partner stations, flat foot markers, fitted ear guards, and qualified coaches close enough to interrupt contact.

Before you begin Use B08 only to check head-inside position and grips. The foot stays down for this entry lesson; release without pulling or turning.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Stance step reset.** Demonstrate a small level change, short entry step, and immediate return to stance without a partner. Use six 30-second work and 30-second rest rounds after two minutes. Athletes keep eyes forward and their movements unhurried.
13-23 10 min	**Learn - Single-Leg Entry.** For their right leg, level-change and step close with your head inside, left temple beside their right ribs. Left arm wraps outside, right arm inside, hands lightly meet behind the knee. Keep their foot down and do not pull or turn. Release before stepping away. After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute cooperative turns.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**One calm entry.** Spend two minutes checking head position and receiver comfort. Run eight rounds of 30 seconds rehearsal and 30 seconds rest, swapping roles each round. Attempt one light collection at a time, release, and rebuild separate balanced stances.
35-45 10 min	**Stop before imbalance.** Demonstrate that either partner can stop the entry before the arms surround the leg. Use eight one-minute rounds after two instruction minutes. Receiver remains still; attacker approaches slowly, collects lightly if comfortable, and releases before any balance changes.
45-55 10 min	**Entry accuracy stations.** Mark a starting point and return point at each pair's station. After two minutes, use eight 40-second practice and 20-second rest rounds. Partners earn a shared point for permission, upright posture, gentle entry, and a balanced return.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Use one open-hand thigh touch; omit the arm collection.

Add challenge Alternate the receiver's lead leg between attempts while keeping the task cooperative and stationary.

Stop or change Stop for head-down posture, gripping near the knee joint, squeezing, pulling, lifting, or any receiver imbalance.

Look for Athlete collects lightly above the knee and releases while both remain balanced and comfortable.

Ask What kept your partner comfortable during the collection?

Double Leg Takedown

Goal Complete a low-amplitude double-leg takedown with controlled receiving and balanced top position.

Set up Spaced receiving lanes, flat foot markers, fitted ear guards, and qualified coaches.

Before you begin Review B07. Individually confirm a low side-hip landing without a straight-arm post before adding a standing entry.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Prepare to enter and receive.** After two demonstration minutes, alternate six 30-second movement and 30-second rest rounds. Rehearse entry footwork separately from low side-lowering onto the hip and side. Receivers keep the head clear and avoid a locked-arm post; coaches check each athlete individually.
13-23 10 min	**Learn - B07.** Demonstrate from a low right-foot entry: head on your left at their right ribs, hands behind both knees. Step the left trail foot outside their right foot. Drive diagonally right while gathering knees left; receiver lowers onto their left hip and side. Follow without dropping weight. After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute cooperative turns.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Receive before standing finishes.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute turns. Coach checks each receiver's low-start descent before approving cooperative standing finishes. Attacker turns the corner without lifting or dumping; receiver lowers with the action. Stop, settle balanced top control, release, and swap.
35-45 10 min	**Finish against one early step.** After two teaching minutes, use twelve 20-second attempts with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved defenders may take one early retreat step; once legs are secured, receive the controlled finish. Stop at balanced top control. Novices rehearse entries or low-start finishes.
45-55 10 min	**Complete the control checklist.** After two teaching minutes, use eight 40-second rehearsal and 20-second rest rounds. Partners complete one coach-approved finish each, then identify upright head, controlled descent, and balanced top control. Receiving quality matters equally; repeat from the lower start whenever control deteriorates.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Use entry-only work or a coach-guided low-start finish with a cooperative receiver.

Add challenge Adjust to one early retreat, then finish through the balanced opening.

Stop or change Stop for head or neck compression, locked-arm posting, airborne lifting, slamming, knee twisting, or uncontrolled descent.

Look for Pair completes a coached double-leg finish with controlled receiving and balanced top position.

Ask What helped partners control the finish?

Keep Your Legs Out Of Reach

Goal Use a short retreating step and a balanced stance to defend an entry touch.

Set up Separate partner lanes with rear safety space, flat start markers, fitted ear guards, and visible stop signal.

Before you begin Athletes can step backward under control and keep their eyes forward.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Backward stance lanes.** Demonstrate one short backward step followed by a balanced pause. After two minutes, use six 30-second movement and 30-second rest rounds. Athletes work alone, check rear space first, and stop before reaching their lane boundary.
13-23 10 min	**See and step back.** Demonstrate an attacker slowly reaching toward the front thigh while the defender takes one short step back. After two minutes, use eight one-minute turns. Keep hands open and heads apart; stop after the reach, whether it touches or misses.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**One reach one response.** Spend two minutes assigning attacker and defender roles. Use eight 30-second work and 30-second reset rounds, alternating roles. Attacker makes one slow thigh-touch attempt; defender retreats once and resets. No pursuit, pushing the head, or sprawling onto partners.
35-45 10 min	**Defend without fleeing.** Mark a comfortable backstop line well inside the station. After two minutes, run eight one-minute rounds: one slow entry attempt, one controlled defensive step, then reset forward together. Defender stops immediately at the line rather than backing farther.
45-55 10 min	**Protect the marker.** Give each athlete a personal rear marker. Demonstrate for two minutes, then use eight 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Partners take turns making one slow reach; defender preserves balance before the marker. Count controlled responses, not misses.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Attacker points from outside touching distance; defender practices the single retreating step.

Add challenge Attacker varies the start moment within a slow agreed count; still allow only one reach.

Stop or change Stop for blind retreating, pursuit, head contact, pushing, or movement near another pair.

Look for Defender takes one controlled step and remains facing the partner inside the assigned area.

Ask How did you make space without running away?

Move Around To The Hips

Goal Practice a grounded go-behind route without pulling the head or pushing a partner.

Set up Separated grounded partner stations, fitted ear guards, flat side markers, and a qualified coach overseeing every active pair.

Before you begin Both athletes tolerate hands-and-knees positioning; the receiver can remain still and request immediate release.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Hands knees stand.** Demonstrate moving from comfortable kneeling to hands and knees, then returning slowly to standing. After two minutes, run six 30-second practice and 30-second rest rounds. Work individually; use hands for support and keep head clear of the mat.
13-23 10 min	**Circle outside the arms.** Demonstrate the receiver holding a comfortable hands-and-knees base. The mover begins beside one shoulder, travels slowly outside the arm line to the hip, and touches the waist lightly. Use eight one-minute turns after two teaching minutes.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Touch hip and release.** Spend two minutes checking space around each base. Run eight 30-second practice and 30-second rest rounds, swapping roles. Mover circles on knees without climbing over arms, touches the waist with an open hand, then releases and returns.
35-45 10 min	**Pick the open side.** Place a flat marker beside either side of the receiver. After two minutes, use eight one-minute rounds. Coach points to the open route; mover travels outside the arms to that hip. Receiver remains still; no head holds or driving.
45-55 10 min	**Grounded route puzzle.** Demonstrate a start marker, outside route, and finish marker beside the hip. After two minutes, run eight 40-second rounds with 20-second resets. Partners complete one controlled route, release, swap, and praise safe spacing; nobody races or blocks.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Circle around a foam pad or flat marker instead of a partner.

Add challenge Choose the other side after each reset while keeping the receiver completely cooperative.

Stop or change Stop for pressure on the head or neck, crossing over arms, climbing, knee collisions, or receiver discomfort.

Look for Mover reaches the hip by an outside route without disturbing the receiver's stable base.

Ask Which route let you reach the hip without pushing your partner?

Choose Attack Or Safe Defense

Goal Apply the double-leg entry and finish against one controlled early retreat.

Set up Separated standing lanes, flat lead-foot markers, fitted ear guards, and two visible role cards.

Before you begin Coach approves entries, receiving, and controlled finishes before resistance; other athletes keep entry-only roles. Use B07 for the double-leg finish.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Color cue stance.** Assign one color to forward stance stepping and another to a single backward step. Demonstrate for two minutes, then run six 40-second movement and 20-second rest rounds. Athletes stay in personal squares and freeze before changing direction.
13-23 10 min	**Read attack and defense.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute cooperative turns. Attacker rehearses the double-leg pathway; defender shows one early retreat step, then receives if the entry connects. Coach distinguishes a safe opening from a closed target that requires an immediate reset.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Swap after every reset.** After two teaching minutes, alternate roles through eight 30-second rehearsal and 30-second rest rounds. Use one early defensive step before contact. Approved attackers finish only from a balanced entry; others stop at entry. Receivers cooperate with every descent and release.
35-45 10 min	**One defense one attack.** After two teaching minutes, run twelve 20-second attempts with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved attackers seek the double-leg finish; defenders may retreat once before contact, then receive safely. Stop on top control or a closed entry. Novices use entry-only versions.
45-55 10 min	**Attack defense and reset.** After two teaching minutes, run eight 40-second rehearsal and 20-second rest rounds. Partners alternate a coach-approved attack and defense, naming whether the opening supported finishing or resetting. Each athlete practices both roles; receiving and sensible resets receive equal attention.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Announce the early retreat and keep the attack entry-only.

Add challenge Choose whether to finish or reset after the same early retreat, without chasing.

Stop or change Stop for crown-first contact, joint pressure, uncontrolled descent, lifting, slamming, or pursuit after a closed entry.

Look for Athlete chooses a controlled finish or appropriate reset after one permitted early defense.

Ask What helped you remember whether you were attacking or defending?

Find A Strong Bottom Base

Goal Build and recover a comfortable hands-and-knees base without loading the head or neck.

Set up Individual floor stations, flat hand and knee markers if helpful, fitted ear guards for any partner proximity.

Before you begin Athletes can move onto hands and knees comfortably and communicate pain or uncertainty.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Floor position choices.** Demonstrate comfortable side-sitting, kneeling, and hands-and-knees positions with head clear of the mat. After two minutes, run six 30-second movement and 30-second rest rounds. Athletes choose two positions and move slowly between them without rolling over.
13-23 10 min	**Build the base.** Show hands under shoulders, knees under hips, fingers relaxed, and head upright. After two minutes, use eight one-minute turns. Athletes settle into base briefly, sit back to rest, then rebuild without locking elbows or dropping the head.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Recover from side sitting.** Demonstrate returning from side-sitting onto hands and knees using comfortable hand support. After two minutes, run eight 30-second practice and 30-second rest rounds. Partners observe from separate spaces and name one stable feature without touching or correcting forcefully.
35-45 10 min	**Base after a small move.** Show shifting one hand a short distance and replacing it while the other supports remain comfortable. After two minutes, use eight one-minute rounds. Athletes make one small adjustment, rebuild base, and rest; coaches check control rather than speed.
45-55 10 min	**Base picture match.** Show cards for seated, kneeling, and stable base positions. Demonstrate for two minutes, then use eight 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Athletes choose a card, assume its comfortable version, and let a partner identify it without contact.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Use seated and kneeling positions only, or shorten time bearing weight through the hands.

Add challenge Recover base after two small self-directed hand or knee adjustments.

Stop or change Stop for wrist or knee pain, elbow locking, head contact, or a partner attempting to push the base.

Look for Athlete rebuilds a balanced base with head clear of the mat and comfortable hand support.

Ask Which parts of your base helped you feel balanced?

Inside-Leg Stand-Up Footwork

Goal Rehearse B17 stand-up footwork solo, then turn into a balanced stance.

Set up Separate floor-to-standing lanes, flat foot markers, clear overhead space, and a qualified coach observing rises.

Before you begin Review B17. This inside-leg version starts with the left foot for a rider on the left; it differs from P08 outside-leg footwork.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Kneel step balance.** Show kneeling, placing one foot flat forward, and pausing in a comfortable half-kneel. After two minutes, run six 30-second practice and 30-second rest rounds. Athletes alternate the forward foot and use hands for balance when necessary.
13-23 10 min	**Learn - Solo B17 Footwork.** Imagine a rider on the left. From base, plant the left foot beside the right knee and lift the chest; left elbow comes back without swinging. Rise with bent knees, rehearse hand control at the belly, move hips forward, and turn right with both feet free. After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute solo turns.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Rise then face.** Place a partner several steps away as a visual target only. After two demonstration minutes, use eight 30-second work and 30-second rest rounds. Athlete stands from base, balances, then turns toward the partner without twisting while rising.
35-45 10 min	**Wait for clear space.** Demonstrate checking that the standing lane is empty before starting. After two minutes, run eight one-minute rounds. Athletes complete one controlled stand-up and balanced turn while partners observe from outside the lane; swap after each round.
45-55 10 min	**Stand up sequence.** Display pictures for base, planted foot, standing, and facing forward. After two minutes, run eight 40-second rounds with 20-second rests. Athletes complete the sequence once, identify the easiest step, and repeat only while movement stays comfortable.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Start from a comfortable half-kneel or practice only the planted-foot position.

Add challenge Use either lead foot while maintaining the same slow, balanced rise.

Stop or change Stop for backward head throwing, loss of balance, joint pain, dizziness, or anyone entering the standing lane.

Look for Athlete rises without contact, pauses balanced, and turns only after standing securely.

Ask Where did you place your foot to help yourself stand?

Inside-Leg Stand-Up Escape

Goal Control the waist wrist, rise with balance, clear contact, and face the opponent.

Set up Matched stations, clear standing lanes, fitted ear guards, and qualified coaches.

Before you begin Check B14-B15 starts before B17. Partner follows lightly without a mat return; confirm hand control, hip clearance and a balanced right turn.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Base and free stand.** Demonstrate stable base, a planted foot, slow standing, and a balanced turn. After two minutes, run six 30-second work and 30-second rest rounds. Athletes practice alone; waiting partners remain outside the standing lane and offer one supportive observation.
13-23 10 min	**Learn - B17.** With rider on the left, plant the left foot beside the right knee and lift the chest. Right hand controls the rider's right hand near its wrist; left elbow stays close. Rise, hold the hand away, move hips forward and turn right to face. After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute cooperative turns; no finger grips.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Follow without returning.** After two teaching minutes, use eight 30-second practice and 30-second reset rounds. Top maintains light waist contact while bottom controls the wrist and rises. Top follows without locking hands or pulling backward, then releases at standing; no mat return is allowed.
35-45 10 min	**Clear then complete the escape.** After two teaching minutes, run twelve 20-second attempts with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved bottom athletes control the waist wrist and rise; top maintains light contact while grounded, releasing at standing. Bottom clears and faces. Novices separate clearing from solo rising.
45-55 10 min	**Hand control escape checklist.** After two teaching minutes, run eight 40-second rehearsal and 20-second rest rounds. Partners alternate the coached stand-up, checking whole-hand wrist control, balanced foot placement, and a clear facing finish. Top releases at standing; coach reduces resistance if bottom loses balance.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Clear cooperatively, have top release, then rise unsupported.

Add challenge Control the wrist while top follows the grounded phase with light waist contact.

Stop or change Stop for finger gripping, wrist twisting, locked hands, backward pulling, loss of balance, or any attempted mat return.

Look for Bottom controls the wrist, rises balanced, clears contact, and faces.

Ask How did hand control help your balance during the escape?

Learn A Safe Top Position

Goal Use a controlled top starting position with open hands and immediate release.

Set up Separate grounded partner stations, fitted ear guards, current event starting-position card, and qualified coach supervision.

Before you begin Review B14-B15 and the event starting procedure. Check light contacts, legal leg placement and stillness before any whistle response.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Side kneeling routes.** Demonstrate moving on knees around a flat marker while leaving room for imaginary arms and legs. After two minutes, run six 30-second practice and 30-second rest rounds. Keep head upright, move slowly, and stop before entering another station.
13-23 10 min	**Learn - B14 and B15.** Bottom sets legally and becomes still. On the referee cue, top starts left: left knee outside bottom's left knee, right foot behind the feet on that side. Left palm rests lightly behind the left elbow; right palm covers the belly button. Keep legs clear and head above mid-back. After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute setup/release turns.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Start on the signal.** Use two minutes to demonstrate stillness before the start cue and release on stop. Run eight 30-second practice and 30-second rest rounds. Top assumes the checked position with light contact; bottom remains comfortable. No squeezing, locked hands, or breakdowns.
35-45 10 min	**Follow one base adjustment.** Demonstrate bottom moving one hand or knee a few inches while top stays beside the hips. After two minutes, use eight one-minute rounds. Top follows with open-hand waist contact only, then releases; bottom never rises during contact.
45-55 10 min	**Correct the safe start.** After a two-minute demonstration, use eight 40-second rounds and 20-second rests. Partners assemble a comfortable checked start, freeze briefly, and ask the coach to observe one feature. Both release and swap; children do not physically reposition each other.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Practice top knee placement beside a foam pad without touching another athlete.

Add challenge Use a slower or delayed start cue while keeping both athletes still and relaxed.

Stop or change Stop for locked hands, neck contact, heavy downward pressure, squeezing, or discomfort in the bottom athlete.

Look for Top places hands lightly in the checked start and releases immediately without disturbing the bottom athlete.

Ask How can a top wrestler show control without using unnecessary force?

Tight Waist Chop

Goal Use a tight-waist and near-arm chop breakdown, then maintain balanced legal top control.

Set up Spaced grounded stations, fitted ear guards, and qualified coaches checking contact.

Before you begin Review B22. Confirm a bent-elbow descent, gentle rear-knee hip drive and cross-wrist capture before adding a rebuild response.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Slow base travel.** Show one small hand-and-knee advance followed by a stable pause. After two minutes, run six 30-second movement and 30-second rest rounds. Athletes work individually inside a short lane; travel stops before the head lowers or supports become crowded.
13-23 10 min	**Learn - B22.** From a left-side start, snug the right waist arm. Left forearm folds their left elbow toward the belly as toes drive forward and the rear right knee moves their hips forward. Bottom lowers through forearms to belly. Right hand catches their left wrist across the belly; left hand controls that upper arm. After two teaching minutes, use eight cooperative turns.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Receive and Catch the Wrist.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute turns. Coordinate a short elbow fold with forward foot and rear-knee drive. Bottom yields through a bent elbow to forearms and belly. Catch the left wrist with the right hand, keep it below the chest, and follow the hips. Release and swap; no striking or arm wrenching.
35-45 10 min	**Breakdown versus base adjustment.** After two teaching minutes, run twelve 20-second rounds with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved top athletes seek the taught breakdown; bottom resists by small base adjustments only, keeping elbows unlocked. Stop at controlled belly-down position, standing, or discomfort. Novices cooperate.
45-55 10 min	**Breakdown and rebuild challenge.** After two teaching minutes, use sixteen 15-second rounds with 15-second feedback/rest. Approved top athletes use the taught chop; bottom maintains base through small adjustments. Stop at controlled breakdown, then release so bottom rebuilds. Swap roles; novices keep the receiving task cooperative.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Practice hand placement and receiving separately before combining.

Add challenge Read one small base adjustment before coordinating the same waist draw and chop.

Stop or change Stop for straight-arm wrenching, joint pain, neck pressure, trapped fingers, uncontrolled collapse, or any mat return.

Look for Top completes a controlled breakdown while bottom receives onto forearms and both release promptly.

Ask How did timing help more than pulling harder?

Escape From Controlled Top Contact

Goal Rebuild base after a controlled breakdown and use hand control to stand and clear.

Set up Matched stations, clear standing lanes, fitted ear guards, and qualified coaches.

Before you begin Coach approves breakdown receiving, base recovery, and hand-controlled rising before resistance; novices use separate cooperative steps. Rebuild base using B16: outside knee up, hips back, other knee underneath. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up. Use B22 for the chop and wrist capture.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Base clear rise solo.** Demonstrate base, an imaginary wrist clear, planting a foot, standing, and facing forward. After two minutes, use six 30-second work and 30-second rest rounds. Athletes move independently and pause between steps rather than rushing the whole sequence.
13-23 10 min	**Learn - B16 to B17.** After a cooperative breakdown, bottom brings the outside knee alongside, shifts hips back and brings the other knee under to build base (B16). With rider left, use B17: left foot up, right hand controls their right hand, rise, clear hips and turn right. After two teaching minutes, use eight cooperative turns with a pause between skills.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**One top action then escape.** After two teaching minutes, use eight 30-second practice and 30-second reset rounds. Top performs one controlled breakdown, then maintains light waist contact while bottom rebuilds and controls the wrist. Top follows lightly without a mat return; neither athlete adds a new counter or return.
35-45 10 min	**Base and escape rounds.** After two teaching minutes, run twelve 20-second rounds with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved bottom athletes rebuild base and seek the hand-controlled stand-up; top follows with light waist contact only. Stop at standing or clearance, with no returns. Novices cooperate.
45-55 10 min	**Three stage escape circuit.** After two teaching minutes, run eight 40-second rehearsal and 20-second rest rounds at staffed stations: controlled breakdown receiving, rebuilding base, and hand-controlled stand-up. Alternate partners' roles; connect stages only after coach approval, and reduce to cooperative work whenever control deteriorates.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Practice base recovery alone, then clear cooperative waist contact before an unsupported rise.

Add challenge After one controlled breakdown, choose when to control the wrist and rise.

Stop or change Stop for wrist twisting, finger gripping, neck pressure, backward pulling, loss of balance, or any attempted mat return.

Look for Bottom rebuilds base and uses hand control to reach a balanced standing escape.

Ask How did rebuilding base help?

Go Behind And Establish Control

Goal Connect a grounded go-behind to a stable, legal top-control position against a limited response.

Set up Separated grounded stations, fitted ear guards, flat start markers, and qualified coaches able to interrupt each pair.

Before you begin Coach approves both partners' legal contact, balance, control, and immediate release before resistance; novices rehearse cooperatively.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Circle a floor target.** Demonstrate slow knee travel around a flat marker without crossing over it. After two minutes, use six 30-second movement and 30-second rest rounds. Keep eyes up and knees clear of imaginary partner arms; change direction only during rest.
13-23 10 min	**Route into control.** Show receiver holding base while mover circles outside the arms to behind the hips. Place one open hand at waist and one at upper arm without locking. After two minutes, use eight one-minute turns; coach checks legal control, then release.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**One permitted pivot.** After two minutes demonstrating roles, use eight one-minute rounds containing a five-second attempt each way and rest. Receiver may make one small kneeling pivot; mover seeks the outside route and stable hip control. No grabbing the head or climbing.
35-45 10 min	**Earn controlled position.** After two teaching minutes, run twelve 20-second attempts with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved movers seek legal hip-and-near-arm control; defenders pivot to face. Stop on control, standing, or lost safety. Novices use cooperative routes.
45-55 10 min	**Control or face challenge.** After two teaching minutes, repeat twelve 20-second rounds and 20-second feedback/rest periods. Coach-approved pairs challenge hip control against facing pivots. Recognize controlled objectives and immediate release; alternate roles, while novices rehearse cooperative routes without a contested outcome.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Receiver remains still; mover completes the outside route cooperatively.
Add challenge After a defended first route, change direction while preserving safe space and legal hip-and-near-arm control.
Stop or change Stop for neck holds, joint pressure, limb tangling, uncontrolled scrambling, standing, or failure to release.
Look for Mover reaches stable coach-confirmed legal control without head pressure and releases immediately.
Ask What made the finish controlled rather than simply touching the hips?

Stand Clear And Face Your Partner

Goal Complete the hand-controlled stand-up against light, limited top resistance.

Set up Matched partner stations, open standing lanes, fitted ear guards, and qualified coaches overseeing contact-to-standing transitions.

Before you begin Review B17. Confirm inside-leg rise, retained hand control and hip clearance before the right turn; top follows without a mat return.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Rise turn balance.** Demonstrate a solo rise from base, a balanced pause, then turning to face a distant marker. After two minutes, run six 30-second work and 30-second rest rounds. Keep the neck neutral and feet under control throughout.
13-23 10 min	**Learn - B17 With a Follower.** Demonstrate B17 with rider left: left foot up, chest lifted, right hand controls their right hand near the wrist. Rise, hold that hand away, clear hips forward and turn right to face. Top follows lightly and lets the hand clear without twisting. After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute cooperative turns.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Follow without returning.** After two teaching minutes, alternate roles through eight 30-second practice and 30-second reset rounds. Top follows the controlled rise without locking hands or pulling backward. Bottom maintains whole-hand wrist control; top follows lightly without a mat return before bottom clears and faces.
35-45 10 min	**Stand against light contact.** After two teaching minutes, run twelve 20-second attempts with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved bottom athletes seek the taught stand-up; top maintains light waist contact while grounded, then releases at standing. Stop on escape or standing. Novices cooperate.
45-55 10 min	**Hand control escape challenge.** After two teaching minutes, use sixteen 15-second attempts with 15-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved pairs use controlled waist contact and the taught stand-up, stopping at standing or escape. Discuss which hand-control adjustment helped; novices clear first and rise without contact.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Top releases before the rise; bottom practices standing and facing separately.

Add challenge Keep wrist control while rising as top follows lightly, then clear and face without losing balance.

Stop or change Stop for finger grips, wrist twisting, backward pulling, lost balance, locked hands, or attempted mat returns.

Look for Bottom controls the wrist, rises balanced, clears contact, and faces the partner.

Ask Why should the turn happen after you have found your balance?

Connect A Takedown To Top Control

Goal Finish a controlled double leg and establish balanced top control.

Set up Wide receiving lanes, fitted ear guards, and qualified coaches supervising transitions.

Before you begin Coach approves entry, controlled receiving, and top control before standing finishes; novices use low starts. Use B07 for the double-leg finish.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Two stance steps and stop.** Show two small stance steps, a slight level change, and a balanced freeze. After two minutes, use six 40-second work and 20-second rest rounds. Athletes work individually and return slowly to their start markers after each sequence.
13-23 10 min	**Finish and settle.** Demonstrate an upright double-leg entry, gather behind thighs, and step around to steer a controlled hip-and-side descent. Follow into balanced top control without crossing the head. After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute turns; novices begin low or rehearse separately.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Check both landing roles.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute turns. Receiver practices controlled descent without a locked-arm post; attacker stays balanced and follows the hips. Coach approves each pair before standing starts. Pause at top control, release completely, and alternate roles.
35-45 10 min	**Finish against one retreat.** After two teaching minutes, run twelve 20-second attempts with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved defenders may retreat once before contact, then receive cooperatively. Attackers finish only balanced entries and settle legal top control. Stop there; novices use low-start repetitions.
45-55 10 min	**Takedown and control team task.** After two teaching minutes, use eight 40-second rehearsal and 20-second rest rounds. Partners alternate a controlled double-leg finish and top-control pause, checking entry balance, receiver descent, and head clearance. Choose low or standing starts according to coach approval; reset whenever control fades.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Start low for the finish, or rehearse entry and top control separately.

Add challenge Read an early retreat, finish through a balanced opening, and settle top control.

Stop or change Stop for crown-first entry, uncontrolled descent, locked-arm posts, lifts, slams, knee twisting, or compressed head or neck.

Look for Pair completes a controlled double-leg descent and balanced top control with immediate release.

Ask How did your finish help you arrive in balanced top control?

Defend A Grounded Go Behind

Goal Use controlled kneeling pivots to prevent a grounded opponent from reaching hip control.

Set up Wide grounded stations, flat markers, fitted ear guards, and qualified coaches.

Before you begin Coach approves both partners' legal contact, balance, control, and immediate release before resistance; novices rehearse cooperatively.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Small base pivots.** Demonstrate moving one hand and one knee slightly to turn a stable base. After two minutes, use six 30-second work and 30-second rest rounds. Athletes work alone, keep head clear, and stop before hands or knees become tangled.
13-23 10 min	**Turn toward the route.** Show mover beginning beside the shoulder and slowly circling outside the arms. Defender makes one small base pivot toward the mover without grabbing. After two minutes, use eight one-minute turns; stop before either athlete loses balance or crowds the head.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**One route one pivot.** Spend two minutes confirming roles and the single-pivot limit. Run eight one-minute rounds with a five-second attempt per role and rest. Mover seeks hip-and-arm control; defender turns once to stay facing. No head blocking, diving, or repeated scrambling.
35-45 10 min	**Face versus go behind.** After two teaching minutes, run twelve 20-second rounds with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved movers seek hip-and-near-arm control; defenders use small grounded pivots to stay facing. Stop at control, standing, or unsafe crowding; novices announce routes and cooperate.
45-55 10 min	**Defend either outside route.** After two teaching minutes, use sixteen 15-second rounds and 15-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved movers choose either outside route; defenders pivot to face without grabbing the head. Stop on control or standing, discuss the useful reaction, and keep novices cooperative.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Announce the route and practice the pivot without any top contact.

Add challenge Read either outside route and use repeated small facing pivots within the same round.

Stop or change Stop for neck contact, limb tangling, joint pressure, uncontrolled scrambling, standing, or delayed release.

Look for Defender preserves a grounded facing position against an outside route and releases promptly when the round ends.

Ask What did you notice before choosing which way to turn?

Choose A Bottom Escape Response

Goal Rebuild base when necessary, then control the waist wrist and stand to escape.

Set up Matched stations, clear standing lanes, fitted ear guards, and qualified contact supervision.

Before you begin Coach approves base recovery and hand-controlled rising before light resistance; top releases at standing and never returns bottom. Rebuild base using B16: outside knee up, hips back, other knee underneath. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Base adjust and settle.** Show a small hand or knee adjustment followed by a stable pause, then an optional solo stand-up. After two minutes, run six 30-second movement and 30-second rest rounds. Athletes choose only comfortable transitions and keep the head upright.
13-23 10 min	**Learn - Base or Stand-Up.** Show belly-down and stable-base starts. From belly, use B16: outside knee up, hips back, other knee under. From base with rider left, use B17: left foot up, control their right hand with yours, rise, clear hips and turn right. After two teaching minutes, use eight cooperative turns; pause whenever the position becomes unclear.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Recover before rising.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute turns. Top supplies light waist contact while bottom rebuilds base and controls the wrist. Once balanced, bottom rises and clears; top follows lightly without a mat return. Novices separate recovery, clearing, and an unsupported rise.
35-45 10 min	**Choose base then stand.** After two teaching minutes, run twelve 20-second rounds with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved bottom athletes rebuild base and seek the taught stand-up; top follows with light waist contact only. Stop at standing or escape; novices rehearse separate cooperative steps.
45-55 10 min	**Escape decision challenge.** After two teaching minutes, use sixteen 15-second attempts with 15-second feedback/rest. Alternate stable-base and cooperative belly-down starts. Approved bottom athletes rebuild, control the wrist, and rise; top follows lightly and releases at standing. Novices cooperate, pausing between each step.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Coach announces the first action; top provides completely cooperative contact.

Add challenge Recover from the taught controlled breakdown, then choose the moment to control the wrist and rise.

Stop or change Stop for painful pressure, wrist twisting, finger grips, uncontrolled collapse, backward pulling, or attempted mat returns.

Look for Bottom rebuilds base when needed, then completes a balanced hand-controlled escape.

Ask When was rebuilding your base more useful than trying to stand immediately?

Link Your Safe Wrestling Choices

Goal Choose familiar top breakdown, grounded go-behind, or hand-controlled escape objectives.

Set up Three separate skill stations, fitted ear guards, and qualified coaches supervising every contact pair.

Before you begin Coach approves both partners' legal contact, balance, control, and immediate release before resistance; novices rehearse cooperatively. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up. Use B22 for the chop and wrist capture.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Movement choice lanes.** Demonstrate stance stepping, a stable base, and a solo stand-up in separate lanes. After two minutes, run six 40-second work and 20-second rest rounds. Athletes choose one comfortable movement per round and avoid changing levels near another athlete.
13-23 10 min	**Show three wrestling objectives.** Demonstrate grounded go-behind against facing pivots, tight-waist chop against base adjustments, and stand-up against light waist contact. After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute cooperative turns. Identify each endpoint: hip control, controlled breakdown, or standing with release and escape.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Rehearse station roles.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute turns at staffed stations. Partners rehearse the go-behind, chop, or stand-up cooperatively; coach checks receiving and control before resistance. Explain the station's single permitted defense and endpoint, then swap roles with full release.
35-45 10 min	**Choose a positional objective.** After two teaching minutes, use twelve 20-second rounds with 20-second feedback/rest. Approved pairs choose go-behind versus facing pivots, chop versus base adjustments, or stand-up versus light waist contact. Alternate roles; release at control, breakdown, or standing. Novices rehearse cooperatively.
45-55 10 min	**Break down or keep base.** After two teaching minutes, run sixteen 15-second rounds with 15-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved top athletes seek the tight-waist chop; bottom maintains base with small adjustments and unlocked elbows. Stop at controlled breakdown or standing. Novices rehearse receiving cooperatively.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Complete one station cooperatively for the entire block, with additional explanation and rest.

Add challenge Choose between two taught objectives across rounds and adapt to each task's permitted defense.

Stop or change Stop for unclear roles, unpracticed counters, neck pressure, joint pain, uncontrolled descent, or attempted mat returns.

Look for Athlete chooses a taught objective, adapts to its permitted defense, and releases at the agreed endpoint.

Ask Which wrestling choice feels most reliable for you now?

Half Nelson and Early Defense

Goal Apply a controlled half nelson and recognize its early defense.

Set up Position cards, spaced mat stations, fitted ear guards, and qualified coaches for grounded tasks.

Before you begin Review B26-B27. Confirm cooperative shoulder rotation; defense is taught only while the neck remains free and before turning pressure.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Position picture walk.** Show pictures of standing neutral, hands-and-knees bottom, and a kneeling top beside the hips. After two minutes, use six 40-second walking and 20-second rest rounds. Athletes identify pictures from their own spaces; no rushing toward shared cards.
13-23 10 min	**Learn - B26.** From the left side, left arm threads under their left armpit, palm on the back of the head. Right hand blocks the far elbow beneath the chest. Lift the half elbow and walk feet left toward the head to a T. Drive chest to turn the torso onto its right side and settle. After two teaching minutes, use eight cooperative turns.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Rehearse Turn and Defense Separately.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute turns. First rehearse B26 with a cooperative receiver. Separately teach B27 against a loose left half: left elbow and shoulder stay low, look right while the neck is free, and left hand clears the whole hand. Rebuild base after clearing. Stop a tight hold for top to release.
35-45 10 min	**Turn or Clear.** After two teaching minutes, use twelve 20-second attempts with 20-second rest. Coach calls Turn for a cooperative B26 turn, or Clear for one loose B27 insertion and early defense. Swap roles. Clear rounds stop before turning pressure; Turn rounds have a cooperative receiver. Reset any blocked or uncomfortable position.
45-55 10 min	**Recognize turn or reset.** After two teaching minutes, use eight 40-second rehearsal and 20-second rest rounds. Partners announce an open arm or early elbow-closing defense. Top chooses controlled half-nelson turn or reset; coach checks palm placement and neck clearance. Novices demonstrate placement without turning.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Rehearse arm and palm placement without turning; practice the early defense separately.

Add challenge Reset against early elbow closure; turn only through a controlled opening.

Stop or change Stop for head or neck compression, painful shoulder pressure, forced bridging, trapped limbs, distress, or any full nelson.

Look for Athlete uses checked palm placement and shoulder rotation for a controlled turn and prompt release.

Ask When should you reset?

Respect Boundaries And Restart Safely

Goal Notice practice boundaries, stop before entering the buffer, and restart from an agreed position.

Set up Flat inner boundary markers, wide clear buffer areas, fitted ear guards, and central restart markers.

Before you begin Coach approves half-nelson palm placement, shoulder rotation, controlled receiving, and prompt release before resistance; novices rehearse placement. Use B26-B27 for the half and early defense.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Find the safe middle.** Demonstrate moving inside an inner marker line with a clear unused buffer outside. After two minutes, use six 40-second movement and 20-second rest rounds. Athletes take short stance steps and stop before the line, then walk back centrally.
13-23 10 min	**Stop before the buffer.** Explain that these practice rounds stop before the inner line, regardless of different event rules. After two minutes, use eight one-minute turns. Partners move without contact, freeze on the cue, separate, and walk to central markers before restarting.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Turn within safe space.** After two teaching minutes, run eight 30-second practice and 30-second rest rounds. Rehearse the half nelson cooperatively: checked palm, lifted elbow, and circling shoulder rotation. Coach stops before the inner line; release completely and return separately to the center.
35-45 10 min	**Turn or boundary stop.** After two teaching minutes, run twelve 20-second attempts with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved pairs use half nelson versus early elbow closure; reset if blocked and receive cooperatively once secured. Stop on controlled turn or inner line. Novices rehearse placement.
45-55 10 min	**Contested round clean restart.** After two teaching minutes, use sixteen 15-second grounded rounds with 15-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved movers seek hip control while defenders pivot to face. Either athlete calls boundary before the buffer; both release, reset separately, and check readiness. Novices cooperate.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Practice walking routes and restarts without contact.

Add challenge Recognize a blocked half, reset, and restart without forcing the neck or chasing boundaries.

Stop or change Stop before buffers or crowds, for head or neck compression, or full nelsons; release completely before repositioning.

Look for Both athletes release and return to the middle separately before restarting.

Ask What should happen before a new attempt begins after a boundary stop?

Try A Restricted Mock Match

Goal Try a supported event using taught takedown or escape objectives.

Set up Marked practice areas, qualified referee-coaches, fitted ear guards, timer, and supervised waiting space.

Before you begin Participation is voluntary; coaches approve both partners' task-specific technique, controlled receiving, and prompt release before each restricted bout. Use B07 for the double-leg finish. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Choose a familiar preparation.** Show three choices: short stance steps, solo base recovery, or a free stand-up from base. After two minutes, run six 40-second work and 20-second rest rounds. Athletes choose comfortable movements and privately tell a coach whether they want contact.
13-23 10 min	**Explain the restricted event.** Demonstrate two choices: upright double-leg entry with corner turn and controlled descent, or wrist-controlled stand-up with top following lightly without a mat return. After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute cooperative turns. Coaches approve readiness; these restricted bouts do not establish full-match readiness.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Practice the referee routine.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute turns. Practice approaching the marker, confirming readiness, starting, and stopping. Double-leg defenders may retreat once before contact, then receive; escape partners maintain light waist contact, releasing at standing. Rehearse cooperatively before contested attempts.
35-45 10 min	**Supported positional mini bouts.** After two teaching minutes, referee-coaches run twelve 20-second bouts with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved athletes choose double-leg versus early retreat or stand-up versus light waist contact. Stop at top control, standing, or boundary. Novices choose cooperative demonstrations or low starts.
45-55 10 min	**Process goal replay.** After two teaching minutes, use sixteen 15-second rounds with 15-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Repeat the chosen double-leg or stand-up objective against its permitted defense, tracking balanced entry or wrist control. Release at top control or standing; cooperative demonstrations remain equally welcome.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Complete the event routine and a fully cooperative demonstration without a contested attempt.

Add challenge Adapt to the permitted early retreat or light waist-contact response while maintaining control.

Stop or change Stop for distress, unfamiliar counters, uncontrolled descent, head or neck compression, lifts, slams, or attempted mat returns.

Look for Athlete completes a restricted attempt and follows the event routine.

Ask What felt comfortable, and what would you change?

Explore The Wrestling Skills Festival

Goal Explore taught takedown, breakdown, turn, and escape stations with suitable challenge.

Set up Four staffed stations, task cards, fitted ear guards, and qualified coaches.

Before you begin Coaches approve station-specific contact, control, and immediate release before resistance; unstaffed stations remain supervised and noncontact. Use B07 for the double-leg finish. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up. Use B22 for the chop and wrist capture. Use B26-B27 for the half and early defense.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Festival movement tour.** Walk through four staffed stations: double-leg finish, tight-waist chop, half nelson, and stand-up. After two demonstration minutes, use six 30-second solo movement and 30-second rest rounds. Rehearse entry footwork, base recovery, circling, or rising without contact during the tour.
13-23 10 min	**See every station task.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute cooperative turns. Demonstrate double-leg corner and controlled descent, bent-arm chop to forearms, half-nelson shoulder rotation with checked palm, and wrist-controlled rise. Explain the endpoint at each station: top control, breakdown, turn, or standing.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Supported station practice.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute cooperative turns at staffed stations. Rehearse each chosen technique and receiving role. Coach checks readiness before allowing its defense: early retreat, small base adjustment, early elbow closure, or light waist contact. Novices stay cooperative.
35-45 10 min	**Choose your challenge level.** After two teaching minutes, run twelve 20-second attempts with 20-second feedback/rest at staffed stations. Approved pairs contest their rehearsed technique against its single taught defense. Alternate roles; stop at top control, breakdown, turn, or standing. Cooperative repetitions and low starts remain available.
45-55 10 min	**Objective and partner care.** After two teaching minutes, use sixteen 15-second rounds with 15-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Repeat the station's taught objective and permitted defense. Release at its agreed endpoint, name one useful adjustment and one caring action, and reduce resistance whenever receiving loses control.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Remain at a solo movement station, use a low start, or complete contact tasks cooperatively.

Add challenge Adapt to the station's permitted defense while preserving controlled receiving and its endpoint.

Stop or change Stop for unstaffed contact, unsuitable pairings, crowding, unfamiliar counters, or attempts beyond demonstrated readiness.

Look for Athlete chooses a suitable station version and identifies a partner's helpful action.

Ask Which station would you most like to visit again?

Solve One Wrestling Problem

Goal Choose one achievable improvement in a taught takedown, breakdown, turn, or escape.

Set up Staffed skill areas, flat markers, fitted ear guards, and coach observation cards.

Before you begin Coach approves both partners' legal contact, balance, control, and immediate release before resistance; novices rehearse cooperatively. Use B07 for the double-leg finish. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up. Use B22 for the chop and wrist capture. Use B26-B27 for the half and early defense.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Choose and prepare.** Demonstrate short stance steps, a comfortable base recovery, and a solo stand-up. After two minutes, run six 40-second movement and 20-second rest rounds. Athletes choose preparation matching their goal and tell the coach which movement feels easiest today.
13-23 10 min	**Make the goal visible.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute cooperative turns. Choose one visible goal: upright double-leg corner, bent-arm chop with controlled receiving, half-nelson shoulder rotation with checked palm, or wrist-controlled rise. Coach supplies one cue and confirms the endpoint before contact.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Repeat with one cue.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute turns: attempt, release, feedback, and rest. Rehearse the chosen double-leg, chop, half, or stand-up cooperatively. Coach checks the receiving role and allows only previously taught resistance when both partners maintain control and immediate release.
35-45 10 min	**Test your repair under resistance.** After two teaching minutes, use twelve 20-second attempts with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved pairs test their chosen technique against early retreat, base adjustment, elbow closure, or light waist contact as appropriate. Stop at its agreed endpoint, assess the cue; novices cooperate.
45-55 10 min	**Teach a helpful cue.** Under direct coach supervision, run eight 40-second rounds and 20-second rests after two instruction minutes. Partners alternate demonstrating a chosen familiar task and offering one helpful cue. Children speak or point; they never physically reposition, pressure, or rank each other.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Choose one solo movement goal and receive feedback directly from the coach.

Add challenge Keep the same improvement cue while adapting to the chosen technique's single taught defense.

Stop or change Stop for peer pressure, physical correction by children, unapproved resistance, unsafe contact, or loss of confidence.

Look for Athlete identifies one change that improves their chosen task and demonstrates it safely.

Ask Which change helped your wrestling today?

Celebrate Your Wrestling Toolbox

Goal Demonstrate safe familiar skills, recognize progress, and choose a next learning goal.

Set up Spaced stations, flat markers, fitted ear guards, observation cards, and qualified contact supervision.

Before you begin Coach approves both partners' legal contact, balance, control, and immediate release before resistance; novices rehearse cooperatively. Use B07 for the double-leg finish. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up. Use B22 for the chop and wrist capture. Use B26-B27 for the half and early defense.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Welcome and readiness.** Greet athletes, assign matched partners, and state today's task. Rehearse the spoken and visual stop signals twice. Confirm immediate release and offer a supervised noncontact option or observation to anyone needing it.
05-13 8 min	**Favorite movement choices.** Show stance stepping, island walking, base recovery, and solo stand-up options. After two minutes, run six 40-second activity and 20-second rest rounds. Athletes select a favorite comfortable movement inside their own area and may change choices during resets.
13-23 10 min	**Show your useful sequence.** After two teaching minutes, use eight one-minute cooperative turns. Choose a double-leg corner and controlled descent, bent-arm chop to forearms, half-nelson shoulder rotation with checked palm, or wrist-controlled rise. Coaches confirm receiving and each endpoint: top control, breakdown, turn, or standing.
23-25 2 min	**Water and partner check.** Use personal bottles and keep the rest area supervised. Ask partners about comfort and pace; adjust pairings before restarting. Water is freely available throughout practice, beyond this planned two-minute break.
25-35 10 min	**Polish one familiar task.** Use two minutes for each athlete to choose one useful cue with the coach. Run eight one-minute rounds containing one attempt per role, full release, feedback, and rest. Contact remains cooperative unless both athletes demonstrate readiness for the stated restricted response.
35-45 10 min	**Choose a progress challenge.** After two teaching minutes, use twelve 20-second attempts with 20-second feedback/rest, alternating roles. Approved pairs choose double-leg, chop, half, or stand-up against its taught defense. Release at top control, breakdown, turn, or standing. Novices choose cooperative showcases; introduce no new technique.
45-55 10 min	**Partner appreciation collection.** Under direct supervision, run eight 40-second rounds and 20-second rests after two teaching minutes. Partners choose a familiar cooperative task, complete one safe repetition each, and name a helpful action they noticed. Everyone receives equal turns without awards based on winning.
55-60 5 min	**Reflect and finish.** Gather in personal spaces and ask the closing question. Invite athletes to show or describe the success check. Recognize safe partnering, check belongings, and release children only through supervised pickup.

Make it easier Choose solo movement, observe, or share a favorite activity.

Add challenge Explain an adjustment to a taught defense, then test the same controlled skill again.

Stop or change Stop for pressure to perform, unfamiliar counters, uncontrolled descent, head or neck compression, or attempted mat returns.

Look for Athlete shows a familiar skill safely and names or indicates a next learning goal.

Ask What are you proud of? What comes next?

Keep these references close

These practice sequences are coaching designs. Use the current rules for your actual league or event, qualified technical instruction, and the club's medical and safeguarding procedures. Session numbers do not certify tournament readiness.

Grindstone Wrestling Club and Mat Rats
https://www.grindstonewrestling.org/mat-rats

Westminster Mat Rats Wrestling on Facebook
https://www.facebook.com/WestminsterMatRats/

USA Wrestling Folkstyle Level 1 technique demonstrations
https://www.usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/1

NFHS folkstyle rules resources; confirm youth event modifications
https://www.nfhs.org/sports/wrestling/rules

American Academy of Pediatrics sports readiness
https://www.healthychildren.org/English/healthy-living/sports/Pages/Is-Your-Child-Ready-for-Sports.aspx

CDC concussion response
https://www.cdc.gov/heads-up/response/index.html

CDC infection prevention for athletes
https://www.cdc.gov/mrsa/prevention/athletes.html

Coach reminders

Keep water available. Children participate at their normally nourished and hydrated weight. Remove suspected concussion from activity and obtain medical evaluation; no same-day return. Suspected contagious skin concerns need evaluation before contact. Follow actual club reporting and emergency procedures.

After practice

Which task helped the group learn? Who needs a different partner or an easier version? What should be repeated? Record private health or safeguarding matters through the club's secure process.

TAB 5 / 11-14

Ages 11-14 practice plans

30 skills and decision practices, 75 minutes each.

Content: binder pages 136-169
34 content pages

Coach / group: _____

Season: _____

GRINDSTONE WRESTLING

30 practice plans
Ages 11 to 14

Wrestling skills and decisions

Thirty practices for ages 11 to 14 that connect foundational wrestling skills with decisions and controlled positional work. Every practice includes a route for newer wrestlers and a challenge for experienced partners.

75 minutes per plan | One practice per page
Timing, setup, teaching instructions, adjustments and a learning check.

Use the shared Coach Moves Reference for full teaching steps. The matching two-page handout provides quick cues and reference pages.

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Run the practice

Choose the right pace

Two practices each week make a fifteen-week sequence. Use the simpler route for first-year athletes and adjust the total load around school sport, other clubs and events. Repetition is part of learning.

Prepare the space

Have a clean wrestling mat, clear margins, timer, personal water bottles and the listed equipment ready. Flat markers must not slide. Confirm staffing, emergency contacts, medical restrictions and the venue emergency plan before arrivals.

Read the clock

The left column shows elapsed time from the start of practice. Demonstration, turns, rest and feedback belong inside each block. Short rounds repeat only while both partners remain controlled. Water is available throughout, beyond the planned break.

Give a clear task

Read the focus and prerequisite first. Demonstrate briefly, give one cue, let athletes try and offer one correction. Tell partners exactly which actions are allowed. Rehearse stopping and releasing before increasing resistance.

Match and supervise

Pair by size, maturity, skill, confidence and control. Coaches assign and observe partners. Stop for pain, distress, unsafe pressure, loss of control or crowding. Reduce simultaneous activity if every pair cannot be supervised.

Adjust without excluding

The easier and harder options change the task, not the child's place on the team. Offer observation, individual movement or cooperative rehearsal. Children may ask to stop at any time. Breaks remain supervised.

Progress the wrestling

Teach receiving, legal position and release before each new finish or turn. Progress from cooperative repetitions to the stated positional resistance after both partners show control. Entry-only drills stop at entry. Use only taught finishes and turns; no lifts, throws or mat returns. Stop at the task objective or signal.

Find a practice

Practice 01 starts on page 4. Click a title or use the PDF bookmarks.

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Start Safe, Move Together

Goal Establish immediate stopping, personal space, stable stance, and dependable partner behavior.

Set up Wrestling mat, cones marking separate lanes, timer, individual bottles; one coach oversees each active partner area.

Before you begin Athletes can follow a stop cue and move without pain; use solo tasks until ready.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Use cone lanes for walking, side steps, and easy direction changes. On the coach's signal, freeze with bent knees and balanced feet. Partners observe from outside the lane, naming one stable position before switching after four short trips.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate a comfortable wrestling stance with bent knees, balanced feet, and eyes forward. Show small steps without crossing feet. Partners alternate twenty-second leader and mirror roles, stopping immediately on either athlete's call; begin without any contact between partners.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse stance, three small steps, and a controlled stop inside their marked area. The observer checks balance and space, then becomes mover. Complete four attempts each, rest briefly, and repeat with a different direction called before starting.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Play Mirror and Freeze: one athlete moves slowly while the other matches distance without touching. Either athlete may call stop; both freeze. Switch leadership every thirty seconds, discuss one adjustment, and repeat with coach-approved pairs in separate marked spaces.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Setup: 2 minutes; 8 rounds of 30-second mirroring and 30-second rest. Use simultaneous pairs in marked squares; alternate leaders. Coaches call unpredictable stops. During rests, recognize balanced movement, clear spacing, and immediate responses. All pairs work together.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Use walking and individual freeze games before partner mirroring.

Add challenge Returners demonstrate a mastered grounded skill, then use matched twenty-second positional rounds after coach approval.

Stop or change Stop for collisions, crossed lanes, discomfort, or delayed response to the signal.

Look for Both athletes stop immediately and maintain balance during three direction changes.

Ask What makes a partner feel safe enough to learn?

Move Without Crossing Feet

Goal Maintain stance and personal space while moving forward, backward, sideways, and around a partner.

Set up Mat, cones forming small squares, timer, individual bottles; matched pairs occupy separate squares.

Before you begin Athletes stop promptly and can hold a comfortable stance during slow movement.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with easy skipping, side steps, and forward walking around cones. Finish each trip in a balanced stance. Partners take turns pointing toward the next cone; move at walking speed first and keep neighboring squares clearly separated throughout.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate moving the nearest foot first, then bringing the other foot back to comfortable spacing. Show forward, backward, and sideways steps. Athletes rehearse each direction alone, then mirror a partner for four brief rounds with a reset between directions.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Place four cones around each pair. The leader points to a cone and takes two controlled steps; the follower maintains spacing. Alternate leadership after four cues. Pause to check crossed feet, upright balance, and whether either athlete needs more room.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Play Keep the Window: partners maintain a comfortable gap while one travels around the square. No touching, racing, or sudden lunges. Change leader every thirty seconds, rest while naming the hardest direction, then repeat at a pace both control.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Setup: 2 minutes; 8 rounds of 30-second activity and 30-second rest. Use simultaneous pairs in separate squares. Mover chooses one of two flat gates; noncontact defender shadows. Alternate roles; discuss balanced direction changes and clear spacing during rests.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Shorten steps and use only forward and sideways directions.

Add challenge Returners add controlled hand clearing to the angle game after coaches verify safe contact and release.

Stop or change Stop when athletes collide, race backward, or leave their assigned square.

Look for An athlete completes a four-direction route without crossing feet or losing the shared gap.

Ask Which direction needed the smallest steps today?

Balance Before Contact

Goal Build stable bases and learn to accept light partner contact without pushing contests.

Set up Mat, cones, timer, individual bottles; separate standing lanes and kneeling practice spaces.

Before you begin Athletes control footwork and willingly accept light open-hand contact; otherwise remain with mirroring.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Move through controlled squats, short forward steps, and gentle single-leg balances near a clear wall-free space. Partners observe rather than hold each other. Repeat each pattern slowly, then finish with stance movement and a prompt freeze on the signal.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate light palm contact to a partner's upper arms while both stand balanced. The receiver stays upright and comfortable; the mover tests only gentle contact, without shoving. Practice touching, releasing, and resetting, with explicit permission before each new attempt.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs alternate three light upper-arm touches followed by complete release. Receivers name whether contact felt predictable. After switching roles, add one small sideways step together. Coaches reduce pressure immediately if either athlete stiffens, leans heavily, or stops communicating clearly.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Play Touch and Recover: the mover lightly touches an upper arm, releases, and changes position one step. The receiver adjusts stance without pushing back. Rotate roles after four attempts, rest, then repeat with the direction announced only just before moving.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Run simultaneous touch-and-angle games: one light open-hand upper-arm touch, complete release, then one angle step. Alternate roles every twenty seconds and rest between rounds. Partners stay balanced; coaches stop shoving, head contact, or chasing immediately.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Replace contact with a hand held nearby as a visual direction cue.

Add challenge Returners use light legal wrist control and footwork while partners defend within agreed limits.

Stop or change Stop if contact becomes a shove, either athlete leans onto a partner, or balance becomes uncontrolled.

Look for Partners keep independent balance and release immediately on every request.

Ask How could you tell that the contact was manageable?

Receive With Control And Reset

Goal Learn controlled low receiving, immediate release, and independent recovery before completed takedown practice.

Set up Mat, flat markers, timer, bottles; qualified coaches supervise separated low-receiving stations.

Before you begin Athletes comfortably sit, kneel, and control head position; qualified coaches verify each receiving progression.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Begin with easy walking, stance steps, and individual transitions from standing to kneeling and seated positions. Use hands for comfortable support, without dropping. Partners watch from clear space, then switch after three transitions and share one sign of good control.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate lowering from side-sitting onto the side with bent supporting arm and head clear, then returning to base. Progress individually to a kneeling side descent under qualified supervision. Receivers move themselves first; no standing fall, push, or surprise contact.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs alternate three low side descents and controlled recoveries while coaches check bent-arm support, head clearance, and comfort. Partner observes before adding agreed gentle guidance. Each receiver announces readiness and may remain at the seated version throughout.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Use individually coached receiving stations: seated lowering, kneeling side descent, and recovery to base. Repeat three controlled attempts, rest, then advance only with coach approval. Coaches record readiness for the particular finish, not a blanket clearance for every takedown.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Pairs rehearse low receiving and independent recovery while qualified coaches observe each active station. Partners alternate three controlled repetitions, then rest upright. Waiting athletes practice solo stance steps nearby; nobody pushes a receiver or attempts a surprise fall.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Practice side-sitting and hand-supported lowering without any partner contact.

Add challenge Returners rehearse receiving for a previously mastered low finish with direct qualified coaching and no lifts.

Stop or change Stop for head contact, stiff-arm posting, sudden dropping, joint pain, or any unannounced push.

Look for Receiver controls a low side descent and returns to base without head impact or a rigid arm.

Ask How did you receive the movement without using your head or a stiff arm?

Change Level With Control

Goal Coordinate stance, level changes, and entry footwork without colliding with a partner.

Set up Mat, floor dots or cones, timer, individual bottles; individual entry lanes and adjacent observer spots.

Before you begin Athletes tolerate kneeling comfortably and can lower themselves without dropping.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with stance walking, shallow squats, and controlled steps toward floor dots. Add slow kneeling and standing only where comfortable. Partners count smooth transitions rather than speed, switch roles after four repetitions, and leave recovery time between sets.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate bending at the knees and hips while keeping eyes forward and balance underneath the body. Step toward a floor marker, optionally lower one knee softly, then recover. Athletes try the standing version first before choosing the kneeling version.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** One athlete performs four slow level-change entries toward a floor dot while the partner checks spacing and controlled knee placement. Switch roles, rest, then repeat from the opposite lead. Keep the target empty; nobody enters toward another athlete's body yet.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Play Choose Your Level: a partner shows a high or low hand target outside the movement lane. The mover adjusts height, steps toward a floor dot, and returns to stance. Change roles every four cues; targets never require reaching or diving.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Run simultaneous floor-target games in separate lanes. A partner indicates one of two dots; the mover changes level, steps, and recovers. Alternate thirty-second turns with short rests. Returning athletes add a coach-verified entry shape without increasing collision risk.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Use standing level changes and shorten the forward step.

Add challenge Returners link level change, entry, and recovery against one coach-approved defensive response.

Stop or change Stop for knee impact, diving, painful bending, or entry lanes overlapping.

Look for An athlete changes level, steps, and returns to balanced stance without falling forward.

Ask How did you lower your body without losing balance?

Recognize Safe Starting Positions

Goal Distinguish neutral, top, and bottom starts while preserving stopping and cooperative receiving habits.

Set up Mat, cones, three position cards, timer, bottles; pairs use spaced stations with a supervising coach.

Before you begin Review B14-B15 and the event rules. Distinguish a comfortable training base from the exact marked referee start.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Use a movement circuit of stance steps, comfortable crawling, kneeling, and independent standing. Perform each for short controlled intervals with walking between stations. Partners observe space and smooth transitions; any uncomfortable position has a standing movement alternative available throughout practice.
15-27 12 min	**Learn - Starting Positions.** Show neutral stance, then B14 bottom: knees behind the rear line, heels of both hands beyond the front line, elbows off the mat. Show B15 top on the left: left knee outside, right foot behind, legs clear; light left palm at elbow and right palm at belly button. Bottom sets first; top follows the referee cue. Both wait for the whistle.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs draw a position card, independently arrange themselves, and ask a coach to check alignment and legal contact. Hold only briefly, release, and stand separately. Switch top and bottom roles each turn; use four repetitions before resting and changing cards.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Play Position Detective: the coach names a position and one safety requirement. Partners arrange only that start, freeze for observation, then release on cue. Rotate the explaining role so every athlete describes where hands belong and how to request a stop.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Run simultaneous position challenges in spaced pairs. Coach names neutral, top, or bottom; partners set the checked start, hold briefly, then release. Switch roles each round and rest between sets. Coaches check actual hand placement rather than judging speed.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Identify positions verbally and demonstrate them solo.

Add challenge Returners add twenty-second top-bottom rounds using already-mastered legal control and an announced escape.

Stop or change Stop for weight placed on the neck, trapped fingers, uncertain contact, or discomfort in kneeling.

Look for An athlete recognizes three positions and resets each without pulling a partner.

Ask Which starting position still needs more explanation?

Clear Hands And Find Space

Goal Use gentle hand clearing and footwork to create an entry opportunity without yanking.

Set up Mat, cones, floor dots, timer, bottles; matched pairs have separate standing and entry areas.

Before you begin Athletes maintain stance, accept light upper-arm contact, and release promptly.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with stance circles, short retreat steps, and individual level changes toward floor dots. Add gentle hand opening and closing with relaxed arms. Partners mirror movement without contact, switching leadership frequently and checking that their entry lanes remain clear.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate light contact at an upper arm, then clearing the contact with an open hand while stepping away. Avoid fingers, forceful wrist twists, and neck contact. The receiver supplies only gentle contact; both finish balanced before repeating from the other side.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Partners alternate offering a light upper-arm touch and clearing it while taking one small angle step. Perform four repetitions each side, then rest. After switching roles, add a level change toward an empty floor dot once the contact has fully released.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Play Clear the Gate: the receiver offers one predictable arm contact. The mover clears gently, steps to space, and freezes in stance. Switch after three successful resets; experienced pairs may vary the offered side, but nobody grabs, resists, or drives forward.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Teams connect three actions into a demonstration: clear contact, move to space, and recover stance. Observers identify the opening rather than choosing a winner. Rotate performers after each sequence and let every athlete explain one adjustment that made the contact gentler.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Use a partner's nearby hand as a visual gate without actual contact.

Add challenge Vary the offered side and choose the corresponding angle step.

Stop or change Stop for grabbing fingers, twisting wrists, pulling hard, or pushing a partner off balance.

Look for An athlete clears contact and creates space while both partners remain balanced.

Ask What created the opening: your hands, your feet, or both?

Make An Angle First

Goal Create an angle with balanced footwork before committing to an entry.

Set up Mat, cones forming partner squares, floor dots, timer, bottles; separate lanes for entry rehearsal.

Before you begin Athletes can circle without crossing feet and complete a controlled solo level change.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Move around cones with short stance steps, changing direction only after a balanced stop. Add a level change at each second cone. Partners mirror outside touching distance, switch leadership after thirty seconds, and walk briefly between rounds to reset attention.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate moving one step toward the outside of a stationary partner's shoulder line, then checking balance before a level change. Keep hands relaxed and avoid body contact. Partners take turns receiving the movement, with no reaching, pulling, or entry finish.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs use three floor dots beside a receiver to compare straight and angled approaches. The mover chooses a dot, circles into position, and freezes before entering. Complete three approaches each side, switch roles, and discuss which start provided clearer space safely.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Play Open Door: the receiver turns slightly to offer a visible side, then remains still. The mover circles toward that opening and performs an entry step into empty space. Switch after four attempts; novices omit kneeling and keep the entire task standing.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Teams build a short angle course using cones and one stationary volunteer receiver. Each athlete approaches, identifies open space aloud, and moves to it without contact. Rotate receivers regularly; teammates recognize balanced foot placement rather than awarding points for speed.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Use only a cone as the receiver and walk through the angle.

Add challenge Let the receiver choose between two small turns before becoming stationary.

Stop or change Stop for crossing feet, chasing a moving receiver, reaching across the body, or crowded lanes.

Look for An athlete creates a useful angle and pauses balanced before an entry.

Ask What told you that an angle was available?

Single Leg Entry, No Finish

Goal Introduce a controlled single-leg entry and an orderly return to stance.

Set up Mat, floor dots, cones, timer, bottles; one spaced pair per entry lane.

Before you begin Athletes lower one knee softly, recover stance, and accept cooperative leg contact.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with stance steps, level changes, and slow knee-down entries toward an empty floor dot. Recover independently after each attempt. Partners observe knee placement and space; switch after four repetitions, rest briefly, and repeat using the other comfortable lead.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate approaching one leg with a level change and controlled step, keeping the head upright beside the partner's body. Touch the outer calf without pulling or lifting. The receiver stands still with both feet grounded; release before recovering to stance.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse the entry three times each side, pausing before contact so the receiver can confirm readiness. The mover touches lightly, releases, and recovers independently. Switch roles, rest, and repeat; first-year athletes use a floor dot instead of a leg.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Play Find the Near Leg: the receiver chooses a comfortable staggered stance and remains stationary. The mover identifies the nearer leg, makes the taught entry, and releases. Switch every three attempts; the challenge is appropriate choice and control, never completing a takedown.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Teams demonstrate a single-leg entry checkpoint sequence: balanced start, level change, soft entry, light contact, full release, recovery. Observers name one checkpoint each while a pair works slowly. Rotate roles frequently and allow a solo floor-dot demonstration for any athlete.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Use an empty floor dot and finish before any partner contact.

Add challenge Have the receiver change the lead leg before becoming completely still.

Stop or change Stop if a foot leaves the mat, the leg twists, the head lowers, or the receiver loses balance.

Look for An athlete enters toward the near leg and releases with the receiver's feet still grounded.

Ask Which checkpoint kept your receiver most comfortable?

Double Leg Takedown

Goal Complete a low double-leg corner finish with controlled receiving and no lifting.

Set up Mat, cones, two floor dots per lane, timer, bottles; matched pairs work in clear lanes.

Before you begin Review B07 and confirm side-hip receiving. The low finish uses no standing lift.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with stance steps, soft entries to floor markers, and coach-approved low receiving. Alternate three entries and three receiving repetitions with rest. Use individual stations so everyone moves while coaches verify head position, knee alignment, and controlled descent.
15-27 12 min	**Learn - B07.** Demonstrate a right-foot entry, head on your left at their right ribs, hands behind both knees. Step your left trail foot outside their right foot. Drive diagonally right across their stance while gathering knees left. Receiver lowers onto their left hip and side; follow above the hips without dropping weight. Rehearse low before a standing entry.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse three cooperative finishes from a low entry position, then switch and rest. Receiver follows the taught descent without rigid-arm posting. Attacker keeps knees aligned and guides rather than dumps. Standing starts require qualified coach approval for both athletes.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 12 rounds of 20-second work and 40-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Attacker uses double and corner finish; defender retreats or angles. Stop at control, closed entry, or unsafe alignment. Novices remain cooperative and low.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Use simultaneous pairs for a finish-and-control challenge. Alternate one attack each, release completely, and reset with rest. Credit a balanced entry, controlled corner descent, and legal top control; no lifts, speed contests, or continued wrestling after the finish signal.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Stop at entry and rehearse receiving separately until the coach approves a completed finish.

Add challenge Receiver offers one controlled retreat or angle response; attacker finishes only while position and receiving stay safe.

Stop or change Stop for head-down impact, lifting, slamming, trapped knees, twisting, stiff-arm posting, or loss of receiving control.

Look for Attacker turns the corner, guides a controlled descent, and establishes top control without lifting.

Ask How did changing your angle help you finish without lifting?

Sprawl And Go Behind

Goal Defend a leg attack with a controlled sprawl and circle into legal top control.

Set up Mat, cones, floor dots, timer, bottles; broad lanes with separate mover and defender starts.

Before you begin Review B11 Sprawl and Go-Behind. Partners can receive low entries and stop; demonstrate leg clearance, arm block and rear control.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with stance retreats, hand support, and slow solo sprawls: legs back, hips low briefly, knees off; then bring feet underneath and recover to stance. Keep the head clear. Alternate short sets with walking rests; offer upright steps if floor support is uncomfortable.
15-27 12 min	**Learn - B11.** Demonstrate B11: legs back and hips low, chest over the shoulders; scoot back until both legs clear. To circle right, use the right hand to block their left triceps, keep chest contact, and reach the left hand to their left thigh. Continue behind before settling knees and separate waist-and-arm control. Show from both sides.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Alternate three slow entries and B11 responses, then rest. Shooter releases the legs and builds a base. Defender pauses with legs free before the arm block and circle; knees come underneath after reaching the rear. Coach checks chest contact, head clearance and separate waist-and-arm control. Reset if alignment is lost.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 12 rounds of 20-second work and 40-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Attacker uses one double entry; defender sprawls and circles behind. Attacker may rebuild base. Stop at control or unsafe alignment; never cling to a twisting leg.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** In simultaneous pairs, alternate attack-defense challenges with a full reset after each outcome. One partner seeks a controlled double finish; the other seeks a sprawl and go-behind. Coaches approve readiness, maintain receiving standards, and use cooperative versions for newer wrestlers.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Practice a solo sprawl and circle around a marker before adding a cooperative attacker.

Add challenge Attacker chooses entry timing; defender sprawls and circles against a permitted attempt to rebuild base.

Stop or change Stop for dropping onto the neck, head pulling, knee collisions, uncontrolled dives, or trapped limbs.

Look for Defender moves hips and legs away, clears the attack, and circles into checked top control.

Ask What did your hips and feet do before you moved behind?

Peek-Out Recovery

Goal Clear the head from a light front cover and recover a useful attacking position.

Set up Mat, cones, floor dots, timer, bottles; generous space behind each entry lane.

Before you begin Review B13 and the mirrored B07 finish. Confirm the supporting post, rightward head exit and controlled side landing before linking them.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with stance steps and soft entries, then solo left-hand posts and right-foot steps from base. Draw the right elbow back beside the hip without swinging it at anyone; slide the left knee underneath and reset. Keep the head clear and alternate brief rehearsals with standing rests.
15-27 12 min	**Learn - B13.** Demonstrate a light, unlocked front cover over the shoulder blades. Bottom posts the left hand, steps the right foot outside the right elbow, draws that elbow back, and slides the left knee underneath as the head exits right. Lift chest only after clearance. Show B07 mirrored: head right, drive left, knees right; receiver lands on the right hip.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Use B13 for three cooperative repetitions each from the stationary front cover, then rest. Pause after the head clears to check hand support and hips underneath. Add the mirrored B07 finish only when both athletes show the entry and landing. The covering partner stays mobile, uses separate hands, and never locks a front headlock.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 12 rounds of 20-second work and 40-second rest. Alternate roles. Partner adds one announced light sprawl and follows the B13 recovery. Shooter clears the head and finishes only if alignment remains sound. Reset if clearance closes; do not force upward through the neck or add a new counter.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** In pairs, complete one controlled recovery at a time, then rest and swap. Coach signals either clearance-only or clearance plus the approved mirrored finish. Partners identify the supporting hand and direction before starting. Count accurate resets together; no fastest-pair contest, locked front headlocks or surprise reactions.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Use a stationary, light front cover; rehearse only the post, step and head clearance before resetting.

Add challenge Partner adds one announced light sprawl, then follows the peek-out into the mirrored double finish.

Stop or change Stop for trapped legs, neck pressure, head-down driving, twisting, or a finish attempted without receiving readiness.

Look for Athlete shortens the base, clears the head sideways before rising, and uses the correct finish direction.

Ask What had to clear before you lifted your chest?

Build A Reliable Bottom Base

Goal Establish a comfortable hands-and-knees base and reset it after small self-directed movements.

Set up Mat, cones, timer, bottles; separate kneeling spaces with observers outside arm reach.

Before you begin Athletes tolerate hands-and-knees positions comfortably and can stop without collapsing.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with walking, comfortable crawling, and independent kneeling-to-standing transitions. Use short distances and frequent posture resets. Partners observe free space and comfort, switching after each trip; standing balance work remains available whenever wrists or knees dislike the floor position.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate a bottom base with hands beneath shoulders and knees beneath hips, adjusting spacing for the athlete. Show a small hand or knee movement followed by a stable reset. Partners observe first; no one applies pressure or supports weight on another athlete.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** One athlete holds a comfortable base while the partner names a hand or knee to move slightly, then replace. Complete four controlled cues before switching. Rest upright between sets; the task is independent stability rather than resisting a partner's weight.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Play Keep Your Table: the bottom athlete chooses three small movements while maintaining a stable base. The observer identifies whether each movement ended balanced, without touching. Switch after each sequence; experienced athletes vary the order, while beginners repeat one comfortable movement.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Use simultaneous base challenges. Newer athletes follow a partner's movement cues without contact; coach-approved returners rebuild base against a legal waist-and-wrist ride. Alternate twenty-second turns with rest. Partners identify one useful support adjustment; coaches prevent neck pressure and trapped arms.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Use a shorter hands-and-knees hold or substitute standing balance steps.

Add challenge Returners rebuild base against a coach-verified legal waist-and-wrist ride without joint force, neck pressure, or lifting.

Stop or change Stop for wrist or knee pain, collapsing support, or any partner pressure on the back or neck.

Look for An athlete moves one support point and returns to a comfortable stable base.

Ask What helped your base feel steady without tensing everything?

Inside-Leg Stand-Up

Goal Use hand control and an inside-leg rise, then clear the hips and face when ready.

Set up Mat, cones, timer, bottles; pairs have clear space above and behind their kneeling start.

Before you begin Review B17. With rider on the left, use left foot and right hand; teach the right turn only after balanced standing and hip clearance.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with walking, shallow squats, and controlled kneeling-to-standing transitions. Begin with one foot planted and rise without using a partner for support. Alternate comfortable lead legs, take short rests, and let observers notice which version preserves balance best.
15-27 12 min	**Learn - B17.** Start with rider left. Plant the left foot beside the right knee and lift the chest; right hand captures their right hand near the wrist. Rise on bent knees, holding the hand away while hips move forward. Stop here first. Once balanced, retain hand control and turn right to face. Top follows without pulling backward or returning to the mat.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs complete three stand-ups with a cooperative follower, then switch and rest. Bottom keeps elbows close, controls the wrist, and rises under their own balance. Progress to gentle positional opposition only after the coach verifies both athletes can stop safely while standing.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 12 rounds of 20-second work and 40-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Bottom seeks hand control and balanced standing; top follows using legal waist/wrist control. Stop on standing, escape, or imbalance. No lifts, returns, finger grips, or compression.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Use simultaneous stand-up challenges in matched pairs. Alternate one attempt each, reset fully, and rest. Partners identify whether hand control, foot placement, or hip position helped. Newer athletes retain the release-first version; returners work against a coach-approved follower.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Rise alone or have top release before movement; add following only after both show control.

Add challenge Top maintains controlled legal contact while bottom clears the wrist and chooses either lead foot.

Stop or change Stop for trapped arms, wrist twisting, backward pulling, loss of balance, or any lift or mat-return attempt.

Look for Bottom controls the hands, plants a foot, and reaches balanced standing against an appropriate follower.

Ask How did hand control help you rise with balance?

Sit-Out and Hip-Heist Escape

Goal Create space with a sit-out, clear waist contact, then heist to face and separate.

Set up Mat, floor dots, cones, timer, bottles; generous space beside each bottom starting position.

Before you begin Review B18-B19. Confirm the solo heist and whole-hand clearing first; a seated position alone is not an escape.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Rehearse P09 sit-outs solo, then B19 heist footwork from a short sit. For a left heist, support on the left palm and right foot; lift hips just enough for the left leg to sweep under and right leg to step over. Turn chest toward the mat, knees under, then reset. Use short sets with rest; keep the head off the mat.
15-27 12 min	**Learn - B18 to B19.** Show B18 with rider left: left cross-post, right foot out, left leg through, low seat and right-hand wrist control. Then B19: clear the whole waist hand, release, post left palm and plant right foot. Sweep left leg under and step right leg over while turning left. Face, separate from contact, then rise. Demonstrate each stage slowly before linking.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Take three B18 sit-outs each and reset. Then begin seated for three B19 clear-and-heist escapes each. Rider follows on knees, hands separate, allowing clear hand and hip space. Link the two only after both stages are controlled. Coach checks the leg path, free head, and actual separation before the athlete stands.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 12 rounds of 20-second work and 40-second rest. Alternate roles. Top follows on knees with light waist contact; bottom creates a short sit, clears hands and heists to face. If control remains, bottom rebuilds base and both reset. No chops, pullbacks, rolls or new counters.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Partners take one cooperative attempt, name the checkpoint they achieved, then rest and swap: short sit, hands clear, or facing and free. Coach varies whether the task stops seated or continues through B19. Reaching the correct checkpoint is success; no points for forcing a blocked turn or rolling over the head.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Rehearse B18 to a balanced short sit and reset. Practice B19 separately from a loose seated start.

Add challenge Top follows on knees with light waist contact; bottom clears and heists, or rebuilds base if contact remains.

Stop or change Stop for trapped arms, shoulder torque, backward falls, neck pressure, or a partner forcing the turn.

Look for Athlete clears the waist hand before the heist, turns without head support, and separates before rising.

Ask What must happen before your sit-out becomes an escape?

Tight Waist Chop

Goal Break a stable base using coordinated waist control and near-arm guidance, then establish a safe ride.

Set up Mat, position cards, cones, timer, bottles; coaches can directly observe each top-bottom pair.

Before you begin Review B22. Confirm bent-elbow receiving, coordinated forward drive and the cross-wrist endpoint before adding resistance.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with comfortable crawling, kneeling side steps, and controlled standing transitions in separate lanes. Finish with a stable bottom base or a standing alternative. Partners observe balance and spacing, switching roles regularly and resting upright between short sets of movement.
15-27 12 min	**Learn - B22.** From the left-side start, snug the right waist arm. Use the left forearm to fold their left elbow toward the belly while toes and rear right knee drive hips forward. Bottom lowers through forearms to belly. Catch their left wrist with the right waist hand and control the upper arm with the left. Follow without strikes, straight-arm collapse or wrist twisting.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse three cooperative breakdowns, then switch and rest upright. Bottom lowers onto comfortable forearm and chest support with head clear; top follows beside the hips without collapsing onto the neck. Coaches check wrist and elbow alignment before adding opposition.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 12 rounds of 20-second work and 40-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Top attempts tight-waist/chop breakdown; bottom maintains or rebuilds base without stiff-arm posting. Stop at controlled breakdown, recovered base, or unsafe arm alignment.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Use simultaneous base-versus-breakdown challenges with equal turns. Top earns the task outcome through coordinated waist control and arm guidance; bottom earns it by preserving or rebuilding base. Reset and rest after every attempt. Coaches keep contact appropriate to each matched pair.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Rehearse the legal start and a voluntary bottom descent without applying the breakdown.

Add challenge Bottom tries to retain base while top coordinates one legal chop and waist action.

Stop or change Stop for striking the elbow, twisting a joint, locked hands, body squeezing, neck loading, or uncontrolled collapse.

Look for Top coordinates waist and near-arm action, guides a controlled breakdown, and follows the hips.

Ask How did moving the waist and arm together change the base?

Follow The Base, Then Release

Goal Connect a controlled breakdown with hip tracking while bottom rebuilds base or begins an escape.

Set up Mat, cones, timer, bottles; each matched pair has a roomy kneeling practice zone.

Before you begin Partners demonstrate safe tight-waist/chop mechanics, base recovery, and controlled stopping before any mat return. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up. Use B22 for the chop and wrist capture.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with kneeling side steps, comfortable crawling, and small standing circles. Partners copy one another without touching, alternating leadership after short sequences. Rehearse a shared freeze frequently, and give athletes upright rest whenever knees or wrists need a break.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate a controlled tight-waist/chop breakdown, then follow the hips as bottom rebuilds base. Keep knees off the partner and adjust legal waist-and-wrist contact without twisting. Bottom may initiate a taught escape; stop at facing or balanced standing before any return.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs alternate three breakdown-to-base-recovery sequences, then switch and rest. Bottom rebuilds deliberately while top tracks the hips, avoiding a repeated chop when the arm is trapped. Coaches add controlled opposition only after both athletes maintain safe alignment through the whole sequence.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 12 rounds of 20-second work and 40-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Top seeks breakdown and ride; bottom seeks base, sit-out, or stand-up. Stop at facing, balanced standing, or unsafe alignment. No lifts, returns, or squeezing.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Run matched pairs simultaneously. Each pair demonstrates one useful choice during an active top-bottom round, then pauses to explain it briefly. Swap roles, rest, and retry with the same permitted actions. Coaches reward decisions and technical control rather than exhaustion.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Bottom voluntarily lowers and rebuilds base while top follows cooperatively without applying the chop.

Add challenge Bottom chooses base recovery or a taught escape; top selects breakdown or tracking within the same safe limits.

Stop or change Stop for neck loading, knee pressure on a partner, joint twisting, body compression, or any lift or return.

Look for Top maintains legal position through footwork while bottom actively rebuilds base or seeks an escape.

Ask When was following the hips more useful than repeating the breakdown?

Half Nelson and Early Defense

Goal Introduce a controlled half-nelson turn, safe shoulder control, and an early clearing defense.

Set up Mat, spaced top-bottom stations, timer, bottles; qualified coaches closely supervise turning and receiving.

Before you begin Review B26-B27. Confirm the cooperative turn and teach defense separately against a loose insertion while the neck is free.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with comfortable shoulder movement, base recovery, and voluntary side-to-back turns without using the head for support. Alternate short sets with upright rests. Coaches observe each athlete's comfortable range and readiness; turning is never forced to match a partner.
15-27 12 min	**Learn - B26.** From the left side, thread the left arm under their left armpit, palm on the back of the head. Right hand blocks the far elbow beneath the chest. Lift the half elbow and walk feet left toward the head to a T. Drive through the chest to turn shoulders and torso together onto their right side, then settle chest to chest.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse B26 and B27 Separately.** Take three cooperative B26 turns each. Then practice B27 against a loose left half: left elbow closes, that shoulder and hip stay low, and the head looks right while free. Left hand clears the whole hand from the head; recover base after the threading arm clears. Release any tight hold rather than forcing the neck to turn.
45-60 15 min	**Apply - Turn or Clear.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 12 rounds of 20-second work and 40-second rest. Alternate roles. Coach calls a cooperative B26 turn or a loose B27 insertion with early defense. The Clear task stops before turning pressure; the Turn task uses a willing receiver. Reset at the outcome or any blocked shoulder, pain or neck restriction.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Use simultaneous supervised turn-defense challenges with matched partners. Alternate short attempts and full releases, naming one technical cue before restarting. The coach confirms controlled shoulder contact using the actual rule standard; no forced hold through pain, neck strain, or restricted breathing.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Rehearse the arm pathway without turning; receiver voluntarily moves onto the side before any partner pressure.

Add challenge Bottom keeps the elbow close and clears the wrist while top seeks a controlled legal turn.

Stop or change Stop for neck cranking, throat or face pressure, shoulder pain, trapped arms, restricted breathing, or uncontrolled turning.

Look for Top guides a controlled half-nelson turn; bottom demonstrates an early elbow-close and wrist-clearing defense.

Ask What made the turn controlled, and what helped the early defense?

Clear, Angle, And Enter

Goal Connect hand clearing and an angle step to a controlled double-leg finish against a permitted defense.

Set up Mat, cones, floor dots, timer, bottles; matched pairs have separate approach lanes.

Before you begin Both athletes show the double finish and its receiving safely; defender knows the taught retreat or sprawl. Use B07 for the double-leg finish.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up in parallel pairs with stance movement, open-hand clearing, level changes, and separate low-receiving repetitions. Alternate three controlled sequences and short rests. Coaches check receiver readiness and preserve an entry-only option for anyone not ready to complete the finish.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate clearing a upper-arm touch, stepping to an angle, and entering the double with head upright. Turn the corner into the taught controlled descent and top control. Defender first cooperates, then offers one approved retreat or sprawl; never force a closed position.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs complete three cooperative clear-angle-finish sequences each, rest, then add one announced defensive response. Attacker chooses a safe finish or recovery; defender may circle behind only after clearing the attack. Coaches stop leg twisting and maintain matched receiving ability throughout.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 8 rounds of 30-second work and 60-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Attacker uses clear-angle-double; defender retreats or sprawls and circles behind. Stop at established control, safe separation, or unsafe alignment. Simplify the next round when needed.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** All pairs run attack-defense challenges in parallel, resetting after each outcome and taking a brief rest. Partners identify the opening or defensive action that mattered, then swap. Newer athletes use cooperative finishes; ready athletes apply the same skills against genuine permitted opposition.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Complete the clear and angle, then rehearse a cooperative low finish or stop at entry.

Add challenge Defender chooses retreat or controlled sprawl; attacker decides whether to finish, recover, or release.

Stop or change Stop for neck pressure, trapped legs, lifting, uncontrolled descent, or forcing a finish after alignment is lost.

Look for Athlete creates space and completes a controlled finish or appropriate recovery against an actual defensive response.

Ask Which action created the usable opening rather than merely touching the target?

Choose Attack Or Counter

Goal Read a leg attack and choose a controlled double finish, sprawl-go-behind counter, or safe recovery.

Set up Mat, cones, paired floor dots, timer, bottles; clear entry lanes with waiting observers beside them.

Before you begin Pairs demonstrate controlled double receiving and sprawl-go-behind mechanics before opposed rounds. Use B07 for the double-leg finish.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with stance movement, solo level changes, controlled sprawls, and low-receiving repetitions. Work in separate lanes with short rests after each set. Partners alternate demonstrations and give one observation about head position, balanced recovery, or the space needed to receive.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate two connected outcomes: an attacker turns the corner for a controlled double finish; a defender clears the legs with a controlled sprawl and circles behind. Both end in checked top control. Rehearse each slowly before allowing a choice of response.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse an announced double finish, then an announced sprawl-go-behind counter. Complete two of each, swap roles, and rest. Attacker releases a closed entry rather than clinging to a twisting leg; defender never drives weight through the head or neck.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 8 rounds of 30-second work and 60-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. One initiates double; opponent retreats or sprawls and counters. Stop at control or stalled unsafe shape. Returners may switch the initiating role after each full reset.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Use simultaneous decision games in matched pairs. Each pair alternates one attack and one counter opportunity, pausing to explain the choice. Count controlled technical outcomes, not rushed attempts; coaches supply a cooperative version for athletes still learning either response.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Announce who attacks and which defensive response will occur; rehearse cooperatively.

Add challenge Either wrestler may initiate one taught double; the opponent chooses defense and a safe counter.

Stop or change Stop for blind diving, trapped legs, neck pressure, lifting, or continuing after the coach calls an unsafe position.

Look for Athlete chooses a taught attack or counter based on the opponent's actual movement.

Ask What information helped you choose the attack or the counter?

Circle To Safe Top Control

Goal Earn legal top control from a grounded go-behind against an opponent trying to regain facing position.

Set up Mat, cones, timer, bottles; matched pairs have generous clear space around a hands-and-knees receiver.

Before you begin Pairs control base, knee movement, legal waist-and-arm contact, and the permitted grounded pivot.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with comfortable crawling, kneeling side steps, and circles around an empty floor marker. Keep hands available for balance and take small steps. Partners observe clear space, switch after each short route, and rest upright between sets of movement.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Start with bottom in a comfortable base and mover kneeling in front at an angle. Circle outside the arms toward the hip, establish legal waist-and-arm control, and follow the hips. Receiver first cooperates, then uses a small pivot to regain facing position.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse three go-behinds each direction with an announced receiver pivot. Mover stays clear of the head and arms, using footwork rather than pulling limbs. Pause on established control, release, switch, and rest; novices begin against a stationary base.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 12 rounds of 20-second work and 40-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Mover seeks grounded top control; receiver pivots or takes small base steps to regain facing. Stop at either outcome or unsafe crowding. Keep turns controlled.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** All pairs practice the grounded control game simultaneously. Alternate roles after each short attempt and rest between sets. Partners explain one route or pivot that worked; coaches verify actual control rather than awarding success for merely touching the hip.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Receiver holds base while mover circles a wide outside route and establishes cooperative control.

Add challenge Receiver chooses a small pivot or base adjustment while mover seeks and maintains legal control.

Stop or change Stop for head pulling, forceful limb twisting, climbing across arms, knee collisions, or uncontrolled spinning.

Look for Mover reaches and maintains checked top control while receiver actively tries to regain facing position.

Ask How did your route change when the receiver moved?

Choose An Escape Pathway

Goal Choose a stand-up, sit-out, or base recovery against legal top control and a responsive opponent.

Set up Mat, cones, timer, bottles; spacious matched-pair zones with coaches observing every active round.

Before you begin Review B16-B19. Offer only demonstrated choices: rebuild base, B17 stand-up, or B18 sit-out into B19 hip-heist escape.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with solo bottom-base resets, comfortable sit-outs, and independent stand-ups. Perform one of each, then walk and rest before repeating. Partners identify which pathway looked most controlled, switch observing roles, and keep every supporting hand free during floor movement.
15-27 12 min	**Learn - Choose an Escape.** From a stable base, demonstrate B17 inside-leg stand-up with hand control and hip clearance. Then show B18 sit-out followed by B19: clear the waist hand before the heist, face and separate before rising. Use B16 first if flattened. Top follows with light, separate-hand contact. Stop at the stated checkpoint or lost alignment.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse one announced stand-up and one sit-out against a follower, then switch and rest. Add positional opposition after the coach checks wrist alignment and balance. Bottom may rebuild base between attempts; top cannot lift or force an arm behind the body.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 8 rounds of 30-second work and 60-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Bottom seeks taught escape; top maintains legal control or attempts taught breakdown. Stop at facing, balanced standing, or unsafe alignment. Simplify the next round when needed.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Use simultaneous escape-versus-control rounds in matched pairs. After each attempt, partners name whether hand control, hip position, or base recovery changed the outcome. Rest, swap roles, and retry with one adjustment; no athlete is kept in repeatedly because they win.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Announce the escape and use cooperative following or complete top release before movement.

Add challenge Bottom chooses without announcing; top responds with legal tracking or a taught controlled breakdown.

Stop or change Stop for trapped arms, backward pulling, wrist twisting, imbalance, neck strain, or any lift or mat return.

Look for Bottom creates facing space or balanced standing against appropriate control; top responds through legal position and hand control.

Ask What did the opponent's control tell you about which escape to try?

Break Down Turn Or Keep Control

Goal Choose a breakdown, maintained ride, or taught half-nelson turn while bottom defends and seeks recovery.

Set up Mat, cones, timer, bottles; pair zones large enough for three controlled base steps.

Before you begin Both athletes demonstrate the breakdown, half-nelson receiving and early defense, and reliable release under coaching. Use B22 for the chop and wrist capture. Use B26-B27 for the half and early defense.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with base recovery, kneeling hip tracking, solo sit-outs, and voluntary side turns. Use short sets in separate spaces with upright rests. Coaches check comfortable shoulder range and review the immediate stop before any half-nelson receiving or defense.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate the choice: use tight-waist/chop against stable base, follow the hips during recovery, or apply the taught half when the near arm is safely available. Bottom keeps the elbow close and clears the half's wrist early; never force a blocked shoulder.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse three announced pictures: base retained, base rebuilt, and near arm available. Top selects breakdown, tracking, or a cooperative half turn. Bottom rehearses the matching safe defense. Switch and rest; coaches approve turning readiness separately from ordinary top-control readiness.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 8 rounds of 30-second work and 60-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Top uses breakdown, ride, or half turn; bottom rebuilds base, clears half early, or escapes. Stop at controlled shoulder contact, facing, standing, or unsafe pressure.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** All matched pairs run short top-bottom challenges simultaneously under qualified supervision. Each athlete gets equal turns attacking and defending. Pause after a meaningful outcome, identify the decision, and rest. Newer pairs omit turns and continue the base-versus-breakdown task.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Work only on cooperative breakdown and base recovery; omit the turn until individually ready.

Add challenge Bottom chooses base recovery, wrist-clearing defense, or a taught escape while top chooses the appropriate response.

Stop or change Stop for neck cranking, trapped arms, joint torque, squeezing, painful turning, lifting, or a mat-return attempt.

Look for Top chooses an appropriate taught action while bottom actively defends without unsafe pressure or scrambling.

Ask When was keeping your position wiser than forcing the turn?

Connect Positions Without Scrambling

Goal Connect a taught takedown or go-behind to legal top-bottom wrestling with clear safety and outcome stops.

Set up Mat, cones, position cards, timer, bottles; roomy matched-pair zones and a separate observation edge.

Before you begin Each pair is approved for its starting position, receiving, escapes, and any permitted turn. Use B07 for the double-leg finish. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up. Use B22 for the chop and wrist capture. Use B26-B27 for the half and early defense.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with stance movement, empty-marker knee circles, comfortable bottom-base resets, and independent standing. Use short sequences separated by walking rests. Partners name the next movement before it begins, and both confirm there is enough space for every change of position.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate a controlled double finish or grounded go-behind, establish legal top control, then continue to one taught breakdown, half turn, or bottom escape. Rehearse with pauses first. Coaches specify the permitted follow-up for each pair and check receiving before combining phases.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse three chains with an announced follow-up: takedown-to-ride, go-behind-to-escape, or breakdown-to-turn. Switch roles and rest. Novices keep a full pause between positions; returners shorten the pause only while receiving, hand control, and safe alignment remain dependable.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 8 rounds of 30-second work and 60-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Start neutral or grounded; novices start grounded. Use named attack, defense, and follow-up. Stop at controlled shoulder contact, escape, standing, or unsafe position. No lifts/returns.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Use simultaneous two-position challenges. Partners choose a taught connection, complete one opposed attempt, reset, and rest before switching. Coach checks both phases instead of rewarding speed through the transition. If control deteriorates, separate the phases and rebuild the connection cooperatively.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Start grounded, pause after control, and rehearse the next action cooperatively.

Add challenge After safe control, continue directly into one taught breakdown, turn, or escape against an appropriate opponent.

Stop or change Stop for uncontrolled transitions, trapped limbs, neck strain, lifting, mat returns, or any action outside the taught set.

Look for Pair connects control to a purposeful taught top-bottom action while preserving balance, receiving, and immediate stopping.

Ask Which transition became easier when you anticipated the next wrestling position?

Understand The Official's Job

Goal Apply an actual event rule card to starts, stops, legal positions, and respectful communication.

Set up Mat, cones, current event rule card, timer, bottles; trios rotate wrestler and observer roles.

Before you begin Coaches verify the current rule card and each pair's readiness for the taught attack, defense, escape, or turn.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with stance movement and solo transitions among comfortable standing, kneeling, and seated positions. Use the practice stop signal frequently. Partners alternate caller and mover roles, checking immediate response and clear spacing rather than copying official signals from memory.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Use the verified event card to explain starts, takedown control, escapes, and shoulder-control criteria. Demonstrate each with cooperative pairs using taught skills. Separate official scoring from practice safety stops; do not invent values or assume balanced standing alone automatically earns an escape.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Trios rotate two athletes and an observer while a coach supervises. Demonstrate a controlled double or go-behind, a cleared-hand escape, and a taught turn. Observer checks one rule at a time. Swap roles, rest, and resolve uncertainty before opposed work.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 8 rounds of 30-second work and 60-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Pairs use approved taught skills. Coaches confirm outcomes using current rule card. Stop for standing before any return, unsafe position, or uncertainty. Observers defer to coach.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** All trios work simultaneously in supervised areas. Each demonstrates one actual scoring outcome and one practice-only stop, explains the difference, then rotates. Athletes may point or speak. Follow with a short restricted round and rest; only coaches resolve disputed interpretations.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Use cooperative demonstrations and only the start-stop procedure while an adult handles the rule card.

Add challenge Apply the checked scoring criteria during a thirty-second round restricted to the taught skill set.

Stop or change Stop for uncertain legality, delayed release, unsafe pressure, lifts, mat returns, or actions outside the demonstrated skill set.

Look for Athlete follows checked procedures and connects an actual wrestling outcome to the applicable event rule.

Ask Which part of the rule helped you understand what happened in the round?

Use Boundaries Without Chasing

Goal Recognize training boundaries and reset before movement reaches unsafe space.

Set up Mat, cones or flat boundary markers, event rule card, timer, bottles; clear buffers around every partner zone.

Before you begin Partners know the practice boundary and are approved for the specific taught attacks, escapes, and turns used.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with stance circles inside clearly marked squares, stopping before reaching the buffer. Partners point toward a boundary and the mover chooses a balanced direction change. Switch roles often, keep movement slow, and never use backward running to escape the square.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate noticing the training edge, stopping, releasing, and returning independently to the center. Compare this procedure with the checked event rule card. Show the same reset from standing and grounded positions; neither athlete drags, lifts, or pursues a partner across the edge.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse a controlled finish, escape, or turn near an inner practice line while preserving the full safety buffer. Either athlete may call edge; both release and reset independently. Alternate roles and rest. Coaches choose the permitted task for each matched pair.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 8 rounds of 30-second work and 60-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Start neutral or grounded. Use taught attacks, defenses, escapes; turns require readiness. Stop before buffer, at agreed outcome, or unsafe position. No lifts, returns, or chasing.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Use simultaneous boundary-awareness rounds with matched partners. After each short attempt, name the decision that kept wrestling central, release, reset, and rest. Coaches recognize controlled attacks and timely resets equally; stepping into unsafe space never becomes the price of finishing a move.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Rehearse movement and clean boundary resets without contact.

Add challenge Use a taught attack-defense or top-bottom round while both athletes track the same protected boundary.

Stop or change Stop before the buffer, neighboring pairs, unsafe pressure, lifting, mat returns, or any pursuit beyond the boundary.

Look for Athletes wrestle purposefully within the agreed area and release before entering the protected buffer.

Ask How did awareness of the boundary change your next wrestling decision?

Manage A Short Practice Round

Goal Apply a process goal using taught attacks, defenses, escapes, and turns.

Set up Mat, cones, timer, process-goal cards, verified event rule card, bottles; matched pairs and nearby observers.

Before you begin Coach verifies each pair's receiving, hand control, and readiness for the specific skills permitted in the round. Use B07 for the double-leg finish. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up. Use B26-B27 for the half and early defense.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with each athlete's familiar sequence of stance steps, base reset, sit-out, and independent stand-up. Choose comfortable versions and pause between movements. Partners observe one self-selected checkpoint, then switch roles and discuss whether the warm-up supports today's intended process goal.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate a controllable goal: finish the corner before following on top, control the waist hand during the rise and clear it before turning, or defend the half early. Coach names permitted skills and outcome stops for each pair. Show one cooperative example, then one opposed example without adding new techniques.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse their chosen goal three times against an announced response, then switch and rest. Observer identifies whether the technical action occurred rather than judging effort alone. Coaches adjust opposition to readiness and verify safe receiving before any completed takedown or turn.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 8 rounds of 30-second work and 60-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Start neutral or top-bottom. Use taught skills toward the chosen goal. Stop at agreed outcome, balanced standing before any return, or unsafe position. Keep feedback brief.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** All pairs use a short round, feedback, and retry cycle. Athlete names what happened; partner offers one useful observation; athlete chooses an adjustment. Rest before the next round and switch roles. Coaches keep advice specific to taught mechanics and appropriate opposition.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Use a fifteen-second round with one announced attack or escape and a cooperative response.

Add challenge Opponent chooses among the taught defenses or escapes while the athlete pursues the same technical goal.

Stop or change Stop for rushed receiving, neck strain, trapped limbs, unsafe pressure, lifts, mat returns, or actions outside the taught set.

Look for Athlete pursues a specific technical goal against appropriate opposition and explains the result.

Ask What did your opponent do that helped you choose an adjustment?

Optional Coached Practice Meet

Goal Apply taught folkstyle skills in an optional supervised practice meet with matched opponents and appropriate rules.

Set up Mat, cones, timer, role cards, verified rule card, bottles; separate warm-up and observer spaces.

Before you begin Athletes opt in; coaches verify receiving, safe defense, technique control, and suitable opponents for the permitted format. Use B26-B27 for the half and early defense.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with familiar stance movement, empty-space entries, and comfortable grounded transitions. Let each athlete choose the movements needed for the upcoming task. Partners observe control, then rest; athletes choosing the skills-showcase alternative receive equal preparation time and coaching attention.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Explain the format: coach-approved double finishes, sprawls, go-behinds, breakdowns, escapes, and half turns using the checked rules. No lifts, throws, mat returns, or untrained moves. Demonstrate check-in, start, stop, and respectful closure; participation alone does not certify tournament readiness.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse their assigned start and one attack-defense exchange at cooperative pace, then switch and rest. Coach checks receiving and safe release for each permitted move. Observers practice recording verified outcomes; athletes may choose a one-position round or skills demonstration instead.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Run short supervised bouts at the duration and format selected for readiness, beginning with thirty-second rounds and full rests. Use matched opponents and checked scoring. Stop at balanced standing before returns or any unsafe position; coaches retain control over every active pair.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Use simultaneous supervised showcase stations and optional short rounds. Athletes choose a taught attack, escape, or turn they can demonstrate safely, then explain one decision. Rotate equally with rest. Celebrate technical progress and partner care without pressuring anyone into another bout.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Choose a cooperative skills showcase or one-position round with an announced response.

Add challenge Use the taught attack-defense-escape-turn set under checked scoring while retaining the same no-lift and no-return limits.

Stop or change Stop for unsafe mismatch, coercion, uncontrolled receiving, neck strain, lifting, mat returns, or untrained maneuvers.

Look for Athlete applies taught skills against appropriate opposition and follows the checked procedures and safety limits.

Ask Which wrestling decision would you like to practice again after this meet?

Repair One Important Difficulty

Goal Improve one technical detail in a taught attack, defense, escape, breakdown, or turn.

Set up Mat, cones, floor dots, timer, four station cards, bottles; coaches oversee contact stations directly.

Before you begin Athlete and coach identify a taught skill, a safe simpler version, and an appropriate defensive response. Use B07 for the double-leg finish. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up. Use B22 for the chop and wrist capture. Use B26-B27 for the half and early defense.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up with stance steps, empty-space entries, knee circles around markers, and comfortable bottom-base resets. Athletes identify one movement that needs attention. Partners observe without correcting immediately, then exchange one clear observation and choose a suitable station together with the coach.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate four repairs: turn the corner before following a double, move hips back before circling from a sprawl, control the waist hand while rising, and coordinate waist with the chop. Athletes choose one repair; coaches use the half only where turning readiness is confirmed.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse three deliberate attempts against an announced response, exchange one observation, then rest and switch. Coaches change one feature at a time. Include the receiver's experience in the feedback; technical improvement must preserve controlled descent, safe joint alignment, and dependable release.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Setup/demo: 3 minutes; 8 rounds of 30-second work and 60-second rest. Alternate roles; give feedback during rests. Start in the repair's position; opponent supplies a taught response. Stop at agreed outcome or unsafe position. Compare attempts; coach checks control before changing challenge.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Use parallel repair-and-retest stations. Each pair explains one useful adjustment briefly, demonstrates it cooperatively, then tests it in a short opposed round with rest. Athletes never mock the earlier error; coaches verify that the adjustment improves technique rather than merely adding force.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Keep the skill cooperative and change only one small technical feature.

Add challenge Test the improvement against an opponent choosing among the already-taught legal responses.

Stop or change Stop for pain, forced receiving, joint torque, neck strain, lifting, returns, or a move outside the taught progression.

Look for Athlete explains one technical adjustment and applies it more effectively against an appropriate response.

Ask Which small change improved the actual wrestling outcome?

Show Progress, Choose What Follows

Goal Demonstrate improved folkstyle skills and decision-making, then choose the next appropriate development goal.

Set up Mat, cones, floor dots, timer, station cards, reflection cards, bottles; clear viewing and activity areas.

Before you begin Coaches verify each athlete's receiving and control for selected tasks; demonstration and competition roles remain voluntary. Use B07 for the double-leg finish. Use B17 for the inside-leg stand-up. Use B22 for the chop and wrist capture. Use B26-B27 for the half and early defense.

TIME	ACTIVITY AND COACHING INSTRUCTIONS
00-05 5 min	**Arrival.** Welcome athletes and privately check readiness and comfort. Review the stop signal. Pair by size, experience, maturity, and control. Begin cooperatively, confirming that both athletes can immediately stop and release.
05-15 10 min	**Movement.** Warm up through a shared sequence of stance movement, balance freezes, comfortable base resets, and independent standing. Athletes suggest one familiar movement each while the coach keeps the sequence manageable. Partners observe space and control, then rest before selecting their showcase stations.
15-27 12 min	**Learn.** Demonstrate showcase choices: controlled double and sprawl defense, grounded go-behind, stand-up or sit-out to B19 hip heist against light control, and breakdown-to-half with early defense. Coaches assign suitable versions. Explain each outcome and safety stop; no athlete must demonstrate a move beyond verified readiness.
27-30 3 min	**Water.** Pause, release partners, and collect personal water bottles. Athletes may drink whenever needed. Check whether the task felt controlled, adjust spacing or partners, and explain the next permitted reaction together.
30-45 15 min	**Rehearse.** Pairs rehearse two chosen skills, three attempts per role with rest. Start cooperatively, then add an appropriate announced response. Observer notes one visible improvement; coaches confirm safe receiving and hand control before any completed finish, turning sequence, or resisted escape.
45-60 15 min	**Apply.** Offer cooperative demonstrations or short opposed rounds at each station. Use only the taught skill set with matched partners and rest between attempts. Stop at the agreed outcome, balanced standing before returns, or unsafe position. Rotate roles so everyone receives useful practice.
60-70 10 min	**Team finish.** Run parallel partner challenges for the first half of the block, using one familiar goal and regular rests. Finish in small celebration circles: name a learned skill, thank a partner, and choose a next interest. Include noncompetitive participants without requiring public performance.
70-75 5 min	**Reflect.** Walk slowly and settle breathing. Each athlete identifies one successful action and one next step. Invite private concerns after discussion, preview the next session, and confirm the agreed pickup arrangement.

Make it easier Choose a familiar cooperative station, solo skill, or supported observation role.

Add challenge Apply a taught attack-to-control or control-to-escape sequence against an opponent choosing a familiar response.

Stop or change Stop for performance pressure, unsuitable partners, uncontrolled receiving, unsafe turning, lifting, returns, or untrained maneuvers.

Look for Athlete shows technical progress against an appropriate task and chooses a realistic next wrestling goal.

Ask Which skill or decision would you like to develop next?

Keep these references close

These practice sequences are coaching designs. Use the current rules for your actual league or event, qualified technical instruction, and the club's medical and safeguarding procedures. Session numbers do not certify tournament readiness.

Grindstone Wrestling Club and Mat Rats
https://www.grindstonewrestling.org/mat-rats

Westminster Mat Rats Wrestling on Facebook
https://www.facebook.com/WestminsterMatRats/

USA Wrestling Folkstyle Level 1 technique demonstrations
https://www.usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/1

NFHS folkstyle rules resources; confirm youth event modifications
https://www.nfhs.org/sports/wrestling/rules

American Academy of Pediatrics sports readiness
https://www.healthychildren.org/English/healthy-living/sports/Pages/Is-Your-Child-Ready-for-Sports.aspx

CDC concussion response
https://www.cdc.gov/heads-up/response/index.html

CDC infection prevention for athletes
https://www.cdc.gov/mrsa/prevention/athletes.html

Coach reminders

Keep water available. Children participate at their normally nourished and hydrated weight. Remove suspected concussion from activity and obtain medical evaluation; no same-day return. Suspected contagious skin concerns need evaluation before contact. Follow actual club reporting and emergency procedures.

After practice

Which task helped the group learn? Who needs a different partner or an easier version? What should be repeated? Record private health or safeguarding matters through the club's secure process.



TAB 6 / PLAN

Program blueprint

Research, development, engagement, inclusion, health, safeguarding and program operations.

Content: binder pages 171-185
15 content pages

Coach / group: _____

Season: _____

Youth wrestling: research and program blueprint

Prepared September 26, 2026. Designed for ages 4-6, 7-10, and 11-14.

Working assumptions: a U.S. beginner-to-intermediate folkstyle club, a flexible 12-week season, and two weekly sessions for ages 7-14. No state, facility, roster, budget, or competitive calendar was supplied. The youngest group is an optional movement/play offering. These assumptions can be changed without changing the program's central principles.

Companion: the coach toolkit contains session plans, a game bank, readiness records, parent orientation, and operational templates.

1. What the research supports

A strong youth program develops children who want to return, move with increasing competence, care for their partners, and gradually learn to solve wrestling problems. Competition can serve that development when the child is ready and interested.

Three research agents investigated curriculum and practice design; development, engagement and inclusion; and health and safeguarding. The coordinating research added club operations, current insurance, source checking, and synthesis. This is a structured research synthesis, not a systematic review or a clinical protocol.

The sources serve different purposes:

Evidence type	Appropriate use	What it does not establish
Current federation rules and safeguarding policies	Determine requirements for covered participants and activities	The ideal way to teach every child
Pediatric, public-health and sports-medicine guidance	Establish health precautions and development principles	Individual medical clearance
Original youth-sport research	Inform motivation and coaching approaches	That results automatically generalize to wrestling
Federation coaching curricula and development models	Supply technical resources and organizing principles	Universal age cutoffs, workloads or technique order
Proposed program design in this report	Make those principles usable in a club	A validated prescription or mandatory standard

Five program decisions follow from the research.

1. Give the youngest children movement play and a gradual, voluntary introduction to mat activities. Most children under six are not ready for conventional organized sport; AAP guidance favors exploration and brief demonstrations without competition. AAP sports readiness

2. Group by age for administration, then adapt instruction and contact partners to individual readiness. Development stages overlap; maturation and motivation matter. USOPC development stages

3. Teach a small connected skill set and revisit it under gradually changing conditions. USA Wrestling provides useful skill and practice libraries, but the coach must select age-appropriate content. USAW curriculum, sample practices

4. Build enjoyment into instruction, relationships and progress. Research on fun and mastery-oriented coaching supports looking beyond wins, although the studies cited here were conducted in other sports. FUN MAPS, coach-training study

5. Put health, safeguarding, parent communication and operating capacity in writing. Good technical coaching alone does not constitute a complete program.

2. Three connected participation pathways

The time ranges below are **proposed starting points**, not federation requirements or research-established maximums. Reduce demands when participation, control or recovery deteriorates. All sessions include transitions, rest, water and conversation.

Program group	Purpose	Suggested starting format	What success looks like
4-6: discover and play	Enjoy moving, share space, stop, take turns and feel comfortable on a mat	Optional 30-40-minute gathering, once weekly initially; flexible arrival/participation within supervision arrangements	Child joins willingly, tries activities, stops with support, and wants to return
7-10: learn foundations	Learn positions, safe partner habits and a few useful skills	About 45-60 minutes, twice weekly	Child explains the task, practices with control, attempts skills and treats partners well
11-14: develop and choose	Refine foundations, connect actions and make decisions	About 60-75 minutes, twice weekly initially	Athlete selects goals, adapts to reactions, manages effort and chooses a suitable participation pathway

For 4-5-year-olds, keep the offering play-based and parent-supported, with observation and movement-only options. Around age six, introduce more structure individually. There is no required takedown syllabus or tournament expectation for this band.

Parents may help with settling, transitions and agreed activities under staff direction. Being a parent does not automatically authorize supervising other children or coaching on the mat; confirm any participation against the club's credential, safeguarding and insurance arrangements.

For the two older bands, offer both a **foundation route** and an **optional competition route**. A first-year 13-year-old belongs in an age-respectful beginner group, not an advanced class simply because of age. An experienced 9-year-old can receive more difficult choices within a safe peer group without automatically moving into contact with substantially larger athletes.

Athletes may change routes. Missing a tournament, playing another sport, or returning after a break should not make them second-class members. This follows the USOPC emphasis on athlete interests, varied participation and development before competition. USOPC development stages

3. How to coach a practice

Before athletes arrive

Write one main learning problem, a simpler version, a harder version, and the behavior that will show progress. Assign coaches to specific stations or pairs. Prepare the space so children spend their time moving rather than waiting for equipment or instructions.

Example: "Today we learn to regain a stable position after an unsuccessful attempt." Beginners rehearse the recovery with a cooperative partner; experienced athletes respond to one of two familiar reactions. Both practice the same underlying problem.

A repeatable teaching cycle

1. **Explain the purpose:** one short sentence.
2. **Show:** demonstrate with a willing partner or another coach; explain necessary instructional contact.
3. **Try:** give athletes an achievable first version.
4. **Observe:** look for one important feature.
5. **Adjust:** offer one usable correction or a simpler task.
6. **Apply:** add a choice or limited resistance when safe.
7. **Reflect:** ask what worked, then move on.

This cycle is a proposed coaching routine. A ten-minute learning block means repeated attempts and feedback, not ten minutes of explanation. USAW's sample practice plans support combining review, technical work, activities and reflection. USAW sample practices

For 4-5-year-olds, these steps are brief invitations within child-directed movement play. Completing a cycle, station or skill is not required.

Define resistance by actions

"Go 50 percent" is ambiguous, particularly for children. Specify what the partner may do: "Hold your starting position; do not counter," or "You may give either of these two practiced reactions." Confirm both athletes understand the roles before starting. End the attempt if intensity rises beyond the task.

Use cooperative work before limited resistance, then short situations before broader live wrestling. A child may be ready for resistance in one position and need cooperative practice in another. Progress is specific to the task.

Manage the whole room

Assign partners deliberately, considering size, maturity, experience, control and confidence. Reassign if either athlete cannot participate meaningfully. Use planned rotations so the same child is not always the winner, loser, demonstrator or last chosen.

Every pair needs usable space, a visible supervising coach, clear permitted actions and a practiced stop signal. Any athlete may stop. If staffing or space is inadequate, reduce simultaneous contact, change to noncontact stations or split the session. A child resting at the edge still needs supervision.

4. What to teach and when to advance

The following is a **proposed selection framework**, not a manual for performing techniques. A qualified wrestling coach must demonstrate and supervise physical skills in person, with the current rules for the athlete and activity.

Learning area	Ages 4-6	Ages 7-10	Ages 11-14
Safety and belonging	Space, stop, ask for help, turn-taking	Immediate stop/release, safe partner roles	Apply safety under uncertainty; support peers without policing them
Movement	Balance, direction changes, comfortable crawling, getting up	Stance, motion, level changes and controlled transitions	Efficient movement while reacting and recovering
Neutral	Noncontact mirroring; optional simple partner activities	One coach-selected attack pathway and initial defense	Better setups, recovery and a second familiar option
Bottom	Movement exploration, without compulsory contact skills	Starting position and one escape pathway	Connect attempts and respond to changing control
Top	Cooperation and release, without compulsory pinning	Legal positioning and controlled release; add safe turn only when ready	Control-to-turn decisions using taught, appropriate skills
Rules and decisions	Stop, boundaries and taking turns	Recognize positions, basic objectives and restarts	Actual event scoring, time, boundaries and tactical choices
Personal skills	Name a feeling; choose to participate	Ask for help; retry; identify one improvement	Set a process goal; reflect; communicate load and concerns

Use the USAW folkstyle curriculum as a technical reference. Its "Level 1" designation does not mean every item is appropriate for a preschooler or novice. The broader games library also contains activities requiring skills or neck loading that this proposed introductory program does not adopt. USAW games library

Proposed contact progression: solo movement → cooperative partner activity → controlled rehearsal → restricted resistance → short positional wrestling → broader live wrestling. Before each step, observe stopping, control, comfort, space awareness and willingness. Move back a step whenever needed; this is instruction, not punishment.

The complete progression applies to ready older children. Under-six participation remains movement play and voluntary cooperative activities, without a route to competitive live wrestling in this program.

Before partner takedowns, both athletes must demonstrate the body control and safe receiving skills required for that specific task under qualified supervision.

For this introductory program, exclude uncontrolled throws, lifts and mat returns; forced neck bridges; head-first landings; painful joint pressure; and fatigue challenges that degrade control. More advanced content requires a separate readiness decision and qualified instruction, even if it appears in a published library.

5. A flexible 12-week season

This is an original planning proposal for two weekly sessions. **Weeks are teaching themes, not deadlines for mastery.** Session A introduces or clarifies a problem; session B retrieves it and applies it in a slightly different setting. The youngest group echoes the movement theme through play and does not follow the contact syllabus.

Week	Session A	Session B	Extension for experienced athletes
1	Welcome, boundaries, stop/release and movement observation	Stance/motion and cooperative habits	Respond to changing movement cues
2	Balance and recognition of neutral/top/bottom	Controlled transitions among familiar positions	Make a simple choice while preserving position
3	One coach-selected neutral attack pathway	Same pathway with a predictable reaction	Choose between two familiar setups
4	Initial defense and recovery	Restricted attack/defense problem	Recover and attempt a familiar second action
5	Bottom position and an escape pathway	Repeat with suitable partner resistance	Connect familiar escape attempts
6	Safe top position, control and release	Review and private midpoint observation	Improve control without unnecessary force
7	Connect two learned skills	Practice the connection from varied starts	Add one reaction-dependent option
8	Recognize a familiar opening or defensive cue	Choose among previously taught solutions	Increase uncertainty while keeping control

Week	Session A	Session B	Extension for experienced athletes
9	Boundaries, scoring and restarts for the actual rules used	Short situations; recheck competition interest	Manage a simple time/score problem
10	Prepare for an optional mock meet or skills festival	Run the chosen experience with safe pairings	Apply an individual process goal
11	Repair common difficulties	Athlete-selected improvement stations	Target a personal technical problem
12	Cooperative skills showcase	Celebrate growth, collect feedback and explain next options	Demonstrate learning and constructive peer support

Repeat earlier themes for late joiners and athletes needing more time. Offer the full learning experience to children who do not compete. Week ten does not establish tournament readiness.

For a shorter season, reduce the number of themes and preserve repetition. For a longer season, revisit problems with different partners and decisions before adding more techniques. Between seasons, welcome other sports and free play; do not turn optional extras into an attendance requirement.

6. Engagement, motivation and behavior

The FUN MAPS study used youth soccer players, parents and coaches to map the many contributors to enjoyment. It supports asking athletes what makes participation rewarding; it does not prove that a particular wrestling game improves retention. Visek and colleagues, 2015

A youth-basketball coach-training study found reduced performance anxiety with a mastery-oriented coaching intervention. This supports a climate focused on learning and improvement, while leaving uncertainty about the size of the effect in wrestling. Smith and colleagues, 2007

Proposed daily habits: greet everyone by name, give each athlete an attainable challenge, offer two acceptable choices, explain a drill's purpose, recognize specific progress, and invite a brief response at the end. Make partner care visible: "You stopped as soon as your partner asked. That helped them trust you."

Use learning goals rather than outcome promises. "Try your practiced setup twice" is controllable; "win every match" is not. Praise effort when it is connected to an effective strategy, adjustment or persistence, rather than praising exhaustion for its own sake.

Situation	Useful coach response
Child is afraid of contact	"Thanks for telling me. Let's choose a version you can control."
Child makes an error	"You found the right idea. Try changing this one part."
Athlete loses	"How are you feeling? We can discuss the match when you're ready."
Athlete becomes frustrated	"It's okay to be frustrated. We still keep our partner safe. Let's reset."

Situation	Useful coach response
Athlete succeeds easily	"Which part could you make more precise?"
Older athlete wants more autonomy	"Choose one goal for this round. What feedback would help?"

Teach three expectations: **stop promptly, protect your partner, speak respectfully**. Rehearse them. For unsafe conduct, end contact, calmly name the action, provide a supervised reset, and teach the replacement. Persistent difficulty calls for a private support plan with the family. A reset is not isolation or public shaming.

SafeSport guidance supports positive discipline and identifies humiliation and deprivation of water as misconduct concerns. Adopt a club prohibition on belittling, body comments, hazing and exercise used as punishment. SafeSport coaching guidance

Intervene in bullying regardless of the athlete's talent or the parent's influence. Protect the harmed child, hear accounts separately and follow the reporting policy. Do not require immediate reconciliation as the price of returning to practice. SafeSport bullying handbook

7. Inclusion, parents and access

Individual accommodations

Use predictable routines, visual schedules, demonstrations and consistent cues. Ask families which supports already help. Offer a quieter explanation area, transition warnings and an agreed visual stop signal when needed. Do not require eye contact as proof of attention. Adapt the activity while retaining a meaningful role. These suggestions draw on Special Olympics coaching guidance; individual preferences matter more than diagnostic stereotypes. Athlete-centered coaching guide

Invite the athlete to explain what feels useful or uncomfortable. Collect only necessary health/support information and share it with staff who need it. Arrange an individual plan for medical or disability-related needs with the family and appropriate professionals.

Girls and other underrepresented participants

Actively recruit girls, recruit and support women coaches, provide suitable clothing options and private changing arrangements, and distribute coaching attention fairly. Ask about partner comfort without abandoning safe matching. Provide menstrual supplies discreetly. Do not infer an athlete's motives, temperament or ability from gender. USAW's coaching resource encourages welcoming messaging, peer recruitment and adult women role models. USAW recruiting and coaching women

Competition eligibility and categories must be checked separately with the current event authority. Every participant should receive respectful treatment and protection from harassment.

Parent partnership

A study of 723 athletes and their parents associated supportive parent behavior with enjoyment and pressure with amotivation. It was correlational and involved other team sports; it is useful guidance, not proof of a wrestling-specific causal effect. Sánchez-Miguel and colleagues, 2013

Use a preseason orientation to explain goals, contact progression, optional competition, expected costs, health rules, conduct and reporting. During practice, coaches supply technical instruction; parents support

participation and alert staff to concerns. Afterward, suggest "What did you enjoy?" and "What did you learn?" before technical criticism.

Make the program's full cost visible, including membership, equipment, events and travel. Offer equipment loans, payment plans and discreet scholarships where feasible. Keep a local participation option so travel is not the gateway to belonging. Track scheduling and transportation barriers rather than interpreting every absence as lack of commitment. AAP organized-sport guidance emphasizes developmentally appropriate opportunities and access. AAP organized-sport report

8. Health and recovery policies

These are operational precautions supported by health guidance. Coaches teach and observe; qualified clinicians evaluate illness, injury and individualized health concerns.

Weight, hydration and nutrition

Proposed club policy: athletes participate at their normally nourished, hydrated weight. Coaches do not prescribe weight loss or ask a child to reach a lower class. Growth-related movement to another class is expected. Necessary weight information is private.

This policy is deliberately protective across ages 4-14; it is not presented as a universal federation ban on every weight change. AAP warns about inappropriate weight loss in young athletes and notes that most junior-high wrestlers should not lose weight for wrestling. AAP weight guidance, AAP wrestling guidance

Provide labeled personal water bottles and unrestricted access, with planned pauses. Never use fluid restriction, extra clothing, fasting or punishment exercise to make weight. Encourage ordinary varied meals, familiar tournament food and allergy planning. Avoid coach-prescribed calories or supplements. Water is the default drink. AAP hydration guidance Stimulant-containing energy drinks are inappropriate for children. AAP caffeine guidance

Skin and mat hygiene

Teach prompt reporting of rashes and sores, showering after participation, clean clothing after use and no shared towels. Staff observe visible concerns without intrusive examinations; medical professionals diagnose suspected infections. CDC athlete guidance

Assign and log cleaning. Use surface-compatible products according to their labels, including contact time, and allow surfaces to dry. Clean shared equipment after use, repair damaged surfaces and keep chemicals away from children. CDC facility guidance

Proposed club rule: a suspicious potentially contagious lesion means no contact pending evaluation. Return requires the relevant medical documentation and event/federation criteria. Covering a contagious lesion is not a workaround. NFHS inspected 2024 model form The current NFHS form landing page was checked, but its newest PDF could not be retrieved during research; no treatment-time table is reproduced here. NFHS current form

Concussion and emergency response

For suspected concussion, remove the athlete immediately, check for danger signs, notify the guardian and obtain medical evaluation. Seek emergency care immediately for danger signs. No same-day return. Coaches do not grant medical clearance. CDC concussion response

Return follows healthcare-provider approval and supervision through a graduated process. CDC states that each step typically takes at least 24 hours; recurrent symptoms require stopping and contacting the provider. Do not promise a fixed return date or use a completed checklist as medical clearance. CDC return to sport

Write and rehearse a venue-specific emergency action plan. Assign first response, emergency calling, AED retrieval, EMS access, guardian contact and supervision of the remaining children. Post the exact address and entrance. NATA recommends annual review and rehearsal and an AED on site or retrievable for use within three minutes. NATA emergency planning statement, 2024

Total load, sleep and strength

Ask about school teams, other clubs, tournaments and family demands. Respond to recurrent pain, fatigue, declining enjoyment or deteriorating control by reducing demands and seeking appropriate evaluation. AAP recommends 1-2 weekly rest days and 2-3 months away from a specific sport annually. These are general guidance, not a guarantee that a particular schedule is safe. AAP overtraining guidance

CDC sleep ranges cross the program's age bands: ages 3-5 need 10-13 hours including naps; 6-12 need 9-12; 13-17 need 8-10. Schedule practice endings and travel accordingly. CDC sleep guidance

For introductory physical preparation, use enjoyable movement and carefully coached balance and strength patterns. Any formal resistance-training component should be designed and supervised by a qualified coach, emphasize technique, and account for the total workload. Do not use maximal lifting contests or exhaustion tests to rank children. Persistent food anxiety, fatigue, recurring injury or menstrual concerns call for confidential clinical referral, not coach diagnosis. IOC REDs consensus, 2023

9. Safeguarding and reporting

For a USA Wrestling affiliate, implement the applicable federation policy, including its **2025 MAAPP**. It addresses observable and interruptible adult/minor interactions, transparent communications, individual training, changing areas, transport, lodging and treatment. Required consent and exceptions are context-specific; a general parental waiver does not replace the policy. USAW MAAPP

Operationally, designate a safeguarding contact outside the head coach's direct authority, establish approved communication channels, record pickup authorization, and make reporting routes visible to children and families. Teach children how to say stop and identify an adult they can approach.

For **Adult Participants under the 2026 SafeSport Code**, reporting is an individual obligation; telling a supervisor is insufficient. Victims are not required to self-report. Known or suspected child abuse must be reported immediately to law enforcement and the Center, with additional recipients as state law requires. Sexual misconduct must be reported to the Center immediately and no later than 24 hours; child-abuse duties also apply where relevant. Do not investigate credibility before reporting. Other misconduct and policy violations also carry reporting duties. 2026 SafeSport Code, section X

Use the SafeSport reporting portal and the USA Wrestling misconduct portal as applicable. Immediate danger calls for emergency services. A club complaint process must never delay required external reporting. Train staff on the full policy and local law before they begin work with children.

10. Staffing, facilities, finances and administration

Roles and supervision

Assign responsibility for coaching/curriculum, safeguarding, emergency preparation, registration, family communication, finances and equipment/cleaning. In a small club, one person may cover several roles, but concerns about a coach need a route outside that coach.

Proposed operating minimum: two appropriately screened/trained adults present, with at least one qualified coach directing each active contact group. This is a club safeguard, not a verified universal USAW practice ratio. More adults may be necessary. Record a session's capacity based on age, needs, mat layout, contact intensity and whether every pair can actually be observed and interrupted. Do not enroll to a number that exceeds that capacity.

For a USAW club, check current leader membership, required screening and SafeSport completion for applicable personnel. USAW recommends Copper coaching certification for ages 12 and under and Bronze for 13 and older, while actual state/event credential requirements vary. Certification should be accompanied by practical mentoring, observation and feedback. USAW membership types, coach certification

Hold a short pre-practice staff huddle and a post-practice review. Once a month, observe a coach for clarity, engagement, safe pairing, correction quality and equitable attention. Review difficult situations without exposing children's private information unnecessarily.

Facility and equipment

Arrange suitable wrestling mats with secure seams, clear run-off space and protected hazards; usable toilets/changing arrangements; ventilation; water access; storage; first-aid supplies; and emergency access. Confirm the facility's rules for mat installation, cleaning, occupancy, AED access and supervision. Keep spectators and loose equipment outside activity areas.

Publish a simple equipment list: clean safe practice clothing, properly fitted wrestling shoes where appropriate, personal bottle, and protective equipment required by the activity or event. As a proposed club policy, use correctly fitted wrestling ear guards for partner contact and live practice. Confirm mouthguard, braces, clothing and other equipment requirements under the rules used. Protective equipment does not replace controlled technique and pairing.

Charter and insurance

Use the current USAW club-charter guidance. Verify the organization's actual coverage with the insurer or USAW, including introductory sessions, visitors, events and all practice sites, before advertising covered activities.

The **2026-27 USAW insurance summary** makes coverage conditional: chartered practice provisions include leader supervision and participating member requirements. It also identifies liability exclusions involving residential settings and multisport/multi-activity entities and gaps such as club property, auto and directors/officers coverage. The summary is not the insurance contract. Do not assume a charter covers every setting or a free trial participant. 2026-27 insurance information

Adding a practice address is separate from adding an additional insured entity. Confirm the facility's required documentation. Encouraging children to play other sports does not mean the wrestling club is automatically insured to operate other sports. USAW practice-address guidance

Budget and records

Build a local budget from actual quotations; no national fee estimate is supplied. Include facility hire, mats/storage, staffing and training, charter/membership administration, insurance, cleaning, equipment loans, first aid, registration services, scholarships and a reserve. Keep optional event/travel charges separate from core participation.

Proposed fee formula: **(fixed seasonal costs + planned reserve − committed subsidy) ÷ conservative paying enrollment + variable cost per athlete**. Model lower-than-expected enrollment before committing to a facility. Explain refunds and cancellations in advance.

Keep attendance, emergency contacts, authorized pickup, staff credentials, cleaning logs, incident records and any medical restrictions securely. Limit access and establish retention/deletion rules appropriate to the organization and jurisdiction. Obtain specific media permission; avoid publishing children's health, weights or identifiable schedules unnecessarily.

11. Competition and style adaptation

Competition readiness requires athlete interest, safe participation in the relevant positions, reliable stop/release behavior, a supported practice or mock-match experience the athlete willingly chooses, and an appropriate opponent opportunity. The athlete needs sufficient control and confidence to participate safely. The family's understanding of the event also matters. A practice win is not a readiness test.

Preparation includes recognizing pinning situations and practicing an appropriate, controlled response with qualified instruction. A tournament should not be the athlete's first encounter with that experience.

Start with a local, well-run, developmentally suitable event when desired. Confirm division eligibility, novice rules, pairing, permitted techniques, bout format, medical/skin procedures, equipment, rest provisions and coach credentials. Decline or withdraw from an unsafe mismatch through the event's procedures.

The requested age bands are program groupings, **not official competition divisions**. The USAW rolling rulebook identified itself as the **2027 edition, updated September 13, 2026**, when checked. It primarily addresses international styles and contains folkstyle modifications; the actual folkstyle event may combine NFHS, USAW and state rules. Do not apply freestyle scoring to folkstyle. USAW rulebook, NFHS rules portal

For freestyle or Greco-Roman, retain the developmental approach and replace technical/scoring content with instruction from a qualified style coach. Freestyle adds style-specific exposure and par-terre decisions. Greco changes allowable attacks and prohibits active use of the legs against an opponent. Use the appropriate curriculum and current event rules. USAW Olympic styles curriculum

12. Measure quality and improve the program

Use a private early/mid/late-season observation with "needs support," "emerging," and "independent in this task." Record the next teaching action. Do not publish a league table of children.

For the youngest children, these are informal adult planning notes, not testing days or pass/fail graduation. Accept gestures, pictures, demonstrations and pointing as communication; verbally naming a feeling is not an admission requirement.

Measure	How to collect it	How to use it
Enjoyment and willingness to return	One age-appropriate question after practice	Look for recurring low responses and ask privately why
Belonging	Ask whether the child has a trusted adult and a comfortable partner	Repair isolation and partner selection
Skill progress	Observe the few skills currently taught	Adjust task difficulty and repetition
Safety behavior	Stop/release, controlled partnering, incident and near-miss records	Change supervision, space or task design
Attendance and continuation	Separate temporary absences, completion and next-season return	Identify access barriers without blaming families
Family experience	Brief midpoint and end-season feedback	Adjust communication, costs and logistics
Coach practice	Peer observation using a few agreed behaviors	Select a specific improvement for the next month

Track novice retention and the experience of smaller or underrepresented groups where numbers permit privacy. Do not set a target of "zero reports": that can discourage reporting. Reward prompt reporting and corrective action.

13. Launch sequence and unresolved local decisions

Before registration: define pathways, identify the governing organization, secure qualified staff and venue, verify coverage, price the program, and publish the purpose and full costs.

Before the first session: verify credentials; complete local rules, medical and safeguarding procedures; rehearse the emergency plan; assign capacity; collect essential family information; run parent orientation; and prepare the first two sessions.

During the first two weeks: observe readiness, stabilize routines, adjust groupings and confirm every child has an appropriate activity and partner. Avoid promising a fixed tournament schedule to every beginner.

Midseason: review enjoyment, attendance, skills, incidents, family concerns and coaching quality. Change the plan where evidence from the room indicates a problem.

End of season: celebrate learning, invite honest feedback, explain continued recreation and competition options, reconcile finances, and plan a genuine break from the sport.

The owner must still resolve: state and event rules; reporting law and recipients; concussion clearance rules; participation/category requirements; staff availability; actual mat capacity; facility/AED access; medical referral and event coverage; insurance exclusions; travel/changing arrangements; local fees; and record-handling requirements. These are configuration decisions for a real club, not reasons to postpone curriculum development.

14. Evidence register and limitations

All sources below were checked by the research team on September 26, 2026. An undated page is not assumed to have been newly published. Search-engine crawl dates were not treated as publication dates. Some USAW pages intermittently rejected direct retrieval; indexed official text and accessible federation documents were used. The current NFHS skin-form landing page was verified, but its newest attachment was inaccessible.

Sources	Date/status	Evidence and limitation
AAP readiness; USOPC stages	AAP updated June 28, 2024; USOPC page undated	Development guidance and framework; not trials of the proposed age groups
USAW curriculum, practice plans, games	Undated current resources	Technical and coaching examples; require individual selection
Visek et al.	Online 2014; journal issue 2015	Original soccer concept-mapping research; not an intervention proving retention
Smith et al.	2007	Original youth-basketball coaching intervention; anxiety outcome
SafeSport coaching, bullying handbook	Coaching page undated; handbook 2016	Practitioner safeguarding guidance
Special Olympics guide; USAW girls resource	Dates not established; girls resource references 2015 team	Useful inclusion approaches; individualize and avoid dated stereotypes
Sánchez-Miguel et al.	2013	Original questionnaire research; association does not prove causation
AAP organized sports	2019; reaffirmed 2023	Clinical report on development and participation
AAP weight, wrestling, hydration	Weight page updated 2012; other page dates not relied on	Family health guidance; no individualized diet prescribed

Sources	Date/status	Evidence and limitation
CDC athletes, facilities	June 27, 2025	Infection-prevention guidance
NFHS skin form	Landing page September 2, 2026	Current document locator; new PDF not inspected
CDC response, return	September 15, 2025	Concussion precautions and clinician-led return framework
NATA emergency plan	June 2024 statement	Professional position statement; local implementation required
AAP overtraining; CDC sleep	July 26, 2024; May 15, 2024	General recovery guidance, not individual load thresholds
IOC REDs	2023	Clinical consensus; referral awareness, not coach diagnosis
USAW MAAPP; SafeSport Code	2025 policy; 2026 Code	Governing requirements within their jurisdiction; consult full text
Reporting portals, USAW portal	Current pages	Reporting routes; local legal duties also apply
Membership, certification, charter	Current undated guidance	Administrative information; event requirements vary
Insurance, practice address	2026-27 summary; current FAQ	Summary and administrative guidance; contract determines coverage
USAW rules, NFHS rules, Olympic curriculum	USAW 2027 edition; NFHS 2026-27 resources; undated curriculum	Rule authority and technical resource; check actual event
AAP caffeine; NFHS inspected model	August 11, 2025; April 2024	Supports caffeine guidance and no covering workaround; use current event skin criteria

What remains uncertain: this research did not establish one optimal practice duration, child-to-coach ratio, number of annual matches, or compulsory week-by-week progression. Older USAW development posters contain differing age brackets and workload suggestions; those numbers were not converted into requirements. Specific games, templates, time budgets, season sequence and staffing proposals here are original design choices. Broader youth-sport findings should be evaluated against feedback from this wrestling program rather than treated as guarantees.

Source links

S01 https://www.healthychildren.org/English/healthy-living/sports/Pages/Is-Your-Child-Ready-for-Sports.aspx
S02 https://www.usopc.org/coaching-education/adm/american-development-model-stages
S03 https://www.usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum
S04 https://assets.contentstack.io/v3/assets/blteb7d012fc7ebef7f/blt60b6b81d96aec8e9/665a3a926330abb9c1345c87/Folkstyle_Level1_Practice_Plans.pdf
S05 https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/24770788/
S06 https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/17556775/
S07 https://www.usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/7
S08 https://uscenterforsafesport.org/positivity-and-understanding-define-next-gen-coaching-practices/
S09 https://uscenterforsafesport.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/11/US-Center-for-SafeSport-Preventing-Bullying-What-Great-Coaches-Need-to-Know.pdf
S10 https://media.specialolympics.org/resources/sports-essentials/general/AthleteCentered_CoachingGuide.pdf
S11 https://content.themat.com/CoachesCorner/Recruiting-and-Coaching-Women.pdf
S12 https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/23717366/
S13 https://publications.aap.org/pediatrics/article/143/6/e20190997/37135/Organized-Sports-for-Children-Preadolescents-and
S14 https://www.healthychildren.org/English/healthy-living/sports/Pages/Safe-Weight-Loss-and-Weight-Gain-for-Young-Athletes.aspx
S15 https://www.healthychildren.org/English/healthy-living/sports/Pages/Wrestling.aspx
S16 https://www.healthychildren.org/English/healthy-living/nutrition/Pages/Choose-Water-for-Healthy-Hydration.aspx
S17 https://www.cdc.gov/mrsa/prevention/athletes.html
S18 https://www.cdc.gov/mrsa/prevention/coaches-athletic-directors.html
S19 https://www.nfhs.org/resources/sports/nfhs-wrestling-skin-lesion-form
S20 https://www.cdc.gov/heads-up/response/index.html
S21 https://www.cdc.gov/heads-up/guidelines/returning-to-sports.html
S22 https://www.nata.org/sites/default/files/2025-08/emergency_action_plan_development.pdf
S23 https://www.healthychildren.org/English/health-issues/injuries-emergencies/sports-injuries/Pages/Too-Much-Too-Soon-Overtraining.aspx
S24 https://www.cdc.gov/sleep/about/
S25 https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/37752011/
S26 https://maapp.uscenterforsafesport.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/02/Wrestling_2025MAAPP_09.01.24_Final.pdf
S27 https://uscenterforsafesport.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/2026-Safesport-Code_1225.pdf
S28 https://uscenterforsafesport.org/report-a-concern/
S29 https://www.usawmembership.com/misconduct
S30 https://www.themat.com/membership/membership-levels
S31 https://www.themat.com/coaches/ncep-certification
S32 https://www.usawmembership.com/help/category/4/question/16
S33 https://usaw-public.s3.us-east-2.amazonaws.com/insurance_forms/Insuranceinfo.pdf
S34 https://www.usawmembership.com/help/category/4/question/63
S35 https://www.usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_rule_book
S36 https://www.nfhs.org/sports/wrestling/rules
S37 https://www.usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/4
S38 https://www.healthychildren.org/English/healthy-living/nutrition/Pages/the-effects-of-caffeine-on-kids-a-parents-guide.aspx
S39 https://assets.nfhs.org/umbraco/media/882323/2024-25-nfhs-wrestling-skin-lesion-form-final-5-1-24.pdf

TAB 7 / TOOLS

Coach toolkit and reusable forms

Games, planning forms, observation records, family communication and operating worksheets.

Content: binder pages 187-201
15 content pages

Coach / group: _____

Season: _____

Youth wrestling coach toolkit

Prepared September 26, 2026. Companion to the research and program blueprint.

These are original, editable planning tools for a U.S. beginner/intermediate folkstyle program. Durations, game formats, observation scales and staffing choices are proposals. They do not replace qualified instruction, medical decisions, the club's actual safeguarding policy or event rules. Complete local operating fields before using the relevant template.

1. A child's first visit

Before arrival, send the start/end time, what to wear, where to enter, how pickup works and a contact for support needs. Resolve registration, participation permission and applicable coverage first; a "free trial" does not automatically satisfy membership or insurance conditions.

At arrival, greet the child by name, introduce the supervising adult, show the water/rest area and demonstrate the stop signal. Offer a familiar, low-demand activity. Let the child observe before joining. Explain partner selection without making them find a partner publicly.

For ages 4-6, begin with a choice such as stepping between markers or copying the coach. For older beginners, first explain what they will actually practice; do not introduce them with a surprise live match.

If overwhelmed: stop contact, provide a supervised quiet space, offer a familiar movement activity or break, and support rejoining without pressure. Ask the family what usually helps. Keep the child within safeguarding arrangements; a break does not mean leaving them alone.

At pickup, give one specific positive observation and the next practical step. Avoid promising talent, scholarships or tournament success after one visit.

2. Three ready-to-adapt session plans

All water breaks are additional to freely available water throughout. Blocks include rest, demonstration, feedback and rotation. End or simplify contact when control declines. "Live" work means only appropriate, taught actions with safe pairings and active supervision.

Ages 4-6: 35-minute play menu

Theme: moving safely in shared space. **Equipment:** flat, nonslip markers and a visual stop cue. **Success:** voluntary participation and a positive goodbye.

Time	Minutes	Invitation
0-5	5	Welcome and choose a simple movement activity; observation is welcome
5-10	5	Traffic lights: move, slow and stop inside personal spaces
10-18	8	Choose between stepping islands, comfortable crawling and balance play
18-20	2	Water and reset
20-27	7	Mirror the coach or a willing partner without contact
27-32	5	Children choose a familiar activity; adults follow their interests
32-35	3	Point to or describe a favorite activity, then supervised pickup
Total	**35**	**A flexible gathering, not a required sequence**

Children may remain at a preferred activity, observe, pause or finish early with an authorized adult. There are no required takedowns, live matches or conditioning finishers. An older, ready six-year-old may receive an individual introductory task without changing the play focus for younger children.

Ages 7-10: 60-minute foundation practice

Example theme: recognizing and using one already selected escape pathway. Qualified coaches choose the actual skill and demonstrate it. First-week sessions instead use stopping, movement and positions.

Time	Minutes	Activity
0-5	5	Welcome, comfort/health check and one simple goal
5-13	8	Movement warm-up through mirror or compass games
13-21	8	Recall familiar movement and starting position
21-31	10	Brief demonstrations alternating with attempts at the day's skill
31-33	2	Water and reset
33-40	7	Cooperative pairs; roles defined and swapped
40-47	7	Short restricted tasks for ready athletes; rehearsal for others
47-55	8	Cooperative group game or skill collection
55-60	5	Name one improvement, recognize safe partnering and preview next time
Total	**60**	

Beginner version: predictable partner, one cue, no counter. **Extension:** respond to one of two familiar reactions. Example rounds can be 20-30 seconds with at least enough rest and feedback to reset safely; this is a starting format, not a required work/rest ratio. Never turn the seven-minute application block into uninterrupted hard wrestling.

Ages 11-14: 75-minute development practice

Example theme: recovering after an initial attack is stopped. Newcomers learn the component positions while experienced athletes link familiar actions.

Time	Minutes	Activity
0-5	5	Check-in and athlete-selected process goal
5-15	10	Movement preparation and an engaging reaction game
15-25	10	Retrieve familiar skills; identify the problem to solve
25-37	12	Learn or refine one response through short demonstrations and attempts
37-40	3	Water and reset
40-55	15	Restricted practice with clear roles, choices, rests and feedback
55-67	12	Short positional situations or broader live work when ready
67-72	5	Enjoyable group finish with controlled movement
72-75	3	Reflect on the goal and choose a next step
Total	**75**	

Use shorter sessions for new or fatigued groups. If adding a qualified strength component, replace an existing block and recalculate the total rather than automatically extending practice. Review school, club and tournament demands before offering extra weekly sessions.

3. Ten games with a purpose and a stop condition

These are proposed formats, not copies of a federation game manual. Use marked spaces, no elimination and multiple small groups where staffing permits. Check that markers cannot slide or trip athletes. The contact game is only for ready older participants.

Game	Suggested group and purpose	How to run it	Stop or change when
Traffic lights	4-10; stopping and space	Green means comfortable movement, yellow slow, red freeze	Children collide, sprint blindly or cannot stop
Mirror movement	All; balance and response	A leader changes direction while a follower mirrors at a safe distance; swap	Distance collapses or speed exceeds control
Stance statues	6-14; stable movement	Move briefly, then freeze in a comfortable balanced position	Repeated loss of balance or discomfort appears
Animal choices	4-10; movement variety	Choose a comfortable walk, crawl or small hop between nearby markers	Wrist/knee pain, head-first movement or collisions develop
Island stepping	4-10; balance and control	Step among flat markers; pause briefly on an island	Markers move or children race into shared space
Compass coach	6-14; direction changes	Follow direction cues within individual areas	Athletes cross lanes or become confused at speed
Shadow level change	7-14; matching movement	Follow a partner's comfortable up/down movement without contact	Diving, knee impact or loss of balance occurs
Rule-card walk	7-14; rules and vocabulary	Walk to a picture showing a position or boundary and explain it	Too many converge; add stations or stagger turns
Movement puzzle	All; cooperation	Partners reproduce a short no-contact sequence, such as step, stop, turn	A partner feels pressured or cannot follow safely
Light shoulder touch	Ready 7-14; distance and reactions	One light open-hand shoulder touch, then reset; no grab, shove or takedown	Head contact, chasing, grabbing, anger or loss of control occurs

For a child who cannot comfortably do a movement, offer an equivalent choice immediately. The goal is participation and learning, not "earning" access to the rest of practice.

4. Four wrestling learning cards

Use only movements already demonstrated safely by a qualified coach. These cards define learning constraints, not physical technique instructions.

Before partner takedowns, verify both athletes' body control and safe receiving skills for the particular task under qualified supervision.

Card	Task and roles	Easier version	Extension	End the attempt when
Position recognition	Coach names a familiar position; athletes identify or assume the taught start	Use a picture and individual demonstration	Athlete explains the objective from that position	Confusion creates unsafe contact
One-path rehearsal	One athlete practices the day's pathway; partner provides a prescribed cooperative response	Practice components without a partner	Add one allowed defensive reaction	Either partner improvises outside the task
Read the reaction	Partner gives one of two familiar cues; athlete chooses a taught response	Announce the cue first	Vary its timing while retaining control	Speed prevents controlled execution
One-objective situation	Start in a taught position with one limited objective; swap roles	Cooperative rehearsal	Add one familiar option or a simple time/score problem	Stop signal, pain, fear, boundary hazard or unsafe pressure

Keep score only when it serves the learning objective. A cooperative "both partners did the task well" outcome is often more useful than keeping a winner in and sending others out.

5. Reusable practice planner

Date / group / expected attendance: _____

Lead coach / assistants / assigned areas: _____

One main learning problem: _____

What progress will look like: _____

Simpler version / more challenging version: _____

Known restrictions and supports, shared only with relevant staff: _____

Block	Minutes	Task / cue	Pairing and supervision	Alternative
Welcome and check-in				
Movement				
Review				
Learning				
Water/reset				
Application				
Enjoyable finish				
Reflection/pickup				
Total				

After practice: Who engaged? Who struggled or appeared isolated? Which task had too much waiting? Were any pairings unsafe? What changes next time? Record incidents through the separate secure process.

6. Private learning and readiness record

Athlete / date / observer: _____

Use **S = needs support, E = emerging, I = independent in this specific task**. No combined score or ranking. For preschoolers, use informal observations during play and omit contact/technical items. Accept gestures and pictures.

Observation	S / E / I / not applicable	What was observed	Next teaching action
Stops and releases on signal			
Maintains space and control			
Communicates discomfort or seeks help			
Cooperates with an appropriate partner			
Recognizes current starting positions			
Performs the current taught task			
Responds safely to the permitted resistance			
Rejoins or retries with appropriate support			

Athlete's view: favorite part _____; difficult part _____; wish for next time _____.

Current practice level, by task: movement / cooperative / rehearsed skill / restricted resistance / positional / broader live.

Next review: _____. An athlete can use different levels for different tasks.

Optional competition decision

Record the child's interest, relevant readiness observations, chosen event/rules, suitability of opponents, family understanding, required documents and who made the decision. Include a plan for opting out or withdrawing if circumstances change. A "not yet" decision must include the next learning opportunity; it is not removal from the club.

Include recognition of pinning situations and an appropriate, controlled response learned under qualified coaching. The athlete should encounter that experience in supported practice before a tournament.

7. Parent orientation and welcome message

Suggested 20-minute meeting: five minutes on age-group goals, five on daily logistics and health practices, five on conduct/safeguarding/reporting, five for questions. Provide the information in writing for families who cannot attend.

Suggested message, to customize:

> *Our goal is for every child to feel welcome, improve their movement and wrestling skills, and learn to care for a partner. The youngest group focuses on play. Older groups learn through repeated practice and gradually increasing challenge. Tournaments are optional and depend on readiness and interest.*
>
> *Please tell us about support needs, relevant medical restrictions, schedule conflicts and concerns. Bring the listed equipment and a personal water bottle. Encourage your child to report pain, skin concerns or uncomfortable interactions. Our program does not ask children to cut weight.*
>
> *During practice, let coaches give technical direction. Afterward, ask what your child enjoyed or learned. Cheer respectfully and help us make new families feel included. You may raise ordinary program concerns with [contact]; safeguarding concerns can go directly to [independent contact and external reporting routes].*
>
> *Practice times: [ ]. Full core fee and what it covers: [ ]. Optional costs: [ ]. Equipment assistance: [ ]. Cancellation/refund rules: [ ]. Pickup arrangements: [ ].*

Provide a separate, clear media-consent choice. Avoid bundling optional photography into permission to participate.

8. Pre-practice operating card

Complete by an assigned adult. This is a proposed club routine, not a substitute for the facility or governing body's requirements.

- Attendance, essential emergency information and authorized pickup are accessible to relevant staff.
- Staff present meet the club's credential and supervision plan; activity capacity is appropriate.
- Mats, seams, margins, hazards, lighting and ventilation are checked.
- Cleaning has been completed correctly; equipment and surfaces are ready for use.
- Phone, emergency access, first-aid supplies and AED arrangements are verified.
- Coaches know restrictions, suitable pairings, learning goals and simpler alternatives.
- Athletes know the stop signal and can access water.
- A supervised plan covers arrivals, breaks, toilets/changing and departures.

If something is inadequate, change the activity or attendance arrangement before starting. Record who will fix the issue and when.

9. Emergency action plan worksheet

Complete with appropriate facility and medical/emergency input, then rehearse. This is a planning worksheet, not instructions for administering medical treatment. The source framework is the NATA emergency planning statement.

Field	Local plan
Facility, exact address, room and entrance	
Emergency number and reliable phone	
Lead first responder and backup	
Person calling emergency services	
AED location, access and retrieval person	
First-aid kit and other approved equipment	
Person meeting responders and clearing access	
Person supervising remaining children	
Guardian notification and emergency-contact access	
Relevant individual action plans	
Rehearsal date / attendees / changes needed	
Review owner and next review date	

For suspected concussion, use immediate removal and medical evaluation, with no same-day return. Emergency danger signs require urgent care. Return decisions follow healthcare guidance and applicable rules. Keep the CDC response guidance available to staff.

10. Incident, cleaning and credential records

Incident / near-miss record

Record date/time/location; activity; people involved; objective observations; the child's own words where relevant; immediate actions; notifications and times; external reporting where required; restrictions; and follow-up owner/date. Store securely. Do not diagnose, speculate about blame, or investigate a safeguarding disclosure in place of reporting it. A club record does not replace any medical, insurance or mandatory external report.

Cleaning log

Date/time	Surface/equipment	Product and label instructions followed	Completed by	Defect or follow-up

Use the CDC athletic-facility guidance and actual product instructions. Keep cleaning materials secured.

Staff credential tracker

Staff member / role	Membership if applicable	Screening status	Safeguarding training	Coaching training	CPR/AED/first aid as assigned	Expiry / owner

Keep sensitive background-screening details out of shared rosters; record verified eligibility/status and renewal needs with controlled access.

11. Program dashboard

Review these monthly and at season end. Choose improvements from patterns, not a single bad day.

Question	Simple measure	Action if a concern appears
Do children want to come back?	Age-appropriate enjoyment response	Ask privately; adjust tasks or relationships
Is everyone included?	Trusted adult and comfortable-partner check	Change partner/station arrangements
Are they learning?	Current task observations	Reteach or increase challenge individually
Are practices controlled?	Stop/release, incidents and near misses	Modify supervision, space or activity
Can families participate?	Absence/exit reasons, cost and timing feedback	Address practical barriers
Are coaches improving?	One peer-observed behavior per month	Set a specific coaching goal

For return rate, define the cohort and denominator: returning eligible athletes divided by prior-season athletes eligible to return. Separately record aging out, moving away and choosing another activity. Do not pressure families to return to improve the metric.

12. Questions to finalize the local program

1. Which state, governing organization and wrestling style apply?
2. How many athletes are expected in each age and experience group?
3. What mat space, practice times and facility arrangements are available?
4. Which screened, trained coaches and assistants will actually attend each session?
5. Is the main purpose recreation, beginner development, optional competition, or a combination?
6. What season length, family costs and scholarship resources are realistic?
7. What medical, emergency, safeguarding, insurance and transport arrangements have been verified?

The blueprint supplies a flexible curriculum while these details are resolved. The finished local handbook should name responsible people, insert actual contacts and rules, and replace planning placeholders with approved operating arrangements.

TAB 8 / QUICK

Quick coaching cues

Two pages per age group, with cues and exact page references to the shared move instructions. Use MOV for the full teaching sequence and prerequisites.

Content: binder pages 203-208
6 content pages

Coach / group: _____

Season: _____

Quick reminders for the mat

Use the shared Coach Moves Reference for the full steps. Page numbers below refer to that standalone reference. Follow the practice task and each move's prerequisites; entry-only work stops before a finish.

01 Stance and Footwork

Full instruction P01: Wrestling Stance, p. 6 / P02: Stance Steps, p. 6

P01 cues Knees bent, eyes ahead. / Hands forward, elbows in.

P02 cues Step, follow, feet apart. / Eyes ahead, knees bent.

Coach check Feet line up like a tightrope, or the child bends only at the waist. **Fix** Restore sideways foot space, then show a smaller bend through both knees and hips.

Original practice links 03, 12, 29, 30

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02 Level Change

Full instruction P03: Level Change, p. 7

P03 cues Knees bend, hips lower. / Back to your stance.

Coach check Bowing at the waist while the hips stay high, or straightening the legs on the return. **Fix** Use a smaller knee bend. Show the starting stance and finish at that same height.

Original practice links 04, 12, 23, 29, 30

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03 Level Change and Step

Full instruction P04: Level Change and Step, p. 7

P04 cues Lower, then step. / Keep your feet apart.

Coach check Reaching the front foot far ahead while the hips stay behind, then gathering the feet together. **Fix** Bring the marker closer and finish with the same foot spacing as the starting stance.

Original practice links 05, 23, 29, 30

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04 Bottom Base

Full instruction P05: Bottom Base, p. 8

P05 cues Chest off the mat. / Move a hand, rebuild your base.

Coach check Reaching a hand far forward until the chest drops or the body rolls sideways. **Fix** Keep the hand close to its starting spot; first practice a small weight shift with both palms down.

Original practice links 06, 14, 18, 27, 29, 30

Quick reminders for the mat

Use the shared Coach Moves Reference for the full steps. Page numbers below refer to that standalone reference. Follow the practice task and each move's prerequisites; entry-only work stops before a finish.

05 Solo Sprawl

Full instruction P07: Solo Sprawl, p. 9

P07 cues Legs back, hips low. / Feet under, back to stance.

Coach check Stopping in a high plank or dropping onto the knees. **Fix** Slow down: extend the legs, lower the hips briefly, then recover. Avoid a long hold.

Original practice links 14

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06 Solo Stand-Up

Full instruction P08: Solo Stand-Up, p. 9

P08 cues Chest up, foot under. / Clear hips, turn and face.

Coach check A long first step leaves the chest folded over the thigh. **Fix** Shorten the step and pause with chest lifted before rising.

Original practice links 08, 27, 30

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07 Solo Sit-Out

Full instruction P09: Solo Sit-Out, p. 10

P09 cues Foot out, leg through. / Sit low, chest up.

Coach check Sitting down before the left leg clears, trapping that knee under the hips. **Fix** Rehearse the foot step and small hip lift; slide the leg clear before lowering your seat.

Original practice links 18, 27, 29, 30

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08 Mirror Footwork

Full instruction P02: Stance Steps, p. 6

P02 cues Step, follow, feet apart. / Eyes ahead, knees bent.

Coach check The following foot catches the first foot, making the stance narrow or crossed. **Fix** Shorten the first step and stop the following foot at the original stance width.

Original practice links 12, 29, 30

Quick reminders for the mat

Use the shared Coach Moves Reference for the full steps. Page numbers below refer to that standalone reference. Follow the practice task and each move's prerequisites; entry-only work stops before a finish.

01 Stance and Footwork

Full instruction B01: Wrestling Stance, p. 12 / B02: Motion and Level Change, p. 12

B01 cues Knees bent, eyes ahead. / Hands forward, elbows in.

B02 cues Step, follow, keep your base. / Hips down; eyes forward.

Coach check Athlete folds at the waist, rocks onto heels, or narrows the feet. **Fix** Reset the foot spacing, bend knees and hips less, then test one small step and stop.

Original practice links 02, 03, 04, 07, 09, 10, 12, 26

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02 Double Leg

Full instruction B07: Double Leg Takedown, p. 15

B07 cues Chest up, trail foot up. / Drive right; knees left.

Coach check Attacker circles left around the head side or keeps driving straight. **Fix** Freeze at entry; point out the right-hand corner, then step across it.

Original practice links 07, 09, 12, 21, 27, 28, 29, 30

---

03 Single-Leg Entry

Full instruction B08: Single Leg Run the Pipe, p. 15

B08 cues Head inside; leg close. / Collect, pause, release.

Coach check Starting the finish during entry-only work. **Fix** Pause at the coached leg collection, then release and reset.

For the original entry-only practices, rehearse stance, entry and leg collection; stop before the finish.

Original practice links 08

---

04 Go-Behind Finish

Full instruction B11: Sprawl and Go-Behind, p. 17

B11 cues Clear the legs first. / Block the arm; circle to the hips.

Coach check Defender circles early or lifts the chest, allowing another leg grab. **Fix** Pause with legs free and chest connected; establish the arm block before stepping around.

Original practice links 11, 19, 22, 24, 26

Quick reminders for the mat

Use the shared Coach Moves Reference for the full steps. Page numbers below refer to that standalone reference. Follow the practice task and each move's prerequisites; entry-only work stops before a finish.

05 Bottom Base

Full instruction B14: Referee's Bottom Start, p. 18 / B16: Belly to Base, p. 19

B14 cues Knees behind; hand heels ahead. / Still until the whistle.

B16 cues Outside knee up. / Hips back; knees underneath.

Coach check Fingertips cross the line but the heels of the hands stay behind it, or bottom rocks before the whistle. **Fix** Check the base of each palm, then rehearse a still pause with an unpredictable whistle.

Original practice links 06, 13, 14, 16, 17, 18, 23

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06 Stand-Up

Full instruction B17: Inside-Leg Stand-Up, p. 20

B17 cues Foot and chest up together. / Control the hand; hips clear, face.

Coach check Turning while the rider's arm still hugs your waist. **Fix** Rehearse from standing: isolate the hand, create hip space, then turn.

Original practice links 15, 18, 20, 23, 24, 27, 28, 29, 30

---

07 Tight Waist and Chop

Full instruction B22: Tight Waist Chop, p. 22

B22 cues Drive forward as the elbow folds. / Chop, catch the wrist, follow.

Coach check Top pulls the elbow sideways while sitting back. **Fix** Reset; use a small arm fold with forward toe pressure and the rear knee moving the hips.

Original practice links 17, 18, 23, 24, 28, 29, 30

---

08 Half Nelson and Defense

Full instruction B26: Half Nelson, p. 24 / B27: Early Half Nelson Defense, p. 25

B26 cues Elbow up; feet to the head. / Chest across; hips down.

B27 cues Elbow in; look away early. / Same hand peels; then build.

Coach check Top stays parallel and tries to win by pushing harder on the head. **Fix** Reset the half, step out to a T, and move the torso with chest pressure.

Original practice links 25, 26, 28, 29, 30

Quick reminders for the mat

Use the shared Coach Moves Reference for the full steps. Page numbers below refer to that standalone reference. Follow the practice task and each move's prerequisites; entry-only work stops before a finish.

01 Inside Control

Full instruction B04: Wrist and Inside Tie, p. 13

B04 cues Wrist on one side, inside on the other. / Elbows down; feet move.

Coach check Reaching across to the wrist-controlled arm or pulling with straight elbows. **Fix** Reset closer; identify their opposite upper arm and keep your elbows bent.

Original practice links 07, 08, 19

---

02 Double Leg

Full instruction B07: Double Leg Takedown, p. 15

B07 cues Chest up, trail foot up. / Drive right; knees left.

Coach check Attacker circles left around the head side or keeps driving straight. **Fix** Freeze at entry; point out the right-hand corner, then step across it.

Original practice links 10, 12, 19, 20, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

---

03 Sprawl and Go-Behind

Full instruction B11: Sprawl and Go-Behind, p. 17

B11 cues Clear the legs first. / Block the arm; circle to the hips.

Coach check Defender circles early or lifts the chest, allowing another leg grab. **Fix** Pause with legs free and chest connected; establish the arm block before stepping around.

Original practice links 11, 12, 19, 20, 24, 27, 28, 29, 30

---

04 Go-Behind Finish

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Original practice links 21, 24, 25, 28, 29, 30

Quick reminders for the mat

Use the shared Coach Moves Reference for the full steps. Page numbers below refer to that standalone reference. Follow the practice task and each move's prerequisites; entry-only work stops before a finish.

05 Stand-Up

Full instruction B17: Inside-Leg Stand-Up, p. 20

B17 cues Foot and chest up together. / Control the hand; hips clear, face.

Coach check Turning while the rider's arm still hugs your waist. **Fix** Rehearse from standing: isolate the hand, create hip space, then turn.

Original practice links 14, 22, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

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06 Sit-Out and Hip-Heist

Full instruction B18: Sit-Out, p. 20 / B19: Hip-Heist Escape, p. 21

B18 cues Foot out, leg through. / Elbows in, chest up.

B19 cues Clear hands, then heist. / One leg under, one over.

Coach check Reaching back with a straight arm while falling into the seat. **Fix** Shorten the step and lower slowly; return the posting hand to your side once balanced.

Original practice links 15, 22, 23, 24, 27, 28, 30

---

07 Tight Waist and Chop

Full instruction B22: Tight Waist Chop, p. 22

B22 cues Drive forward as the elbow folds. / Chop, catch the wrist, follow.

Coach check Top pulls the elbow sideways while sitting back. **Fix** Reset; use a small arm fold with forward toe pressure and the rear knee moving the hips.

Original practice links 16, 17, 22, 23, 24, 27, 28, 29, 30

---

08 Half Nelson and Defense

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Coach check Top stays parallel and tries to win by pushing harder on the head. **Fix** Reset the half, step out to a T, and move the torso with chest pressure.

Original practice links 18, 23, 24, 25, 27, 28, 29, 30
